EGGCRAFT



A COMPENDIUM OF FOLKLORE, FANCIES & FOODS

EGGCRAFT

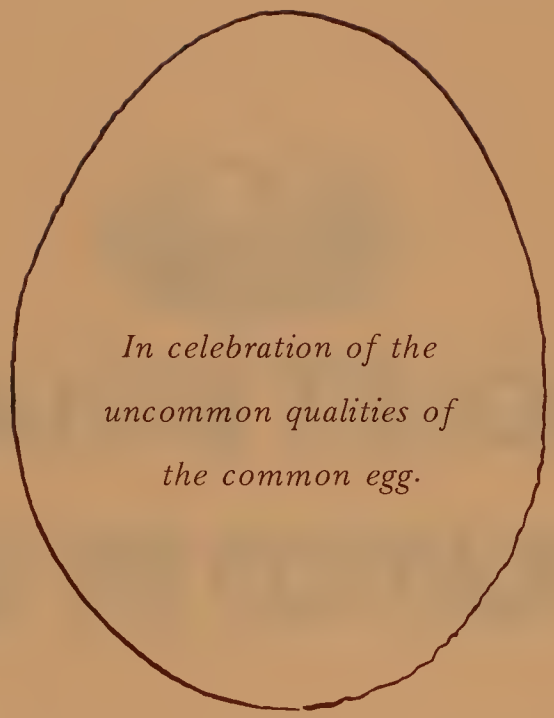


BY VIOLET SCHAFER

ILLUSTRATED BY WIN NG

YERBA BUENA PRESS

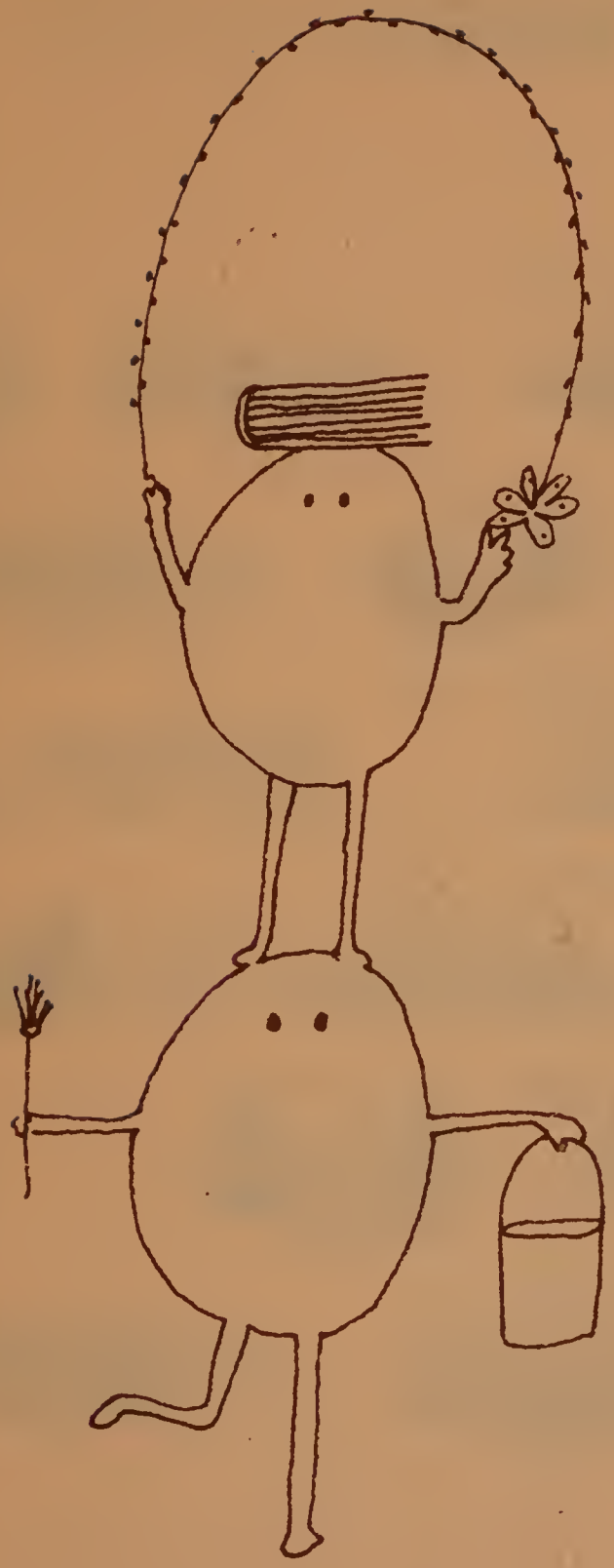
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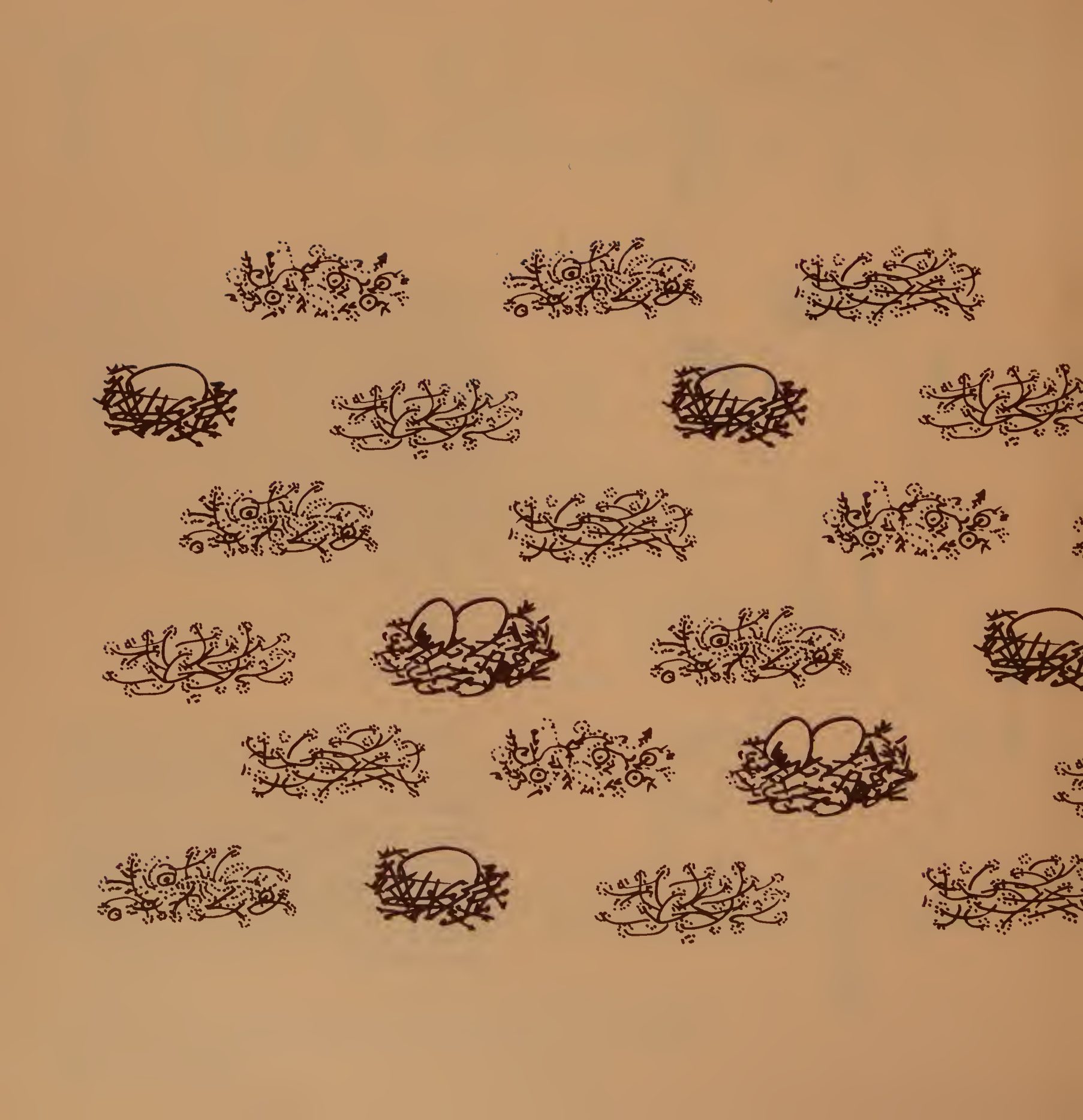


About the author

Eggcraft is the third in a craft series carrying Violet Schafer's name. First of the series was *Herbcraft* (1971) and the second, *Wokcraft* (1972), she co-authored with her husband, Charles Louis Schafer. *Eggcraft,* in the same tradition of its predecessors, traces its subject through folklore, history, and personal experiences and finally brings the reader into the kitchen to enjoy appropriate dishes. Mrs. Schafer writes from a background as educator, industrial editor, and student of color and design. She is associated with her husband who is a writer and conference consultant.

About the illustrator

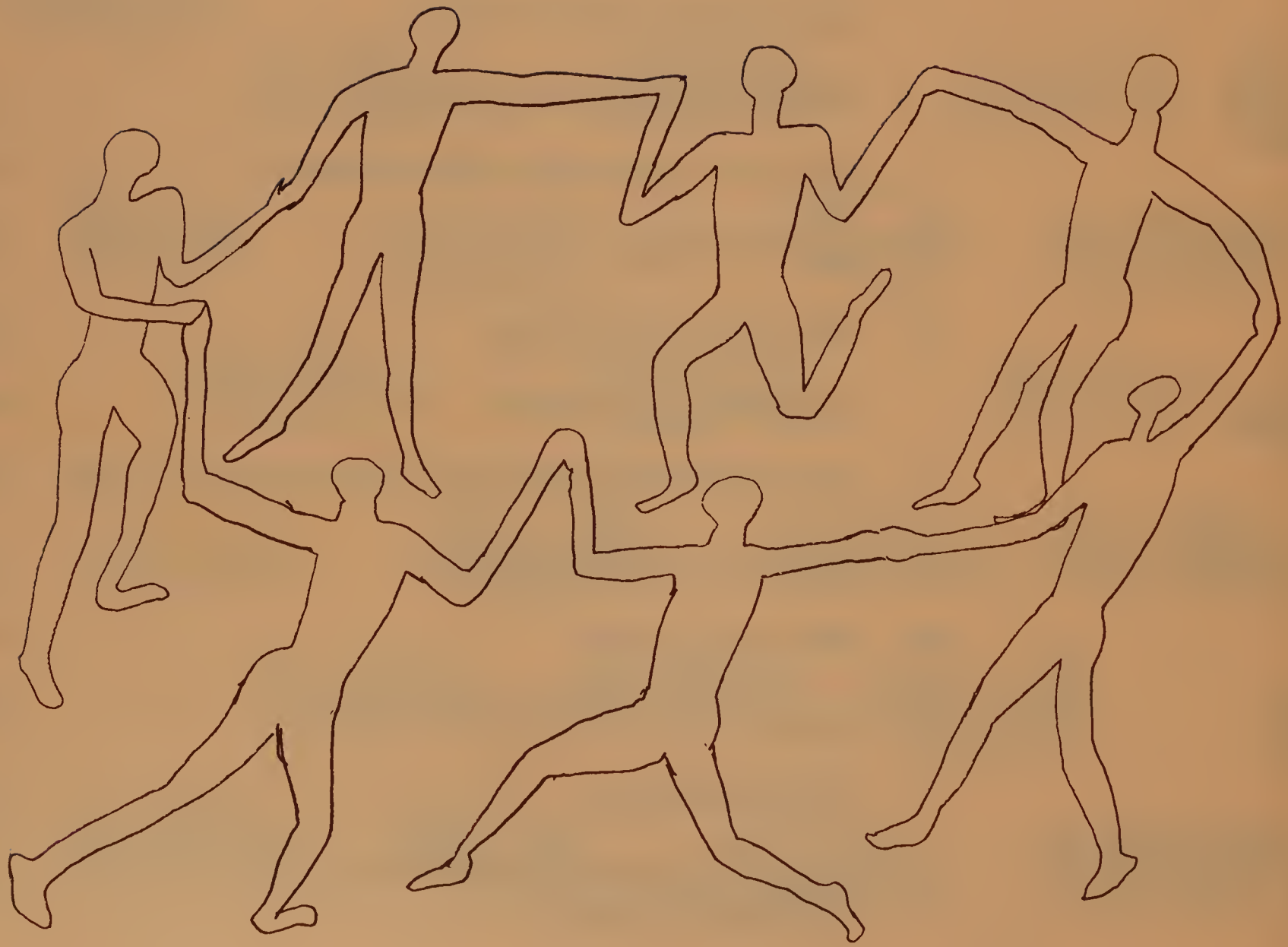
Win Ng, the illustrator, has won his laurels as a sculptor and ceramicist of international reputation. His long friendship with the Schafers is expressed in his sharing of all three books in the series by creating a graphic image for them. His illustrations are full of symbolism, double meaning, and robust humor. For *Eggcraft* he has altered the infinitely detailed delineations of the first two books and approached his latest subject with handsome simplicity.



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AN APPRECIATION OF EGGS

Innocent of intent, the egg has enjoyed great critical acclaim as one of nature's most exquisitely designed delivery packages. It has a divine shape, irreproachable proportions and no need for embellishment. Like all great works of art, it has a soul and meaning transcending its physical manifestation. It has the ultimate ecological wrap. You can eat it, yea, even to the shell!

Eggs of all kinds have always fascinated me. And this is to say nothing of childhood experiences collecting real hen's eggs in the high hills of hay in Grandfather's loft; along sunny windrows in the fields; and between the stanchions in the dark caverns of the barn.

What terrifying moments those were when in breathless panic I reached under a perverse hen to rob her of her new laid egg! What a racket of fuss and feathers and dust flying! What a noisy operation! And what a reason for hoping for praise from my Grandmother for bravery in my collection rounds. I never learned, like tougher members of the clan, to surprise the hen, grab her by the legs and toss her flying into the air. But I envied them.

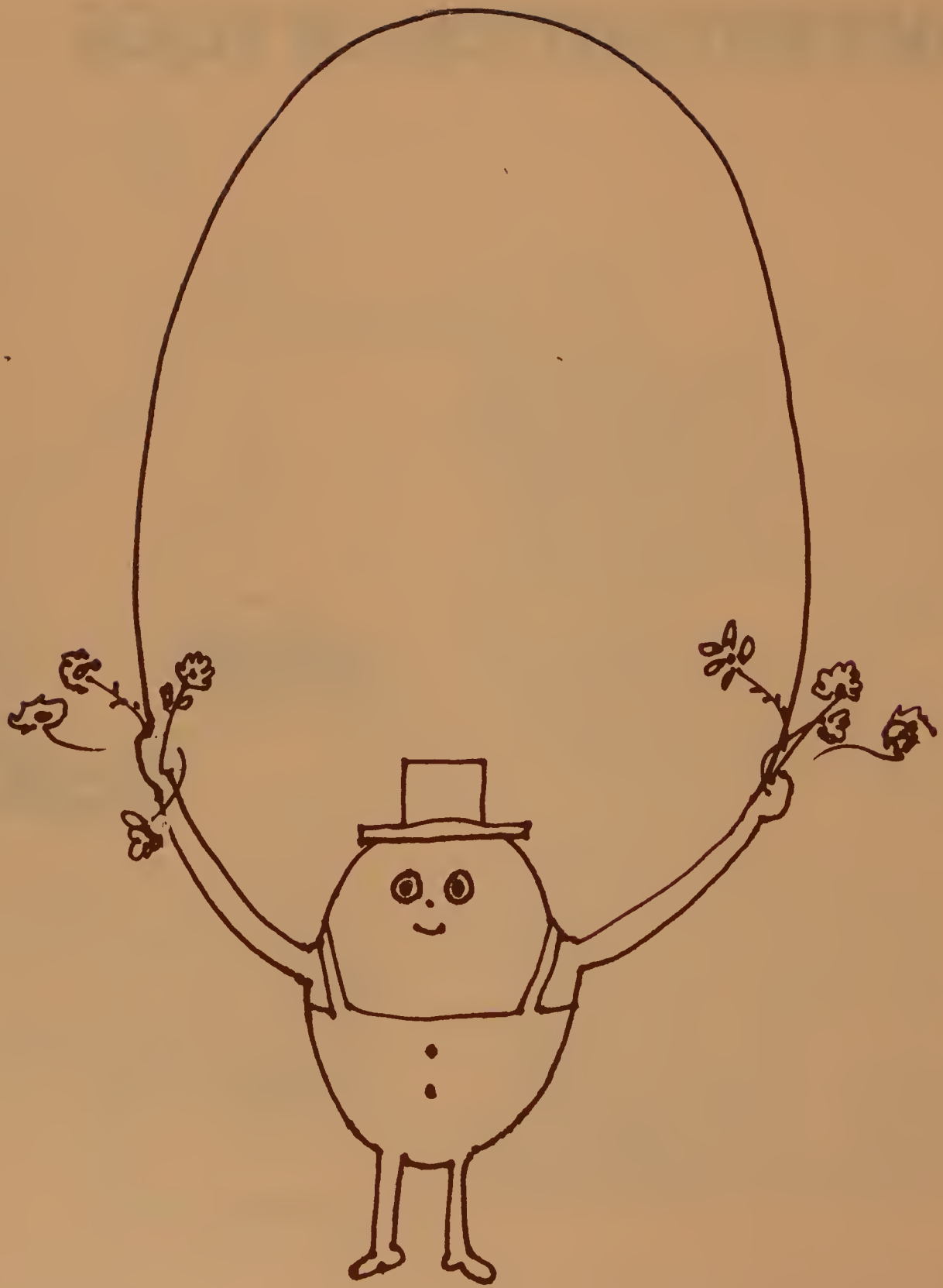
More than simply fascinating as design, package and source of thrifty food and youthful adventures, the egg is distinguished for its incredibly impressive history.



Few symbols match it for complexity. The egg is food, it is omen, it is magic, it is medicine. Folklore, superstitions and curiosities accompany its progress to present times. I confess to unabashed admiration for it!

Its role in legends, industry, art, medicine and frontier cuisine makes it a delight for me to attempt a homely portrait.

Corte Madera, California — Violet Schafer



EGGS OMINOUS & LEGENDARY

THE WORLD EGG

In the beginning, there was the Egg. It was both container for matter and for thought. According to Orphic philosophers, Cronus produced an egg in vaporous space and it had both male and female seed and from it came the creator of the world. The vault of space was known as an Egg, and the Egg had seven enfolding layers which were the seven heavens, the seventh of which was a place of great happiness.

According to the sacred writings of the Indians, the primeval waters produced a golden germ from which Brahma burst forth to create the world.

Hindu scriptures read: In the beginning this world was merely non-being. Then it was existent. It developed. It turned into an egg. It lay for a year. It was split asunder. Half the eggshell was silver, the other half gold. That which was silver was the earth. That which was gold became the sky. The outer membrane became mountains; the inner membrane, clouds and mist. What were veins were rivers. What was fluid became ocean. A swan floating on the waters of chaos had produced the egg.

There are some who see a like significance in the Biblical version — that the earth was formed in the waters of chaos by dividing the upper and lower waters with a firmament. This compares with the upper half of the eggshell in mythology.

In China, the belief was that Tien, the controlling principle of the universe, dropped an egg from heaven to float upon the waters and from the egg sprang the first man.

Ancient Egyptians credited the egg with equal miracles and told how Geb, the great Cackler, and the sky goddess, Nut, produced a mighty egg from which was born the earth and sky. Still another Egyptian myth is that Ptah was the father of beginnings and creator of the egg of the sun and moon. He is depicted in an ancient drawing at a potter's wheel turning a golden egg. A papyrus illustration shows an egg floating over a mummy, signifying hope of life in the hereafter.

Phoenicians believed the egg was formed in primeval waters and split open to form two parts — heaven and earth.

It is written in the Finnish *Kalevala* that the world formed from broken eggs of a teal.

A Philippine folk tale, "The Children of the Limokon," explains man's appearance this way: It is told that before people appeared on earth, there were limokons who spoke like man but looked like doves.

A limokon laid two eggs, one at the mouth of the Mayo River, the other upstream. The first egg hatched a man, the second a woman.

For a long time, the man lived in loneliness at the river's mouth. Crossing the Mayo one day, he felt against his legs something that caused him almost to drown. He saw that it was a hair and he wondered. He went up river to find out whose it was. That is how he found the woman and his mate. They married. Their many children were the ancestors of the Mandaya who live even today on the banks of the Mayo.

THE PHILOSOPHER'S EGG

From such ancient cosmogonies and myths came the concept of the Philosopher's Egg, symbol of creation and the alchemist's art.

Alchemists believed that whoever understood the mystery of creation – that one knew the secret of the Philosopher's Egg. That one could transmute base metals into noble stuff. That one could create a universal medicine and discover a medium of eternal youth and health.

From the Alexandrine Greeks early in the Christian era, alchemy passed to the Arabs and from the Arabs to Western Europe. Its doctrine can be traced for a thousand years down to the time when Albertus Magnus, Roger Bacon and Arnoldus Villanovanus began writing about it in the 13th Century. Its principles were transmitted during the dark ages in the practical formulas and traditional processes of the workshops of jewelers, painters, glass blowers, potters and other craftsmen.

The vase or Philosophic Egg in which the alchemical process was completed was mysterious. It was called the aludel. It contained a furnace called the athanor. According to an old manuscript the "Egg must be of good Lorraine glass, oval in shape or round, clear and thick; . . it must have a neck eight or nine inches long. It must hold four ounces of distilled water; it must be hermetically sealed."

This furnace in which transmutations were attempted was a matrix shaped like an egg, like the gigantic Orphic world egg. The alchemic process imitated the formation of the cosmos from chaos. Through centuries of persecution and suppression, alchemists slaved on, each inventing his own secret symbols for materials, his own symbols for directing processes.

Their materials included such things as copper and lead filings, glass, cinder, wood, caustic lime, cribbled ashes, clay, burned pebbles and eggshells. For each there was a symbolic character, the one for eggshells being: 

Extant illustrations of their workshops are monuments to a housewife's despair. There was an incredible clutter and disorder and a collection of oddments to make the squeamish turn away. How these workshops must have reeked! What a relief it must have been to early neighbors when an alchemist decided he might have to try something new with his Philosopher's Egg!

The Philosopher's Egg never made the alchemists rich. But it did enrich our world by leading to modern chemistry.

THE OOMANTIC EGG

The awesome burden of being "World Egg" and "Philosopher's Egg" was not destined to overwhelm the egg forever. And so it was that a 19th Century gentleman by the name of Gilbert gave the world a homely simile – "as innocent as a new-laid egg."

Yet nothing in the world has had a more complicated history, a more devious route through time, or a more fascinating and often lurid past than the

breakfast egg. It has not been a simple presence, a mere food, and it certainly has not been innocent, no matter what Mr. Gilbert thought.

Among other things, the egg was an instrument of augury, a magic, fortune-telling, oomantic dish.

Most commonly, egg divination was a reading of the shapes egg whites took when dropped from a pierced shell into a glass of water. The shapes told the future like tea leaves in a teacup.

In England, oomancy was a New Year's Eve happening. In Spain it took place on Midsummer Eve. The occasion for it in Scotland was Halloween when the Scotch used the first egg laid by a pullet. Oomancy has also occurred on special days in Mexico, Portugal, Italy, France, Germany, Poland and Russia.

Sometimes the ritual required an egg to be broken on a person's head or on a special board. Before important undertakings, Khasi tribesmen in Assam threw an egg on a special board as they intoned abracadabra. The omens were revealed by the configuration of the shell fragments.

EGGS AND BOSOMS

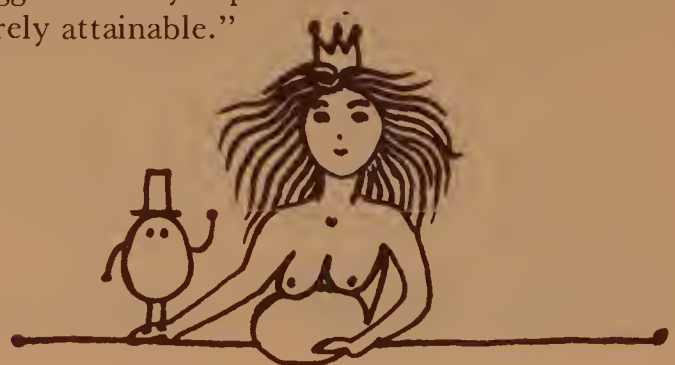
An ancient oomantic activity was reported by Pliny. According to him, a Roman princess yearned for a son. To divine whether she would produce a boy, she warmed an egg with her breasts and, when she could not tend to the task, entrusted it to a wet nurse. Between them, they hatched a rooster. The princess, of course, was delivered of a boy, or so the story goes.

A contemporary imitator had something other than divination in mind in hatching an egg the same way. Erica Wallace, a London reporter, was variously proclaimed in the headlines as "Chick Hatches Egg" and "News Hen Hatches Egg."

In November, 1969, it was reported that she had kept an egg nestled in her bosom for 21 days. The hatching took place in the full glare of television. The film was titled "Love of a Kind."

The scene was filmed for BBC by the Earl of Snowdon, photographer husband of Princess Margaret. The movie showed a middleaged woman hatching a chicken from an egg placed between her breasts.

The feat did not go unchallenged. Sir Donald Gibson, a former government official who had retired to poultry farming wrote to *The Times:* "I am at a loss to understand how the lady managed to incubate a chicken in her cleavage. To my knowledge, it takes 21 days at 104 degrees Fahrenheit to hatch an egg. From my experience of ladies' bosoms this is rarely attainable."



He hinted at royal chicanery. "I think you could have got from an incubator an egg on the point of hatching and then have put it into a woman's cleavage and photographed it."

Sir Donald's facts about temperatures were immediately disputed by the head of the National Institute of Poultry Husbandry. The thermometer in an incubator, he pointed out, may show 104°, but the instrument is situated above the eggs and heat rises. "Down where the eggs are, the temperature is about 99°. If you tried to hatch eggs at 104°, you would cook them."

The controversy raged on. Researchers opined that Miss Wallace augmented her natural resources of warmth and humidity with plenty of extra clothing.

An interested bystander introduced the idea that the Chinese had been known to hatch eggs on their stomachs.

Still another recalled Brian Wilson, the Birdman of Chelmsford Jail, as an egg hatcher. Wilson, during his 15-year imprisonment, taped eggs under his armpit by day and wrapped them in bedclothes by night. Like Miss Wallace he had not been particularly original. His inspiration could have been a Magyar folk tale about a black, five-cornered egg which was brooded in an armpit for seven years. The Magyar hatching produced a horse with five legs and three heads. Wilson hatched birds.



THE MAGIC IN EGGS

Primitive and ancient people everywhere ascribed magic powers to the egg. Their use of it in cabalistic rites was a bid for favors from friendly spirits and a means to break the evil influence of devils that plagued them. The egg was a specific for curing both physical and social ills.

The Mayans relied on the egg to free persons thought to be under the spell of the Evil Eye. Their medicine men passed an egg back and forth many times before the face of the bewitched. Then they broke the egg, looked at the yolk as though it were the Evil Eye, and buried it at once in a secret place. The healing was complete.

SURROGATE PLAINTIFF

A delightful Chinese ritual involved eggs in restoring domestic tranquility without resorting to psychiatric methods.

When women quarreled, they consulted a wise woman, explaining their problem and leaving everything in her care. The wise woman assumed the burden: the complainant did not concern herself with her problem again except by proxy to see that exorcism of the demon was properly performed.

First, the exorciser determined a lucky day and hour. For the ritual, she collected a talisman invoking Gods of the Dark Altar, offerings of paper clothing, a square of yellow paper, a representation of the Five Demons causing the trouble. To this she added a good supply of firecrackers, an earthen-

ware teapot, candles, incense and especially fresh eggs.

The rites were ready to begin. The wise woman lit candles and gave the name of her client to the Divinity of the Locality. This introduction made, she invoked the Divinity as she waved the yellow paper. Next, the firecrackers went into the teapot with a strip of paper with the Five Demons on top. These devils were placed head down so that their skulls would feel the full force of the coming explosion.

The wise woman also burned offerings. She threw an egg into a metal bowl to smash the shell. She lit more paper and talismans and finally the firecrackers in the teapot. All present ran for cover to escape the explosion that blew up the pot.

The wise woman searched the remains for a trace of the disputatious devils. She discovered none and announced omens were favorable. There would be no more trouble.

One detail remained – to tell the Divinity who had brought the offerings. This, the wise woman managed by writing the complainant's name on a piece of paper and burning it. She burned more incense, intoned a prayer and waved a fresh supply of paper offerings over the incense. Finally, she shattered a second egg in the metal bowl. She burned the last of the paper. All was well!

As insurance against future gossip and quarrels, Cantonese also observed the birthday of the White Tiger on the Feast of Excited Insects at the beginning of the Second Moon. Propitiatory offerings – also good for ridding the house of snakes and rats – were made in the form of eggs and slices of fat pork.

OTHER EGG POWERS

An ancient magic rhyme charm invokes eggs. It is full of word fossils from Druid times of the first century B.C.

Eena, meena, mona, mite
Basca, lora, hora, bite
Hugga, bucca, bau;
Eggs, butter, cheese, bread,
Stick, stock, stone dead – OUT!

Charms like this were used to single out victims for human sacrifices. The eggs along with the other three staples, say anthropologists and students of comparative religion, came into the picture because these foods had powerful magic. This was so for centuries.

Folklores of Iceland, Ireland, Bohemia, Lapland, Italy and Brittany accorded a special power to the egg. No supernatural being could be destroyed, for instance, unless you could break an egg hidden in the body of an animal.

Gypsies buried eggs on banks of rivers to avert floods. Moroccan children who stumbled in a stream quickly broke the evil magic by throwing an egg in.



RITUAL EGGS

Landmark rites – human and agricultural – required eggs. Germans and Slavs smeared a paste of eggs, bread and flour on their plows on Maundy Thursday to ensure a bountiful harvest.

The breaking of objects to bits during ceremonies was thought to bring good luck in marriage. The ceremonial breaking of eggs at weddings has been the custom in Morocco, Persia and in East and West Java.

To insure good luck, French brides in the 17th Century stepped on an egg upon crossing the threshhold of their new home.

In the recent past, the Chinese, abhorring a vacuum, used eggs as fillers in a wedding procession. Friends and relatives called upon a bride's parents to inspect gifts. The bride-to-be was brought in weeping – a symbol of her distress at leaving her family. The day before the wedding her furniture was moved to her new home. In this procession, though both parties might enjoy modern plumbing, the thunder box pridefully led the way. Since nothing could be sent empty, the convenience was filled with eggs – or pomegrantes.

Eggs often accompanied the dead to the other life, both as symbols of the resurrection and as a means of light refreshment for the journey into the hereafter. Maoris buried their dead holding a moa's egg in one hand. Kassian tribes sped their departing souls with an egg in the navel. Romans and Slavs also placed eggs in graves, and the Jews of Eastern Galicia ate eggs following burial ceremonies.

A recent archeological find in a Han Dynasty tomb at Changsha disclosed a banquet table laid out with lacquered bowls of eggs, peaches, pears, melons and rice – all for the use of a Chinese noblewoman for the journey into the other world. The Chinese have also provided their dead with sand castles, candles and incense as well as duck eggs.

The egg on the Jewish Passover Plate is strictly for ritual. It is a hard-boiled egg, roasted with the shell still on.

"My mother placed a hard-boiled egg on a small pie plate in the oven while roasting chicken for Passover dinner," a Jewish friend explains. "She left it there for one or two hours or until it became brown and the shell cracked a little. Then she removed it to use in the Passover ceremony.

"It is symbolic and commemorates sacrifices in the original Temple in Jerusalem. It also symbolized the festive Seder nights celebrated in olden Temple days. *It is never eaten.* After the Seder, it is thrown away.

"Other hard-boiled eggs are eaten at the Seder. They are regular boiled eggs and symbolize the unbroken chain of life. They are eaten following the second course after first being dipped in salt water. This represents the tears of the slaves who built the pyramids in Egypt.

"'Don't forget that once you were slaves,' we are told. 'Give thanks that today you are free.'"

WORSHIPFUL EGGS

Eggs figured in tree worship. On Midsummer Eve fir trees in the Harz Mountains bloomed with flowers and red and yellow eggs while people danced around them. The third Sunday before Easter, Moravian village girls carried a tree decorated with flowers and dyed eggshells from house to house. Alsatians carried trees and collected eggs on May Day. In their markets, Swedes sold maypoles with leaves, flowers, colored paper and gilded eggs.

The Chinese marked the coming of Spring with exchanges of scarlet eggs centuries before Christ. They observed the same happy custom when they introduced their month-old offspring to the God of their Fathers at their temples. Wrapped in red robes and carried in arms, the baby was preceded to the temple by an amah bearing a tray of chicken and eggs.

PROPHETIC EGGS



As symbols of fertility and emblems of the resurrection, eggs have been both real and symbolic objects for working magic among primitive and ancient peoples. In rural societies today, they are still wrapped in magic.

In our Southern states, eggs are credited with the gift of prophecy. Some superstitions are curious indeed.

Broken eggs. If you see many broken eggs, you will have to resort to a lawsuit to protect your rights.

Bringing birds' eggs into your house will provoke bad luck.

Bringing in or taking eggs out after sunset is also unlucky.

Finding a soft-shelled egg in a hen's nest is unlucky. But you can overcome this bad omen by throwing the egg over your house.

Egg whites beaten by two people will not hold peaks.

In North Africa, a talismanic egg was given to a new baby's brother to discourage sibling rivalry. If someone intercepted and ate the egg, however, the baby was doomed to hate its mother.

It has also been said that eggs eaten on Easter Day bring good luck until the next Easter rolls around. And eggs laid on any Friday will cure a stomach ache!

EGG YOLK ODDITIES

An egg with two yolks is lucky for the one who makes a wish while he is eating it. His wish will come true. The rationale for this superstition is that the supernatural, reproductive power of the

egg is doubled. But for the mother hen, two yolks in a single egg is disaster. Even fertilized, the egg will never hatch.

No folk tale I could find attached significance to other multiple-yolk eggs, although their finders did enjoy a brief limelight in national wire stories. In Eureka, California, an egg candler reported sighting a four-yolk egg. His appropriately named supervisor, Frank Eggerer, said this was the first such egg of 270 million candled in Eureka in 30 years. Double yolks appeared frequently, he said, and occasionally triple yolks.

Meanwhile the University of British Columbia in 1958 received a two-in-one egg from a housewife. For breakfast one morning, she cracked a larger-than-average egg to find a smaller whole egg inside with shell intact. A Canadian chicken farmer four years earlier brought evidence that one of his Leghorn hens had laid an hour-glass shaped egg. It was not reported whether omens or marvelous happenings accompanied these wonderful eggs.

FORMIDABLE EGGS

From early times, however, anything unusual about the appearance of an egg – its smallness, lack of yolk, lack of shell or oddness of shape – aroused suspicion that it was the devil's doing, that it was probably a cock's egg.

Cock's eggs, in fact, were formidable fetishes. In the 15th Century, a cock, believed to be a sorcerer, was tried in court, convicted and burned at the stake, along with his egg, of course! Cock's eggs were said to hatch sulphur-breathing basilisks which slew all who merely looked at them – except for the elderly cocks thought to be responsible for their existence. In heraldry, these basilisks were pictured with head, wings and feet of a cock.

In Mexico's Sierra Madre, the basilisk is thought to be a strange and rare beast, hatched, not from a cock's egg but from the undersized egg of a chicken that has mated with the soil instead of a cock. To look upon this ugly lizardlike monster is to be struck blind – at least an improvement over the instant extinction dealt by the medieval version of the basilisk.

In the 18th Century, anyone finding a cock's egg hurled it over his rooftop to prevent leaks during winter storms. From Europe to Arabia and Africa, cock's eggs produced a better, often more benign, troop of elves and brownies. They were as often helpful as harmful.

DREAM EGGS

American and European folklores record many interpretations of the Dream Egg. I recall being frightened half to death by dreams of movie villains and Hairbreadth Harry types when I was a child, but I don't recall being terrified by a single egg after dark.

Yet dreams of eggs must be common enough all over the world to give rise to such a variety of con-

tradictory interpretations both ominous and cheering.

Dream eggs bring good luck. They portend riches. They predict weddings. They are a sign you love children.

Equally, they bring bad luck. For instance:

If you dream of eggs, you will be beaten.

Dreaming of broken eggs is interpreted in various ways. Some say it is a sign of anger or foretells a lover's quarrel. Others, contrarily, say it means a quarrel will break like the eggs, and lovers will reconcile.



Just as often, to dream of whole eggs signifies a coming fuss. Others interpret a dream of unbroken eggs to mean wealth; broken eggs, sorrow. Conversely, they interpret unbroken eggs to mean trouble and broken eggs, peace.

In Europe, if your egg dream predicts a quarrel or ill luck, you can avert misfortune very easily. Simply break an egg before you speak to any one the next morning. And if you are short on eggs, just throw a little salt into a fire.

If you dream of a hen on a nest of eggs, you will receive something besides the eggs!

In Herefordshire, a dream of spoiled eggs is an omen of death in the family.

Dreaming of holding eggs in your lap – and none falling out – is a sign of coming wealth.

A girl who wants to dream about who her future husband will be, puts the first egg of a white pullet under her pillow.

If you put eggs in your parents' bed, they will fight. Nothing in this superstition suggests that you may well suffer their wrath as a result of playing such a low trick on them.

EGG INSURANCE

Somehow it seems a happy circumstance that poultry should have its own egg mystique. There are various kinds of poultry insurance in existence from Central America and Europe to our own South.

Miskito Indians in Central America protect their flocks by preserving eggshells. In Brunswick, townspeople beg for eggs on Whitsuntide. If they fail to get any, it means their hens will stop laying.

In our Southern states, you can thwart a hawk in the henyard by threading a piece of straw with eggshells from recently hatched chicks. Or, you can put them in a covered tin bucket and hang them in the chimney.

You can also mark eggs with a black cross and place them under your hen to scare off weasels.

If you wish all the chicks to be hens, you will have a woman carry eggs to the nest in her apron. For a hatching of roosters, you ask a man to carry the eggs to the nest in his hat. Or you can set the hen in the morning for roosters, in the afternoon for hens.

The number in a setting is important. In Georgia, if you set a hen on 13 eggs, it is believed all will hatch but one. In England, it is lucky to set a hen on an uneven number of eggs.

In the South when eggs are set under a hen, they are usually marked to distinguish them from eggs which are laid later in the nest. These marks, it is believed, will be reproduced on the chicks. The eggs will hatch in exactly the same rotation in which you put them into the nest. If you want all chicks to hatch simultaneously, you put them all into the nest at the same time.

In Mississippi farmers take eggs from a guinea hen's nest with a spoon, believing as many Europeans do, that a guinea hen will abandon her nest if a human being touches it.

ARCHITECTURAL EGGS

From earliest times, a blend of curious but often reasonable practices brought eggs into use in architecture.

Since every self-respecting house has a spirit, it is natural it should be propitiated and courted – with eggs.

New buildings of every kind, in fact, required blood sacrifices. Eggs became the substitute. Eggs propitiated spirits of newly cleared village sites in Borneo. Egg and milk went into foundations of buildings in Bombay. An egg, salt and wheat were hidden where new houses rose in Morocco.

A fable as old as Homer tells of houses built of eggshells mixed with feathers and mud. Architects were warrior pygmies only 27 inches tall. Every spring, in battle array, they mounted rams and goats and sallied forth to wage war on cranes. Their quarry – eggshells and feathers.

In Virgil it is told that Naples was founded on a base of eggs. As the builder of towns, Apollo materialized in statues with heaps of eggs.

Ruins of 18th Century German buildings have disclosed eggs buried in their foundations, at bases of chimneys, within the walls of churches and embedded in mortar beneath doors.

In Russia, egg pancakes were laid on the roof or threashing floor as offerings.

Mortar blended with eggs and blood was used for a castle in the Shetlands.

At the time of Ghengis Kahn, the Bukharan Tower of Death, so the legend goes, was built of mortar made of sand, camel's milk and eggs.

In the Middle Ages, an adhesive of lime and eggs was reasonable.

Bridges, too, had their eggs. A Czech legend relates that 200 carts of eggs were used in the mortar of the Charles Bridge in Prague.

WITCHES AND EGGS

Witchcraft thrives in little pockets around the world. In the West Indies it is Obeah. Caribbeans stand in awe of the Obeah woman, who, they believe, can hex or unhex them.

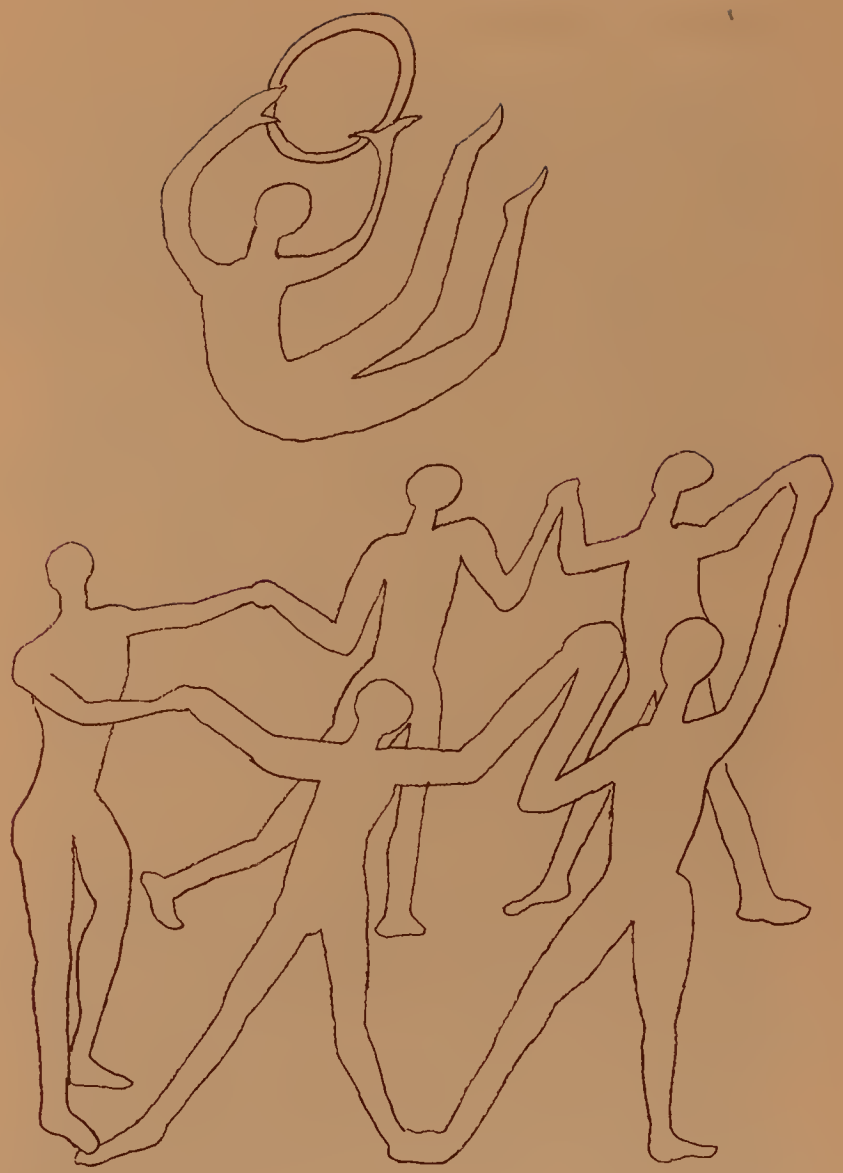
Among the weird tools of their magic are eggshells and any other odds and ends that come to hand. Their recipes for charms are extremely freewheeling, their fabrications unbothered by quality controls or standards for ingredients. So let the buyer beware! He has been known to get a hen's egg with gunpowder stirred into it!

One Obeah is an egg. There is a West Indies' tale of a female vampire who sucks the blood of children. At night she abandons her skin and metamorphoses into a huge egg. Your weapon against her is salt. First, you find her skin, then salt it and shrivel it. At cockcrow when she returns to cast off her egg form, she will have one terrible battle getting into her skin. In fact, she will never succeed and your world is spared night prowlings of the old egg forever after.

Haitian voodoo ceremonies invite spirits by means of drawings made on the floor with flour. The egg is what makes it magic. By adding it to the flour, you make it irresistible to the spirits.

In Jamaica, a gruel of rice, rum and egg beside a grave will attract a ghost who will do your bidding.

Folk tales of eggs stained with blood that will not wash away bear awful witness to punishment for broken promises and murderous events.



EGGS TO CONJURE BY

Eggs figure prominently in black arts and conjurations. Here are some strange conjures.

Put two eggs in front of an open fire on a very windy day. Soon two men will come in with a coffin. The man at the foot will be your future husband.

Several girls sit before an open fire. Each roasts an egg. When her egg begins to sweat blood, she rises and turns it. At that moment, the one who is to marry her will come in through a door or window which has been left open and take her chair. If she is to die before she marries, two black dogs will come in bearing a coffin and put it on her chair.

Two girls in silence boil an egg hard, take out the yolk and fill its place with salt. They eat it before going to bed and move backward as they retire. The one a girl dreams of bringing water to quench her thirst, will be her future husband.

To see ghosts, break a rain crow's egg into some water and wash your face in it!

To ward off evil and poisons of a conjure, take butter made on May Day, mix it with saltpeter and the yolk of an egg and roll into small pills. This May butter mix draws its magic from the fact that a cow bites off the top and bottom of every herb in the woods. So you get the best of every plant in the butter! At least that was the belief in the South. The English used this same stuff as a salve to cure "grievances."

One conjure purports to provide a very accurate way to tell who is your friend or enemy. If you fear injury from anyone, get an egg that has been laid by a black hen on Friday. Bury it two feet deep where people commonly pass. Leave it there three days. When you dig the egg up, the picture of your enemy will be on the shell. If you think you have two enemies, bury two eggs.

EGGS GIVE AND EGGS TAKE AWAY!

Medical researchers today tell us warts are viral infections little understood and quite unpredicable, being here today and often gone tomorrow. Old superstitions blamed them a great deal on eggs.

In New Brunswick it was thought that drinking water in which eggs have boiled promoted internal warts! In old Massachusetts, they believed that washing hands in water in which eggs were boiled caused external warts. In the Witch Capital warts were blamed on touching the white of an egg. No wart cures were assigned to eggs, but old timers were asked to consider using dandelion juice. Or they could cut their fingernails, put the parings in a knothole of a tree, stop up the hole, and wish the warts onto someone else!

Albanians use garlic, so I have read, to protect their children from witches. But the herb must be eaten before Lent, and there must be no egg in the house which witches can use to cast spells.

Folk beliefs held out better egg hopes for curing birthmarks, goiters, and fevers.

Rub birthmarks with a fresh hen's egg every morning just before sunrise for nine consecutive mornings. Bury the egg under your doorstep.

Removing the goiter from one's neck followed a similar procedure: Rub the goiter with an egg. Bury the egg. If that fails, try wearing a horsehair or live frog around your neck.

Eggs were also credited with reducing fever. Touch the sufferer with the egg and then bury it. That will transfer the heat to the earth.

WHY YOU BREAK EGGSHELLS

There is a rather widespread custom of breaking eggshells. The practice has its origins in a belief that witches used eggshells not only as cups and dishes for their meals but also as a means of transportation. That is why in some cultures, eggshells are smashed to prevent witches from using them.

Ancient Romans thought magicians emptied eggshells and drew magic signs inside to work their spells. So they broke the shell after eating the egg in order to destroy the vessel of the omen and prevent their enemies from using the shell as a weapon against them. The superstition has even come down to modern times. A Southern superstition makes it important to crush eggshells after the egg has been removed. This prevents witches from using them for boats in which to sink ships!

MAGIC AIRCRAFT

Eggshells were as popular for witch aircraft as broomsticks according to legends from Sweden and Yugoslavia, Puerto Rico and Mexico. But the most delightful success story of a marvelous aircraft concerns a Chinese patron saint.

It is said that between Canton and Wuchow once lived an old fishwife. While gathering firewood one day, she found a gigantic egg. She carried it home, incubated it and hatched a strange creature. Its advent coincided with extremely successful fishing. Unfortunately, the old woman accidentally cut off part of the creature's tail and it disappeared in a huff. Business deteriorated, of course.

Some years passed and the creature returned as a gorgeous dragon. The Emperor got wind of this and demanded that the old woman come and explain how she was able to raise Imperial beasts. She set out for the court but tired half way and decided to return home with the help of her Dragon Express. She had an instant flight home. It was sensational!

The old woman became the patron saint of navigators on her stream, for those who dreamed of seeking favors at court, or at the very least, wishing safe and speedy transportation. It is not told how the Emperor viewed her dereliction at court.

What a long, long way the egg has come from its beginnings as seed of the universe! What a kaleidoscope of human activities it has lent color to on planet earth!

EGGS IN COSTUMES - ARTS



&CRAFTS

THE ARTFUL EGG

Eggs have inspired every conceivable artist and craftsman.

The egg has sat for its portrait, individually and in groups, plain and in costume.

Its shell has been canvas for the painter, plate for the photographer, foundation for the collage maker and decorator, and original model for some of the world's most ingenious toys and boxes.

Egg expressions have been wonderfully diverse.

When an egg sits for its portrait, it presents a formidable challenge. Schools of photography have assigned egg portraiture for final examinations: Take a picture of a dozen white eggs in a white bowl. The delineation of shapes when all is white requires consummate control of light and shadow. An artist passes the test with ease.

A BEAUTIFUL PACKAGE FOR A BEAUTIFUL PACKAGE!

The egg also tests those who would send it to market. The most beautiful egg package we have ever observed is created by Japanese farmers of the Yamagata Prefecture. It gives the buyer, not a closed cardboard or plastic carton but an open vertical string affair he can carry off like a lantern. It holds five eggs – in Japan the set is five, not a half dozen. The eggs are arranged lengthwise, one above the other in a cylinder shape like so many white ovals held with strings of gold. All it requires is straw which is plentiful and cheap and nimble fingers.

Avant-garde artist Claes Oldenburg has chosen to monsterize the egg by creating a baggy-ugly, nine-foot fried egg.

Needlepoint experts have adapted Robert Bushong's representational painting of a bird's nest with three eggs to execute an upholstery design for a dinner table chair seat. It is nice to think it fulfills those who have a passion for pondering the psyche of a mother hen.

FRAMED BY AN EGG

Photographer Jack Hunt uses surfaces of chicken, duck and ostrich eggs to complete photographic images. His process is secret. His eggs are hardened in a special way to secure them against breakage, even if you throw them 15 feet onto a rug.

To begin with, Hunt created rooms with precise temperature and humidity controls. He ran tests on available hardeners and emulsions. He searched for ways to create photographs that would look right on eggs.

First they were presented as stationary sculptures with bases of wood or semiprecious stones. Now, they have motorized bases. "I have no notion what to make of them," a critic admitted. "They leave me bemused at their refusal to be taken too seriously. Yet I am charmed by their delicacy and wit. They are among the damnedest photographic works I've ever seen, profound and silly simultaneously,"

Prices begin at $30 and go up.

POWER TO THE EGG

An unknown village craftsman on Africa's Gold Coast carved an upraised fist from wood. In the fist, firmly held, is an egg. Asked what his carving meant, the artist said it symbolized black power.

"Power is like an egg. It needs to be held firmly. But violence will destroy it for everyone."

SYMBOLIC CONSTRUCTIONS

Some eggs are integral to graceful constructions. In Ethiopia ancient Christians crowned their churches with crosses outlined in ostrich eggs. Long ago it was thought that ostriches laid their eggs in the sand for the sun/creator to hatch. From that, Christian symbolism translated the ostrich eggs to mean the virgin birth and resurrection. Tradition dictates that seven eggs shall adorn each cross. With the disappearance of the birds in the wild, churches have unfortunately begun to make do with artificial eggs.

A London museum has an example of another kind of symbolic egg construction. Among its treasures is a beautiful pottery bowl shaped like a swan. It is piled high with eggs. The swan is traditionally a symbol of death because its image is reflected in reverse on the water. As a container filled with eggs like this bowl, however, the swan becomes a symbol of the resurrection of Christ and new growth in springtime.

Everyone knows the eggs that have lent their classic form to enrich Greek and Roman architectural moldings. No molding has been more universally favored than the egg-and-dart, egg-and-tongue, or egg-and-anchor ornament which separates architectural elements.

ADD EGGS AND PAINT FOR POSTERITY

Eggs have given their all for art's sake, too, and proved their lasting powers. Before oil was in use, panel paintings and manuscripts in Europe knew the egg. Artists ground pigments in water and added yolk as a binding medium. They also mixed egg white with various ingredients, including water soluble gums, to use in illuminating manuscripts. The survival of these works from medieval times attests to the longevity of the egg as a painting medium.

TREASURES FROM EGGSHELLS

An ancient eggshell formula contributed to a work by Gonroku Matsuda. Mr. Matsuda has the distinction of being designated by law as one of Japan's "human treasures." He is a master of lacquerwork.

"Spirit is the essential quality behind great art," he has said, "a spirit that demands an endless search for perfection. And that spirit must be developed, layer on layer, like fine lacquerwork."

Mr. Matsuda practices what he preaches.



A magnificent writing box from his hands has a cover decorated with a beautiful crane. To achieve the precise shade of white for the crane, Mr. Matsuda used a formula consisting largely of powdered shells of quail eggs.

All he needed was two dozen shells, "Unfortunately," he pointed out, "quail eggs are not all the same color. I bought 2,300 of them before I found 24 that matched perfectly."

He doubts that he and his wife will ever eat quail eggs again.

THE HANDMADE EASTER EGG

Sixteenth Century Hieronymus Bosch painted a "Concert in the Egg." It was in this same century that Francis I of France originated the custom of giving precious eggshells at Eastertime. This was the beginning of the Easter eggs as we know them.

An absolute monarch with Italian persuasions in the arts and letters, Francis was ill-equipped to attract a popular following for this idea. Not until prerevolutionary days in Russia did the custom of exchanging Easter eggs catch on among the people. This happened because the Russians celebrate Easter much more elaborately than they celebrate Christmas. For them, Easter was the more profoundly holy, the more joyful occasion. An added impetus was the fact that the Russian Imperial Factory imported craftsmen from all over Europe to make rare and curious art objects for the royal family.

Nicholas I commissioned porcelain eggs to be embellished with Russian holy images. Some of these eggs still exist.

These orthodox motifs found less favor with Nicholas II. He preferred floral designs. Eggs he ordered had corn flowers, primroses, pansies and African daisies painted on smooth off-white surfaces. He also favored gilded eggs pierced and tied with silk ribbons for hanging.

Late in the last century papier mâché eggs appeared. These larger scaled masterpieces were formed from wet pulped paper poached in glue and resin and elegantly lacquered. Religious subjects richly decorated the surfaces. Interiors were in regal gold and lined with *sang de boeuf.*

ULTIMATE TOYS

In the 1880s, Carl Fabergé, the St. Petersburg goldsmith, conceived the idea that was to make him court jeweler to the tsars. He proposed to make an egg with a surprise inside for Alexander III to give to the Tsarina on the coming Easter.

When it came time to deliver the egg, the master craftsman personally presented what looked for all the world like an ordinary egg. It was of gold enamelled white and opened to a golden yolk. The yolk opened to a tiny hen. And in the hen was a diamond studded Imperial Crown. And in the crown hung a tiny ruby egg.

The czar was well pleased. He granted Fabergé the Royal Warrant. The success of this first Imperial Easter Egg catapulted the House of Fabergé to lasting international fame. "A little something" from Fabergé's became an important gift among European royalty. Presentation pieces were exported to the King of Siam and the Negus Menelik of Abyssinia. The Empress of China could not resist the Siberian cut stones. The Rothschilds were patrons.

Fabergé chose his craftsmen well and honored them with his trust. A conference initiated every project. Each specialist joined in contributing expertise – carver, goldsmith, designer, silversmith, jeweler, lapidarist, enameler and gilder.

Eggs with a Surprise Inside

As the court goldsmith, Fabergé had a standing order for Easter Eggs – one for the empress and one for the dowager. The only condition was that there be a surprise inside, this to be decided by Fabergé. No questions were to be asked.

Once when Alexander could not contain his curiosity, Fabergé put him off. "Your Majesty will be content," he promised. To a Grand Duchess's inquiry, "And what new eggs have you this year, Mr. Fabergé?" he responded with wellbred disdain, "This year, Your Highness, we have square ones."

Mum was the Word

Fabergé's surprises were well kept secrets. None in the workshops ever discussed the Easter Eggs after hours. As for the public, few ever saw the Easter gifts. Only one showing of Imperial Easter Eggs took place at the insistence of Empress Alexandra Feodorovna and the Dowager Empress Marie. Along with other Fabergé objects, they appeared at the *Exposition Internationale Universelle* in Paris in 1900.

The surprises were astonishing mechanisms. The Coronation Egg contained a tiny replica of the coach used at the coronation of Nicholas and Alexandra in Moscow. It required 15 months to complete. The coach is perfectly articulated, has properly slung chassis and little steps that come down when the coach door opens. It is fitted with rock crystal windows and platinum tires. Every detail was meticulously researched at the Coach Museum in St. Petersburg. The height of the egg is only five inches and the length of the coach, 3-11/16 inches.

Special Delivery

Delivery of the Easter Eggs was always ceremonial. The Fabergés, father and son, personally bore the treasures to the palace. Only the last of the Easter Eggs remained undelivered in 1917 because the imperial family were prisoners in the Alexander Palace. We know only that one of the eggs was made of Karelian birch. No one knows where the eggs are today.

The Imperial Eggs were clearly a secular art and created without even an eye to posterity. They were simply timely toys with a coach inside, or a Siberian train, or miniatures of the tsars' families, or a basket of flowers, a strutting peacock, a gliding swan.

Fabergé's reign as goldsmith to the tsars lasted from 1884 until the Russian Revolution in 1917. He asked the Bolsheviks for just time enough to put on his hat and coat and walked out of his shop into exile. The descendant of French Huguenots who had fled to Russia in the 17th Century to escape religious persecution in France was now himself an exile in the 20th.

SEVEN-YEAR-COLLECTIONS ART

Long ago I discovered that seven years is required to collect enough rags for a rug, enough scraps for a piece quilt, and enough odds and ends to fill a boodle box for visiting children. So it might take you seven years to collect what is necessary for some egg projects.

You might like to think of them as the Poor Man's Fabergés. They draw on skills required of collage and are straight from a sewing basket – rococo, colorful in a pastel way, and frilly. A basketful of them has ineffable charm if they are workmanlike.

Your precursors in making these egg specials are distinguished – no less giants than Braque and Picasso.

Sixty years ago, Picasso pasted a piece of printed oilcloth, imitating caning, on his "Still Life with Chair Caning." That was the beginning of collage.

What you do is use snippets of flat materials and apply them to an egg form with paste or glue. Big papier mâché eggs are nice to work with since they give you a sizable canvas.

You can use cuttings from newspapers (foreign language and especially Chinese papers are exciting possibilities), magazines and old books; photographs – black and white and in color; exotic cloth of all kinds; lace, ribbons, decorative tape; silk and velvet and straw flowers; dried flowers and leaves and weeds; wall paper, chromos and discarded gift wrap; little poems and nursery rhymes; postage stamps, old tickets, sand; feathers – any textured materials.

The idea is not to tell a story but simply to communicate a feeling and sentiment. Eggs like this naturally lend themselves to window cut outs to be filled with bouquets and miniatures of all sorts.



A Good Handbook

If you feel the need of a guidebook for this adventure, Nancy M. Lang has one that is easy to follow. It is titled *Getting Started in Egg Decoration* (The Bruce Publishing Company, New York, 1971).

Mrs. Lang discusses basic supplies and procedures; what to use to achieve special effects; where to get eggs and what kind to use; how to clean, cut, harden, paint, dye and decorate them; how to hang, store and display them.



Many pictures of eggs created by hobbyists and artists illustrate techniques and show a wide range of possibilities for the craft.

RECIPE FOR FUN

Another thing every lay person from four to 84 can do is "take an egg box." A famous designer has used egg cartons by the hundreds to make a handsome wall covering in the foyer of his New York apartment. He uses them as a vigorous palette for the play of light. Others have used egg cartons as they would acoustic tile.

No one knows how many teachers have taught their charges how to paint, decorate, form, re-form and have fun with these kitchen throw-aways.

Because he thinks egg cartons are beautiful, Richard Slade was inspired to write a charming and instructive book, *Take an Egg Box* (Faber and Faber, London). Like me, he finds it nearly impossible to throw useful things away.

Just consider what a fascinating shape the egg carton has and see if you don't think it a pity to consign it to a dustbin, he chides. Then he proceeds to show you in words and pictures how to make portraits in the round for table decorations and party favors; how to create lively looking ducks and glove and string puppets; sailboats that sail for awhile; houses, Santa Clauses, Christmas trees; wobbly dancing jacks and push-me-over characters who always right themselves. You can also make totem poles; articulated fish; flower boxes with flowers; holiday wreaths and chickens; dachshunds, dragons, owls and caterpillars.

This only begins to suggest what fun you can have with an egg carton party. Like collage eggs, these call on you for odds and ends from button boxes, sewing boxes and boxes of tissue and ribbons saved from gift wraps.

So hang on to pencil stubs, old bicycle spokes. Add scotch tape, varnish, wire, rubber bands, balsa wood, water colors, shelf paper, cardboard, cotton from tops of vitamin bottles, ribbons, bias tape, rickrack, lace, pipe cleaners, ball fringe, cloth and paper flowers, feathers, sequins, glitter, dried moss, glue, string, toothpicks, bright bold acrylic and poster paints.

Tools are simple: quick drying ink pens, crayons, sharp scissors, straight pins, stapler, clothespins, paper clips.

And imagination, the most important tool of all!

EASTER EGGS

The use of eggs at Easter is universal in the Western world, but not original. The rite-of-spring egg is much older. Ancients among the Chinese, Egyptians, Persians, Greeks, Romans and Gauls regarded the egg as a symbol of the universe, the work of God. From very ancient times they dyed eggs, ate them and exchanged them each spring.

BLESS THESE EGGS

Some think the custom found its way into Europe with the Crusaders. Whatever the route, the egg, along with the lion, peacock and the phoenix, came to be regarded as a symbol of the resurrection. Eggs were holy and appropriate gifts at Easter for friends, servants and members of the family.

In medieval England, priests blessed Easter eggs. A benediction authorized by Pope Paul V expressed "thankfulness on account of the resurrection of our Lord." Another priestly blessing was "Bless, O Lord, this Thy creature of eggs, that it may become a wholesome sustenance to Thy Faithful servants, eating in thankfulness to Thee, on account of the Resurrection of Our Lord."

On Easter Eve and Easter Day, heads of families sent great platters full of hard eggs to the church for these blessings. Priests intoned appointed prayers, made great signs of the cross over them and sprinkled them with holy water.

Eggs so blessed were believed to have the virtue of sanctifying the body and were the first fat or fleshy nourishment people took after the abstinence of Lent.

As soon as the eggs were blessed, each carried his portion home and caused a large table to be set in the best room in the house. On it was spread the best linen, strewn with spring flowers and laid with a dozen dishes of meat. The great platter of eggs was the centerpiece.

It was a pleasant thing to see these tables set in the houses of great persons with all the silver they had in the house and whatever else that was rich and curious in honor of their Easter eggs. The eggs themselves were a very fair show, for their shells were all painted with many colors and gilt.

Sometimes there were twenty dozen eggs on a single platter, neatly piled in the form of a pyramid. The Easter table remained in this festive dress all the Easter Week. Every visitor was invited to eat an Easter egg. None refused.

SOME OLD SUPERSTITIONS AND BELIEFS

Since the 15th Century many folk customs have sprung up around the Easter egg.

Eggs laid on Good Friday were supposed to work wonders. According to one superstition, a Good Friday egg would keep all year long because the day exercised a special charm over farm products. An-



other tale ascribed other miraculous possibilities. If you could just keep a Good Friday egg for 100 years, its yolk would turn into a diamond! But if you decided on a quick return on your investment, you could cook it Easter Sunday and it would become a powerful amulet against sudden death. It would also make your trees and fields fruitful.

In the Balkans, Easter eggs were kept throughout the year because they not only had the power to protect the house from evil but also to bring good luck. Easter eggs planted in vineyards guarded vines against thunder and hail.

A Beautiful Thought

A charming family ceremony gave the Easter egg the character of an edible talisman. The head of the house divided a colored Easter egg and presented a piece to each member of his family. Forever after, should a member of the family become lost, he had only to think of those who shared this Easter egg with him. Their thoughts would leap to his rescue and bring him safely home. What a fine custom this would be to revive! How warming a thought never to be lost in this world all because of a shared Easter egg!

Colorful Legendary Easter Eggs

According to Polish legends, when Mary Magdalen and her companions went to the Sepulchre to anoint Jesus' body with sweet spices, they took with them a basket of eggs to eat once their work was ended. When they arrived at the tomb, lo, the eggs were miraculously dyed with a rainbow of colors!

Another Polish legend is that Mary amused the infant Jesus by boiling eggs and painting them red, yellow and green, just as every good Polish mother does, though now the eggs are dyed only for the Easter festival.

In the Ukraine, they tell how the Virgin Mary during Crucifixion decorated eggs as offerings to plead for her son's life. Her falling tears left brilliant dots on the eggs and to this day Easter eggs in the Ukraine have dots in commemoration.

In current folk lore, the Easter egg is produced by the rabbit or hare. It is dyed red – some think to symbolize joy, some think to symbolize the blood shed on Calvary. This scarlet dyed Easter egg had a counterpart in China centuries before Christ. The Chinese exchanged red eggs each spring because red was a favorite color and, like the egg, symbolic of life itself.

Coloring and ornamenting eggs for Easter was the custom in the Middle Ages in England. Edward I's household accounts for the year 1290 showed an expenditure of eighteen pence for 450 eggs to be colored or decorated with gold leaf for distribution to the royal household.

EARLY DYES FOR EGGS

In olden times, eggs were dyed by boiling them with flowers, leaves, logwood chips or cochineal. Spinach leaves produced green eggs as did anemone petals. From gorse blossoms they got yellow; from logwood, a rich purple and from cochineal, scarlet. The latter dye was introduced to Europe from Mexico where it had been in use long before the Spaniards came in 1518. It was a staple tribute to the crown. And Cortez was instructed by the court to procure as large a quantity as possible. It produced scarlet as well as crimson, orange and reddish brown and its origin was an insect that fed on cactus.

DESIGNS ARE SYMBOLIC AND TRADITIONAL

The Eastern Europeans have always excelled in painting Easter eggs. Often these are red. In the Balkans, eggs are elaborately painted with crosses and swastikas. In Hungary they are often white with red flower patterns drawn on them. First they trace the design in wax on the shell, then dip the eggs in cold paint. Sometimes they fit the eggs with little metal shoes with spurs and attach small metal hangers. Hungarian children exchange eggs as tokens of friendship, and in some places young men hang little Easter trees with eggs and place them outside the homes of young ladies they fancy.

The Polish decorate their Easter eggs with traditional abstract patterns, symbolic fish and cross designs. They, too, had a happy courting custom which has sadly died out. Girls presented 30 to 100 beautifully decorated eggs to their favored suitors. Those with talent decorated the eggs themselves. Lacking talent, they employed women who excelled in the art.

Each village had its specialist. Each knew many intricate designs. Some were famous far beyond their parishes. The girls paid for the eggs with money or goods or service in the artist's home. When the eggs were finished, the girls gathered them into fine lawn kerchiefs, embroidered with the young man's initials. Often they added other small gifts of nuts, flowers or tobacco. In return the young man presented his lady fair with dress material, a kerchief or colored ribbons.

The beautiful Easter eggs of the Easter table are all that remain of this romantic tradition, and they are now simply intended as gifts for children.





In Yugoslavia, Easter eggs bear the letters XV for *Christos vaskrese,* "Christ is risen," the traditional Easter greeting.

Today in Czechoslovakia's capital city at Easter, you may encounter a little old lady in fringed babushka selling gaily decorated eggs attached to ribbons and offered in a bunch like a clutch of pretty bells.

JOYFUL RUSSIAN OBSERVANCES

The Russians have always taken Easter celebrations more seriously than other Europeans. Easter climaxed their church year. On Easter Night, after services, festivities began.

For the occasion, they made eggs of wood, plaster or wax and decorated them with designs of flowers, gems and symbols of the Resurrection and hung them by ribbons above icons.

In the Crimea where the tsars celebrated the occasion, the Imperial family welcomed all who came and the palace became a vast banquet hall. The tsar and tsarina greeted all members of the household with the three kisses of blessing, welcome and joy. They gave gifts of Easter eggs. Some were simply well-painted shells of blown eggs. Some were enamelled porcelain hung on silk ribbons. Some were "a little something" from Fabergé's to become part of a necklace or a bracelet.

Amor Vincit Omnia

Some of the most beautifully decorated eggs come from the Ukrainians. A tradition since 988 A.D., their decorated eggs are believed to exert a powerful force in guaranteeing the survival of the earth. Should they stop decorating Easter eggs, a chained giant representing evil will destroy the world. Each year the monster's minions count the decorated eggs. If few eggs are decorated, they loose the chains and the giant runs rampant. In times of plentiful decorated eggs, love conquers all.

Mysteries of the decorating process are handed down from generation to generation. Decoration begins with prayers and blessings at dawn on Mon-

day of Holy Week. Finished eggs are hidden until Holy Saturday when food prepared for Easter Sunday is carried to church for a holy water blessing.

The Message of the Eggs

Egg decorators use traditional symbols and deeply believe in their magic powers. Every line and shape has a meaning. The eggs are not mere baubles: they are symbolic communications.

Three traditional designs – plant and animal, geometric, and nature – are incorporated separately or appear all together on an egg.

Geometric designs are the oldest.

Dots: Stars or tears of the Virgin Mary. A large round dot may be the sun – a holdover from pagan worship.

Continuous ribbon or belt lines around egg having no beginning or end symbolize eternity.

Crosshatching, enclosed in triangles or diamond shapes and combined with a 6 or 8-pointed star, symbolizes trios: fire, air, water; three stages of man, etc.

Ladders or parallel lines with crossbars are extensions of the ribbon form.

Combs, rakes, fingers (short lines at right angles to longer line) may represent the object itself, i.e., rake.

Diamond shapes forming star. Eight-pointed version may be pagan symbol for sun-god.

The cross form was in use before Christ – in Africa and Australia – but in pisanki it is a deeply religious symbol.

Wavy or saw-tooth line means death.

Single spiral and spoon shapes are plant symbols.

Circle with dot or X enclosed is the Oriental sign for brightness and nobility.

Plant designs symbolize love and charity. The rose may combine large and small diamond shapes around a center – like a church rose window.

A pine tree symbolizes eternal youth and good health.

Hens and roosters – fertility and fulfillment of wishes.

Fish are symbolic of Christ.

Reindeer, horse symbolize wealth and prosperity.

When this year's eggs are made, the last year's eggs are put on the graves of relatives, in barns to protect farm animals, in beehives or in water to guard their inhabitants.

FUN AND GAMES AT EASTER TIME

Eggs first became associated with Easter because it was forbidden to eat them during Lent and they were part of the Easter Sunday feast.

The last three or four days before Lent was a time of high carnival in many places in Europe. Then the Lenten fast was far more strict than it is now and was celebrated by wild revelries, games, sports, dances and riotous antics. Food forbidden during Lent was consumed in feast after feast. Children went "lent-crocking" demanding gifts of eggs and hurling broken crockery at the doors of those who failed to comply.

PACE-EGGING

Until recent times roving bands of a handful to twenty pace-eggers collected colored eggs and other gifts from householders during Easter Week. This was probably an offshoot of the custom of bringing eggs to the priest when appearing for confession on the day before Easter. Pace-eggers blackened their faces or wore masks, decked themselves out with bright ribbons and paper streamers and otherwise affected fantastic and outlandish disguises. In one north country district in England, they pulled animal skins over their clothes. One of the mummers, called Old Toss-pot, carried a basket for the eggs. And they all sang.

We are come a pace-egging, and we hope
you'll prove kind
We hope you'll prove kind with your
eggs and strong beer
And we'll come no more a pace-egging
until another year.

Pace-eggers performed simple skits in return for the eggs or gifts they expected to collect. For these slight performances they sang traditional songs.

Contemporary bands are chiefly children, and their get-ups are far less fierce. Boys as well as girls participate, singing:

Please, Mrs. Whiteleg,
Please to give us an Easter egg,
If you won't give us an Easter egg,
Your hens will all lay addled eggs,
And your cocks all lay stones.

The small curse brings pennies and sweets but few eggs these days, for eggs are not cheap and pace eggs are not easy to make.

The pace-eggers collected eggs, not for their own sakes, but for the sake of games to follow. They needed the eggs for shackling, for rolling and other games.

EGG SHACKLING

Egg shacklers firmly grasped a hard-boiled egg in their right hands. This became a sturdy weapon with

which to strike eggs held by opponents. The idea was to smash as many other eggs as possible this way while keeping their own whole.

The St. Nicholas Society of New York has celebrated Easter with a renewal of this ancient egg breaking ceremony. Each member goes from table to table at their festival dinner with a basket of eggs. Each holds an egg in his hand with only a small end exposed. An opponent, holding an egg in the same way, tries to break the shell. The one who breaks the other's shell, adds it to his basket. The one who collects the most broken eggs becomes the hero of the festival.

EGG ROLLING

One game pace-eggers played, was to roll hard-boiled eggs at each other on a field. The egg remaining unbroken when the game was called, was the "victor egg."

In England and other parts of Europe children participated in egg rolling contests. The eggs were hard boiled and rolled down hill. The child who rolled the largest number of eggs without cracking them won.

The unbroken egg is equally important in the Ukraine where it is an omen of a fortunate year ahead. In their egg-rolling, egg-cracking games, the winner is the one who emerges with the most unbroken, uncracked eggs. All the whole eggs remaining, they believe, are powerful talismans.

THE WHITE HOUSE EGG ROLL

Dolly Madison was the first to introduce egg rolling on the White House grounds during Easter Week early in the last century.

At this initial egg rolling, children at first sat sedately in long rows. According to an account of the times:

> . . . Each has brought a basket of gay-colored hard-boiled eggs, and those on the upper terrace send them rolling to the line next below, and those pass on the ribbon-like streams to other hundreds at the foot, who scramble for the hopping eggs and hurry – panting to the top to start them down again. And as the sport warms, those on top who have rolled all the eggs they brought finally roll themselves, shrieking with laughter.

Then it was discovered that the sport was injuring the grass on the terraces. The egg rolling moved to the larger grounds of the White House lawn. The custom continued until the Civil War when it lapsed, as also happened during World War I. Egg rolling revived with President Harding in 1921. Thousands of children accompanied by adults rolled 300,000 eggs. Since no adults were invited without children, young boys conceived the bright idea of turning the restriction to their profit. They volunteered to escort grownups into the grounds for a fee

of fifteen cents, got their charges inside and left them at once to go outside again and find others who wanted a close look at the egg rolling.

A variant of the White House egg rolling was introduced to New York children in 1947. Wooden eggs are rolled with wooden spoons along prescribed lanes in the grass in Central Park. Winners receive toys and other gifts.

There is a counterpart of this in Bohemia where boys roll red eggs downhill on Easter Monday. The one who rolls his egg the fastest wins all the other eggs.

EGG HUNTS

Eggs and Easter Monday have been companions for centuries. An old French superstition was that church bells were silent during Passion Week because they took this occasion to go to Rome to receive the Pope's blessing and to fetch eggs. They returned Easter Eve bringing with them eggs dyed scarlet like cardinals' cloaks. In some areas children hunt these eggs in the church yards where they believe they have fallen from the church bells. These eggs were also given to heads of families to distribute among their children.

The Easter Hare is said to lay the Easter eggs as does the Easter Rabbit in the United States. The hare is an Easter beast, pure and simple, for he was sacred to Eostre, the Teutonic goddess that gave us the name for Easter.

In Yugoslavia, the hare makes a nest in the stable and young folk go on Easter morning to look for his eggs in the hay. In England, they search gardens among long grasses and spring flowers or, if the weather is bad, they hunt eggs hidden around the house. They represent the beautiful hare. Egg hunts, when they are contests, end with an award of a prize for the one who finds the largest number of eggs. But all win, for each keeps the eggs he finds.

EGG TOSSING AND THROWING

In some English villages on the Sunday after Easter, villagers gather at the market square each with an egg. They throw their eggs into the air and woe to him who fails to catch his egg as it falls, for he loses face with the neighbors and must pay a forfeit. In France this is a boy's game. They toss eggs and the boy who drops his pays the forfeit.

In French towns a plentiful supply of eggs was too attractive a thought not to suggest a street battle with eggs for ammunition.

There was an Easter game played by the clergy, a game of catch, possibly played with eggs. An account described in connection with Chester Cathedral in England tells that "The bishop and dean took eggs into the cathedral and, at certain stages in the service, engaged in an egg throwing match with the choristers." And one church in an old parish in London gives each member of the Easter Sunday congregation an egg with the words "My Redeemer."



EGGS IN LITERATURE



Major and minor poets, essayists, historians, journalists and story tellers have viewed the egg with awe, as a matter of sport or economics and in a glow of simple pleasure.

The egg's appearance in print stems from its comprehensive nature. It has been religious and practical symbol as well; environmental entity; food for gourmets and gluttons; subject for the teller of tall tales, the fabler and riddler; currency; stationery; and provider of place names.

THE GOOD EGG WILL TRIUMPH OVER THE BAD EGG

Historian Gibbons, in discussing Persian theology, nodded to Mazda's Egg, the very diety who until recently provided a trademark for electric light bulbs. Because of Mazda, man became capable of virtue and his world was filled with materials for happiness.

In perpetual opposition to Mazda is Ahriman, lord of evil and darkness. Ahriman pierced Mazda's Egg and thereby introduced man to vice and misfortune. These opposing forces were the God and Satan of the Zoroastrians. Persians of the first three centuries popularly believed that Mazda would eventually overcome Ahriman.

Mazda has been consistently associated with light. Thomas Edison appropriated the name for his electric lamp and Mazda was a required trademark on certain light bulbs until 1945. Only recently a small foreign car brought the name back into the language.

THE CONSPICUOUS CONSUMPTION EGG VS. THE HOMELY EGG

Their senses jaded by constant gratification, Romans of Nero's time amused themselves at elaborate banquets. Petronius described what happened to an egg at a banquet hosted by Trimalchio.

Trimalchio arrived late, borne in on a couch and picking his teeth with a silver pin. His guests were already into the first course. Now that the host was present, servants brought in a machine topped by a basket with straw. On it, carved of wood, sat a brooding hen. Musicians struck up. Servants reached into the straw under the hen. They drew forth paste peafowl eggs and presented them to the guests.

"I gave orders to set this hen on peafowl eggs," mocked Trimalchio, "but, by Hercules, I fear they are half hatched! Let us see if they are still eatable."

Guests began to break the eggs with heavy spoons. Petronius almost threw his away when he saw a chicken in it. Just in time he heard a veteran of the banquets observe, "There's bound to be something good in here."

So Petronius persevered. He was rewarded by finding a tasty fat beccafico surrounded with egg yolk and seasoned with pepper. What a prize – a little figpecking warbler, a real delicacy in the fall after the birds have fed on fruit!

But even in high places, saner Romans clung to the simple life. The eggs they ate did not inspire Trimalchian extravaganzas. Rather, they evoked visions of quiet enjoyment at the table.

The letter-writing Pliny who commented on the etiquette of the imperial circle and the decay of good taste in hospitality, joshed a friend who missed a dinner engagement:

> You may sup, I confess, at many places more spendidly; but you can be treated nowhere, believe me, with more unconstrained cheerfulness, simplicity and freedom; only make the experiment, and if you do not ever afterward prefer my table to any other, never favor me with your company again!

Pliny's dinner that night planned to skip luxurious delicacies and Spanish dancers. The menu listed a lettuce dish, three snails, two eggs and a barley cake with some sweet wine and snow.

Separated by social station and probably by tastes and manners from Pliny, the poet Juvenal also ate his eggs straight. During the April festival of the nature goddess, his feast included a tender lamb from his farm and "pullets dressed with new-laid eggs, yet tepid from the nest."

Add to this the simple meal Philomen and Baucis prepared for the gods with:

> "new-laid eggs, which Baucis' busy care
> Turned by a gentle fire and roasted rare. . ."

FAR-FETCHED EGGS

Scheherazade, Paul Bunyan and Baron Munchausen established eggs as excellent raw material for tall tales.

Ladies First

On the 405th night of the *Thousand Nights and a Night,* Scheherazade regaled her master with Abd al-Rahman's story of the Rukh. Adb al-Rahman who sailed the China seas told this story.

The ship's crew, having gone ashore on a large island to get wood and water, came upon a great white, gleaming dome, a hundred cubits long. Perceiving it was an egg of the Rukh, they fell upon it with axes, sticks and stones until they uncovered the young bird. First, they plucked with great difficulty a wing feather still undeveloped. Then they slew the chick and took some of its flesh and the quill back to the ship.

All went well until the next day. The parent bird, like a vast cloud, came flying. In its talons was a rock bigger than the ship. It bombed the ship but without success, thanks to Allah. The chick stealers escaped, ate the flesh of the chick, and, lo, on the morrow those who were greybeards among them rose with beards turned black never to grow grey again.

On the 543rd night, Scheherazade described the Second Voyage of Sindbad, the Seaman.

Cast upon a desert isle, Sindbad climbed a tree to establish his bearings. Presently he saw a distant dome rising high in the sky. It was vast in compass. He made his way to the great white structure. Looking for a door, he walked around it. He tried climbing it, but it was too smooth and slippery. He marked a spot and began walking around the thing to measure its circumference. It was a good 50 paces before he returned to his starting point.

Suddenly a shadow darkened the earth. Sindbad saw an enormous bird. It was the Rukh which fed its chicks on elephants. "I must be standing by a Rukh's egg," he thought.

The great bird lit on the egg, tucked it under its wings, stretched its legs out behind on the ground, and, so arranged, fell asleep. "Glory be to Him who sleepeth not," said Sindbad.

The resourceful Sindbad unwound his turban, twisted it into a rope and bound himself fast to the Rukh's leg. Next day, so secured, he flew with the Rukh to an island, filled with diamonds and mammoth snakes capable of swallowing an elephant in one gulp.



Fables Follow Facts

Marco Polo observed in his travels that the people of Madagascar reported seeing such extraordinary birds appear from the south. They were said to look

like eagles, though much bigger in size. They were so large and strong they could seize an elephant in their talons, lift it into the air and dash it to ground and prey upon its carcass.

This may be the Aepyornus of Madagascar, a gigantic ostrich whose egg could hold 2.35 gallons.

Another Traveling Man's Egg

Baron Munchausen also contributed to tales of fabulous eggs. A sea traveler like Sindbad, he came to an island where rivers ran with milk and wine. The island itself was an immense cheese. This became evident when a member of the crew, allergic to cheese, fainted on landing.

The edible paradise was home for a kingfisher of prodigious size. His nest was twice the circumference of the dome of St. Paul's in London and was formed by two huge trees joined together. The nest capacity was 500 eggs, each as large as four common hogsheads.

Hearing chicks chirping in the eggs, the crew hacked one open. They found a featherless creature bigger than 20 full grown vultures.

The parent bird, discovering their perfidy, took revenge, snatched up the crew's captain, and flew straight up for a mile. There the bird flapped all the teeth out of the captain's mouth and dropped him into the sea.

Being a good swimmer, the captain survived and probably ate his share of poached eggs thereafter.

SOME INDIGENOUS HYPERBOLICAL EGGS

The only homebody among the tall-tale-tellers was Paul Bunyan. His Pinnacle Hen was as big as an ostrich. Having only one wing, she was unable to correct her flight and spent her life flying around in circles. She had the good sense, however, to lay square eggs so they wouldn't roll out of the nest and fall off the mountain.

Bunyan's happiest camp was on Big Rock Candy Mountain where

> Roast pigeons fly into your mouth
> And the hens lay soft-boiled eggs. . .

His cook shack boss, Hot Biscuit Slim, made hot cakes that gave men the strength of ten. His recipe included buffalo milk and ostrich eggs. On Sundays, as a special treat Slim made the batter really rich by throwing eggs in by the crate. The hot cakes were only appetizers. Whole hams and eggs with two yolks followed.

Bunyan's wife Hattie personally cooked for him. To tempt his appetite, she invented soft-nosed pancakes. These required eggs softer than any hen had ever laid. Hattie experimented with eggs of pigeons, doves and robins. None would do. They were not tender or sweet enough.

So Hattie crossed a tomato plant with a milkweed and planted it with ground up eggshells. What grew was an egg plant that produced soft, round eggs whiter than snow.

Besides whipped eggs, Hattie added to the batter flour sifted seven times, a dash of cream and a pinch of moonshine. To assure perfect lightness of the eggs, she ran to the egg plant meadow five miles away and personally rolled the eggs back. They were well beaten by the time she reached her kitchen.

EGG RIDDLES

Some very old riddles have egg for answer. One charming rhyme allows the egg its fair share of beauty.

> In marble walls as white as milk,
> Lined with a skin as soft as silk;
> Within a fountain crystal clear,
> A golden apple doth appear.
> No doors there are to this stronghold,
> Yet thieves break in and steal the gold.

Another egg rhyme is so common that few think of it as being a riddle.

> Humpty Dumpty sat on a wall,
> Humpty Dumpty had a great fall.
> All the king's horses,
> And all the king's men,
> Couldn't put Humpty together again.

Humpty Dumpty did not appear in early riddle books, probably because the rhyme was already well known. Linguists believe its antiquity may be measured in thousands of years, or be so great as to be unmeasurable. The rhyme had other nationalities besides English.

In France the rhyme was known as "Boule, boule"; in Sweden as "Thille Lille"; in Finland as "Hillerin-Lillerin"; as Annebadadeli in Switzerland, and variously in Germany.

The earliest recording of the rhyme is in a manuscript, contemporary with *Mother Goose's Melody* (1803).

You should also know about Mr. Bilbo Baggins, J.R.R. Tolkien's hobbit who was lost in a cave. There he encountered old Gollum. Anxious to appear friendly, Gollum suggested posing riddles for each other. One of the toughest Bilbo asked Gollum was this beautiful egg couplet:

> A box without hinges, key or lid
> Yet golden treasure inside is hid. . .

ROUGH AND READY EGGS

The American frontier was responsible for verse of quite a different kind. Consider the hayseed exuberance of this "Kansas Hen."

> We have read of Maude on a summer day, who raked, barefooted, the new mown hay; we have read of the maid in the early morn, who milked the cow with the crumpled horn; and we've read the lays that the poets sing, of the rustling corn

and the flowers of spring; but of all the lays of tongue or pen, there's naught like the lay of the Kansas hen. Long, long before Maude rakes her hay, the Kansas hen has begun to lay, and ere the milkmaid stirs a peg, the hen is up and has dropped her egg; the corn must rustle and flowers spring if they hold their own with the barnyard ring.

If Maude is needing a hat and gown, she doesn't hustle her hay to town, she goes to the store and obtains her suit with a basketful of her fresh hen fruit; if the milk maid's beau makes a Sunday call, she doesn't feed him on milk at all, but works up eggs in a custard pie and stuffs him full of a chicken fry; and when the old man wants a horn, does he take the druggist a load of corn? Not much! He simply robs a nest and to town he goes — you know the rest.

He lingers there and he talks, perchance, of true reform and correct fee nance, while his poor wife stays home and scowls, but is saved from want by those self-same fowls; for, while her husband lingers there, she watches the cackling hens with care and gathers eggs, and the eggs she'll hide till she saves enough to stem the tide.

Then hail, all hail to the Kansas hen, the greatest blessing of all to men. Throw up your hats and make Rome howl for the persevering barnyard fowl! Corn may be king, but it's plainly seen the Kansas hen is the Kansas Queen.

"Kansas Hen" situations still exist. In Czechoslovakia, it was reported last year that a housewife set a steel trap to catch a polecat she thought was stealing eggs from her henhouse. In the trap she found her husband. He confessed he had been stealing the eggs to pay for his drinking.

BARTERING EGGS

My own experience gathering eggs on my Grandmother's farm was prelude to trading at a general store in the village a few miles away. This meant the joy of a buggy ride with Grandmother. Daisy and Fanny were hitched up. We mounted the cart by way of a little round iron step. Grandmother took the reins, clucked "Tch! tch!," and off we went up a dusty one-lane road that had a middle strip of grasses and walls of tall grain on either side rising like a golden corridor.

Soon we turned into the big road East running parallel with the Great Northern Railroad tracks.

When we arrived at the village and came even with the loading platform of the general store, Grandmother took care of all the business of trad-

ing eggs and cream. I went inside and took up station to wait quietly opposite the big glass jars of molded cream candies and tiny heart-shaped wafers with mottoes. The wafers were a kind of early-day, barefaced fortune cookie with "Be mine" and "I love you" plainly pressed in to their faces.

I knew there would be a bag of these sweets for me to take back to the farm. I can taste them yet and still enjoy the very thought of them. How firm the molded candies were when I popped them into my mouth and then how deliciously they collapsed into cream on my tongue! And how oddly of face powder the wafers tasted, once I had enjoyed their messages. What sweets to exchange for eggs!

SHARP PRACTICES

Egg bartering is a part of our folklore.

A story about rotten eggs is told from a storekeeper's point of view. He bought eggs in unlimited quantities and had to be wary from July on when farmers, busy with haying, couldn't keep track of their hens. The eggs of setting hens went into crates along with fresh ones. Rotten eggs in one farmer's delivery escaped detection.

The next time the farmer delivered eggs, the clerk complained, "Those last eggs you brought in were rotten!"

The farmer pretended shock. "Damn a hen that will lay rotten eggs!" he exclaimed.

Another egg barter story describes the Yankee custom of treating customers after trading with them.

A stranger, too honest to steal and too well off to beg, brought a newly laid egg to trade for a darning needle. The exchange made, the customer waited for a treat.

When after a decent interval it failed to come, he asked, "Ain't ye going to treat?"

The merchant mixed a drink with brandy, sugar and water only to learn that his customer wanted an egg with his drink. The man picked up the very egg he had just traded, broke it and discovered a double yolk.

"Look!" he crowed. "I have given you an egg with two yolks! Shouldn't you now give me two needles?"

He got them!

THE WRITER'S EGGSHELL STATIONERY

The eggshell has long been my special province. On it I have written hundreds of messages. So I have a special feeling for a man far away in England.

Having mislaid his checkbook, he could not write an ordinary check when his truck driver came to collect his wages.

He was boiling an egg at the time and substituted its shell for paper. He wrote his check on the egg and the truck driver easily cashed it at his bank.

In much the same way I have written the order of my daily affection on shells of hard-boiled eggs and tucked them into a hundred brown paper lunch bags for The Man. For me, these were the darling thoughts of the moment and strictly ephemeral.

But The Man responded and I began to find scraps of paper in the empty lunch bags answering my noontime eggshell messages. Finally, he bought a blank Japanese book with a silk cover in which to record them. Point, counterpoint in a book inspired by eggshell messages!

THE CONCEPTUAL EGG

Oliver Wendell Holmes, *The Autocrat of the Breakfast Table,* fancied eggs as concepts. In one discursive monologue he observed that a professor friend was "full of eggs."

A few men, according to Holmes, carry in their brains the *ovarian eggs* of future civilizations. Not ready to be laid in books, some of the eggs are hardly ready to be formed in conversations. But they do exist as rudimentary ideas and tendencies and forms of the future. General notions aren't much good unless a man has a crop of these intellectual ovarian eggs in his mind or knows they are in the minds of others.

> One must be in the habit of talking with such persons to get at these rudimentary germs of thought; for their development is necessarily imperfect, and they are moulded on new patterns, which must be long and closely studied. But these are the men to talk with. No fresh truth ever gets into a book.

EGG PLACE NAMES

Real and fictional place names incorporate the egg. Famous among fictitious place names are West Egg and East Egg in *The Great Gatsby.* They were said to derive from two unusual land formations resembling a pair of enormous eggs, identical in shape and separated by a bay. West Egg is the less fashionable of the two.

How often these place names have surfaced, I do not know, but Fitzgerald drew such a graphic picture of them, their people and activities that mere mention of them establishes a time, mood and way of life.

A Yale professor has described Adlai Stevenson as not being one of those who searched for laughter and grace "from West Egg to the Riviera" and went to pieces in the process.

Both East and West Egg cropped up in a *New Yorker* profile of Dick Cavett. The talk show personality is pictured in the living room of a Stanford White beach house in fashionable East Egg. His wife is shopping in West Egg.

Then there is Two Egg, Florida, believed to have been settled in 1860 at the time barter was the means of exchange in the Florida Panhandle. Eggs,

chickens, peanuts and cotton took the place of currency.

One story about this real place is that a farmer with a large brood of children gave each a hen and decreed their pin money would depend on egg production. Early drummers who passed through the area filed reports to their home office referring to Allison Crossroads as Two Egg. The name remains. Today an official highway sign in Grand Ridge on U.S. 90 gives mileage to Two Egg.

OTHER EGG PLACES

There is an Egg Harbor and an Egg Harbor City in New Jersey; an Egg Island, which is only a barren rock of Niihau, Hawaii; and an Egg Island Point extending into Delaware Bay.

Oddly enough, Egg Harbor City is a famous wine center. It was named in anticipation of a proposed canal to connect it with Gloucester Furnace and the Mullica River. The canal was never dug. But egg on the nameplate makes sense since the Atlantic County Agricultural Society Fair Grounds there have outstanding poultry exhibits.

A second Egg Harbor along Wisconsin's Green Bay derived its name from an incident during a rowboat outing of prominent couples in the area.

To amuse themselves, as rowboats came within range, occupants first fired hardtack at each other and progressed to a bombardment of fresh eggs.

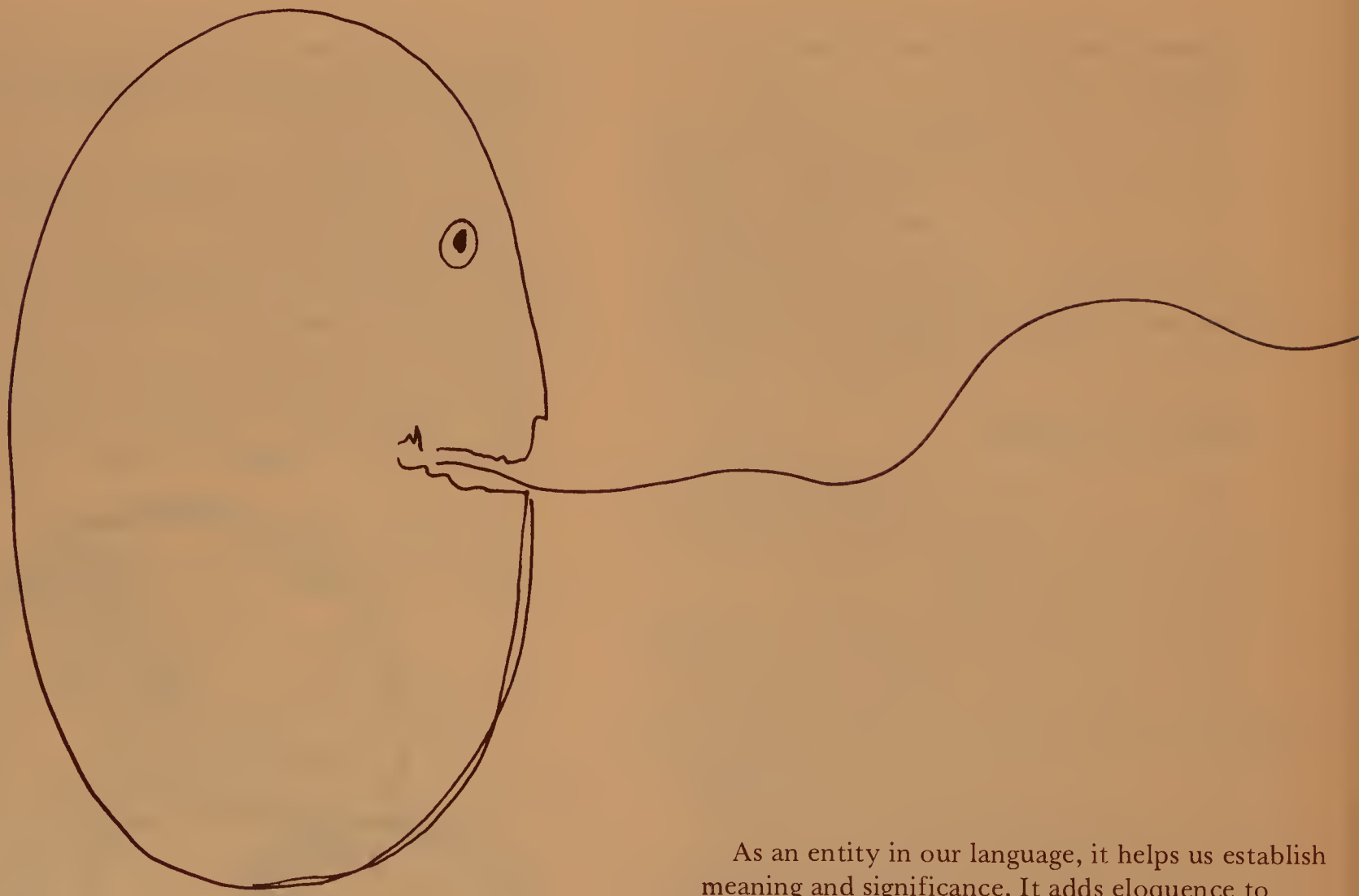
The frolic continued on shore until the field of battle was strewn with eggshells. The next morning, gentlemen in the party made speeches appropriate to cessation of hostilities and formally named the battlefield Egg Harbor.

The Green Bay battle had a precursor of sorts in the egg throwing climax of a 17th Century banquet.

The impresario of the times ordered a ship to be made of confectionery. He had it filled with guns loaded with real gunpowder and piled with pastry to conceal live frogs and birds. At a signal, guns were fired, ladies pelted each other with eggshells filled with perfumed water, the pies opened and the frogs hopped out and the birds flew away.



EGGS WITH TONGUES



The egg has a tongue, no doubt about that! Its language and character have been colorful and dramatic enough to inspire mimes, word inventors, politicians, linguists, cartoonists, advertising artists and entrepreneurs.

As an entity in our language, it helps us establish meaning and significance. It adds eloquence to speech. It has the gift of both revelation and disguise. What an egg is, we all know. When the word becomes part of a name, we still feel comfortably certain what it means. We do, that is, until the name persists without retaining the original significance.



Such a meaning loss occured with "egg cream," a drink which came to my attention during the 1972 presidential campaign. On a television newscast, a candidate in search of votes in a New York City delicatessen, drank a potion from a waterglass. He smacked his lips and said to the proprietor, "It's good! What is it?"

"Egg cream," was the reply.

"We'll serve it in the White House," called the candidate over his shoulder as he left.

"Egg cream," I mused, "must find out about that." And it was the word "egg" which deluded me. Finally I learned why from Sylvia Hecht of Washington.

"I had never heard of egg cream either," she wrote, "but I have traced it through a former resident of New York.

"Believe it or not, egg cream has nothing to do with either eggs or cream. It is a typical New York City drink and local there. It came into being at least 50 or 75 years ago during the heyday of corner taverns and corner grocery stores. While the non-Jewish neighborhood were partaking of Irish whiskey and other strong drinks in the taverns, the Jewish people would gather in the corner grocery stores and candy stores for 2¢ plain (plain seltzer water) or egg cream.

"This is how the egg cream was made: To a little bit of seltzer in a glass, add some chocolate syrup, then a little milk and spritz the glass with more seltzer. This made it foam which is probably why it was called egg cream.

"It was always chocolate and sold for 3¢ or 5¢ depending on the size of the glass. It was usual in the old days to go to the corner stores to catch up on gossip and news while sipping an egg cream."

Now that we know how unreliable any word can be, let us get on with egg language we can rely on!



THE LINGUISTICAL EGG

If you have kept encyclopedic company with the venerable Dr. Ebenezer Cobham Brewer, you know about his "alms-basket of words." Its formal title is: *Dictionary of Phrase and Fable Giving the Derivation, Source, or Origin of Common Phrases, Allusions and Words That Have a Tale to Tell.*

From 22 of Dr. Brewer's entries, we learn how much eggs have enriched the language.

1. **A bad egg** is a disreptuable character who comes to no good. A good egg is commendable.

2. **A duck's egg** shortened to "a duck" means no score in cricket. The same is said of a goose egg, which also means "zero" in school assignments.

3. **Curate's egg** was introduced by *Punch.* A nervous young curate at his bishop's breakfast table, when asked whether the egg was to his liking, responded, "Parts of it are excellent." He was too unstrung to say it was bad.

4. **Druid's egg** was said to be a wonderful egg hatched by two serpents and suspended in the air by their hissing. Anyone wanting to catch it had to run for his life. Possession assured success in contests and favors from the powerful.

5. **Easter eggs.** Villeins made Easter payment of eggs to overlords. This is probably the origin of customs of eating eggs at Easter and making gifts of eggs to children.

6. **Golden eggs** signify great profits.

7. **Scrambled eggs** stand for "brass hat," a service term for high ranking officer. Term refers to gold leaves on the brim of senior officers' caps.

8. **Mundane egg.** Early Phoenicians, Egyptians, Hindus, Japanese and others believed the world was egg shaped and hatched from an egg made by the creator.

9. **As sure as eggs is eggs.** This means "very sure." It is possibly a corruption of the logician's formula "X is X." The expression has been in use since the 17th Century.

B.A. Botkin in *A Treasury of New England Folklore* includes "eggs is eggs" among clever retorts. According to an anecdote, a man brought a dozen extra large eggs to market and tried to get a fancy price for them. The storekeeper demurred, "Eggs is eggs."The next week the same man returned with a dozen bantam eggs. When the storekeeper objected, the seller quietly remarked, "Eggs is eggs."

10. **Don't put all your eggs in one basket.** The advice is: diversify. Don't risk everything on a single venture.

11. **I have eggs on the spit.** It means "I can't give you any attention now." Roasting eggs on a spit required undivided attention. First, eggs were boiled, then the yolk removed and braided with spices and returned to the white. The whole was spitted and roasted.

12. **Like as two eggs** means exactly alike.

13. **Show him an egg and instantly the whole air is full of feathers.** This is counting chickens before they hatch.

14. **Teach your grandmother to suck eggs** is a scornful reply to someone who thinks to teach his elders.

15. **There is reason in roasting eggs.** Even simple methods have their reasons. During the time when wood fires were more common, eggs were often roasted. Great care was necessary to prevent their being ill roasted.

"The vulgar boil, the learned roast an egg. . ."
Second Epistle of Second Book of Horace

16. **To crush an egg** is to nip things in the bud.

17. **To egg on** is simply to urge, or encourage one to the edge. The expression has been used since the 16th Century.

"Schemers and flatterers would egg him on."
Thackeray

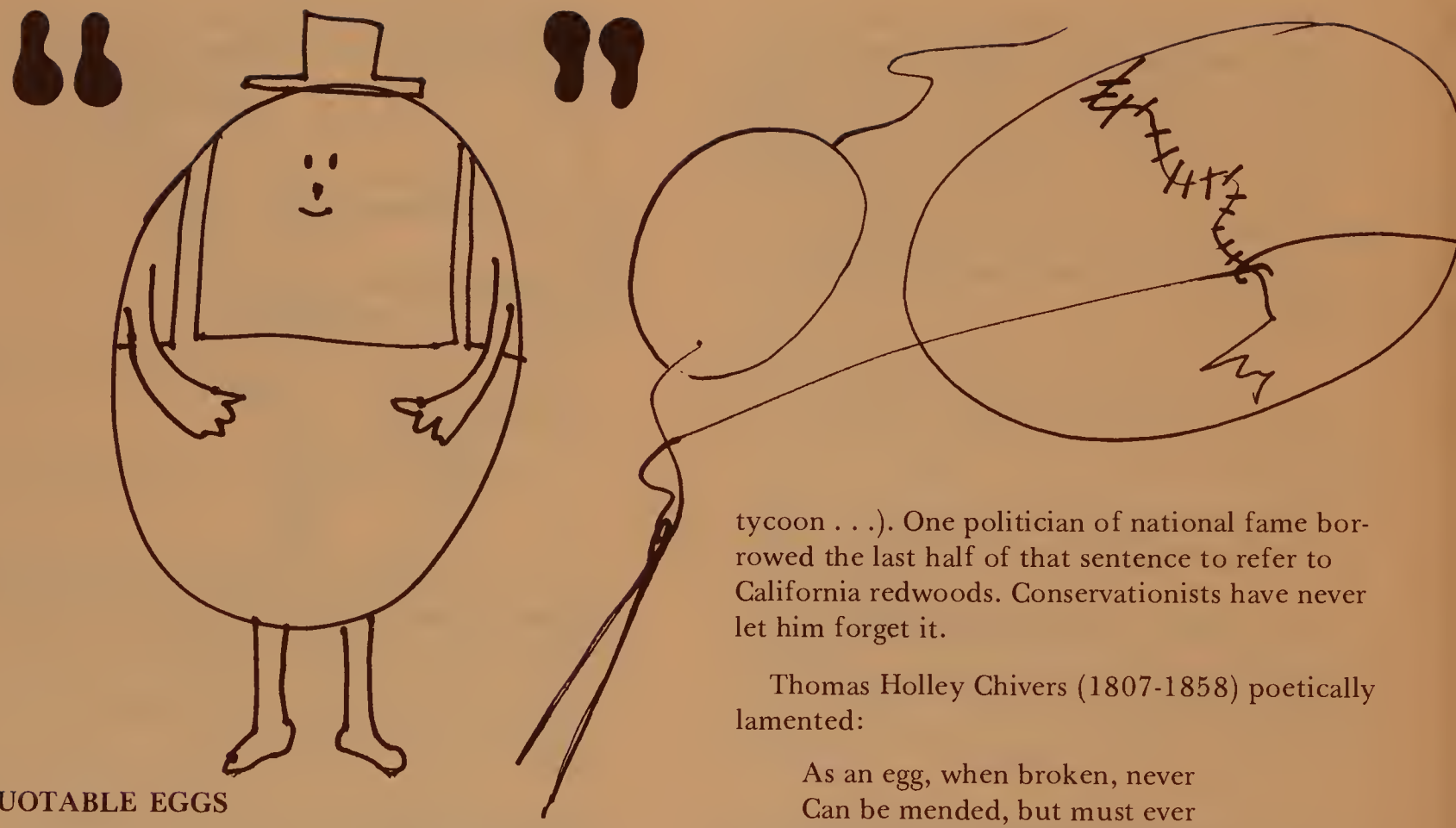
18. **To take eggs for money** was more appropriate when eggs were plentiful and cheap. It meant to allow yourself to be imposed upon.

19. **To tread upon eggs** is to walk on delicate ground.

20. **Egg Feast or Egg Saturday** is Saturday before Shrove Tuesday.

21. **Egg-head** refers to one who is bald or an intellectual – a high brow, in other words. My husband is both! It is proper to say egg-bald.

22. **Egg-trot, or Egg-wife's trot** is travel at a cautious pace.



QUOTABLE EGGS

John Bartlett's *Familiar Quotations* took note of eggs, too.

"A kiss without a moustache is like an egg without salt," he reported, is an old Spanish saying.

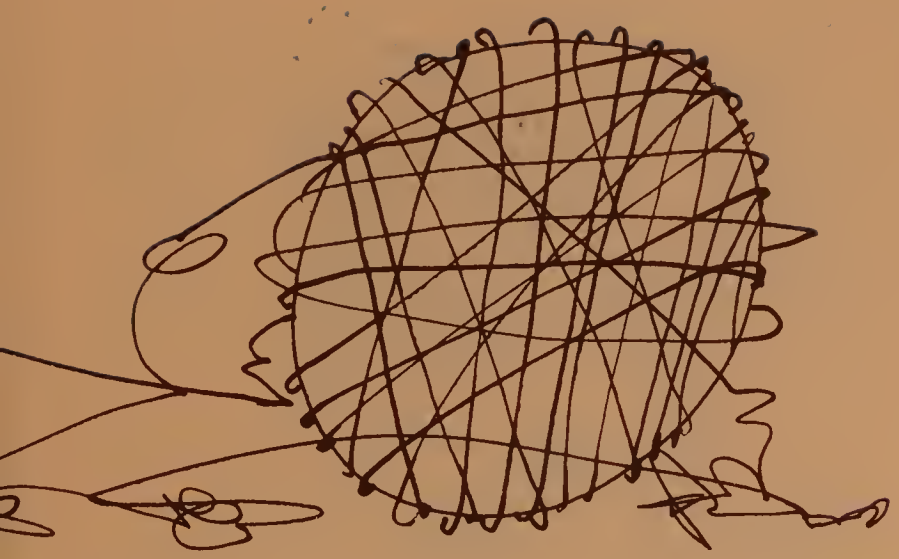
Whoever said, "As one egg is like another, when you've seen one you've seen them all!" established the gist of the simile as a handy design for newspaper headlines and quick repartee (You see one tycoon . . .). One politician of national fame borrowed the last half of that sentence to refer to California redwoods. Conservationists have never let him forget it.

Thomas Holley Chivers (1807-1858) poetically lamented:

> As an egg, when broken, never
> Can be mended, but must ever
> Be the same crushed egg forever –
> So shall this dark heart of mine . . .

Shakespeare's *Romeo and Juliet* uncovered the line, "Thy head is as full of quarrels as an egg is full of meat."

In the 16th Century George Herbert, perhaps anticipating Lecky's theory of self consistency, claimed "He that steals an egg will steal an ox."



Poet James Russell Lowell said, "Puritanism, believing itself quick with the seed of religious liberty, laid, without knowing it, the egg of democracy."

And Samuel Butler brought everything down to earth with his simple, "A hen is only an egg's way of making another egg."

Roget's *Thesaurus* connects eggs with difficulty (walking among eggs); unskillfulness and rashness (having too many eggs in one basket); and hounding (egging on).

CACKLING HENS

A 19th Century Baptist preacher and The Autocrat of the Breakfast Table found differing significance in cackling hens and their eggs.

"Bear the hen's cackle for the sake of the egg," said Preacher Spurgeon. "Little annoyances must be put up with because of great advantages."

Autocrat Holmes, after firing off his intellectual artillery for the benefit of the School Mistress, confessed he wasn't sure whether he had or had not borrowed his high flown ideas from literary giants. He liked to think he found them in his own head "laid there by that solemn fowl, Experience (who according to my observation, cackles oftener than she drops real live eggs). . ."

UNCONVENTIONAL EGGS AND SOUBRIQUETS

Eric Partridge brings us into present times. *An egg* is a person or a fellow, he says. It is also a bomb, grenade or torpedo. *To lay an egg* is to fall flat, to fail completely.

Other slang expressions include:

"Eggs-a-Cook" for Egyptians; and during World War I, for the Third Infantry Division of AIF, Australian.

Also during World War I, an egg was American slang for a newly arrived, inexperienced airman and later for a male who let his girl pay for her ticket to a dance hall (1920). From this came the hyphenated word *egg-harbor,* meaning a free dance.

And there were names for egg. In the underworld about 1900 a biddy was an egg. From 1880, in the underworld, and on the railroad, cackleberries were eggs. And a souvenir egg was an egg too old.

"To take the egg" had the same outrageous meaning as "to take the cake" – to deserve a prize, the overtones being sarcastic.

POETIC POVERTY

The Rhyming Dictionary holds little hope – 14 or 15 words – for the egg as a performing artist.

There is beg, naturally, then, beglerbeg, goose egg, keg, leg, Meg, peg, philabeg, skeg, teg, unpeg, Winnipeg and yegg. The *beglerbeg* is a Turk and next in dignity to the Grand Vizier. A *philabeg* is a Scottish kilt. *Skeg* is the after part of the keel of a vessel near the sternpost and also a sort of wild plum, an inferior kind of bearded oat, a glance or peep, and a variation of *skag* which is a tear, split or wound. I leave it to you to determine how to make these poetic companions of the egg.

MORE EGGS DEFINED

I cannot imagine why *nest egg* did not make the best lists I saw, for they have long been dear in the language. I first knew them as the glass eggs that were actually left in hens' nests as decoys to induce the hens to lay more eggs in the same place. Figuratively, they are things and money laid up as the beginning of a fund or collection, or as a reserve for a rainy day. They are like the pennies you put in a child's new purse to sweeten the possession of it.

An even more up-to-date egg phrase comes to us from a professor of psychology at the American University in Washington. He has been compiling a glossary to help himself overcome his middle-classness in communicating with disadvantaged youth.



One entry is *throwing the egg:* to ignore someone by throwing your head back and whistling derisively.

INSULTING EGGS

More dramatic and certainly more messy is the actual throwing of eggs: the intention is insult. A middle-aged Londoner threw two eggs at a Playboy "playmate of the month" and screamed, "You English tart!" He scored one hit and was questioned, but not charged, by detectives at the scene.

The Grand Klud of the Ku Klux Klan had his nose bloodied by egg-throwing student hecklers at Wayne State University in Detroit.

The Prime Minister of Ireland, Jack Lynch, crouched behind Secret Servicemen outside the American Broadcasting Company studios in New York to avoid the fire of 300 egg-throwing demonstrators. Shouting "IRA All the Way" and other appropriate slogans, they splattered eggs on Lynch's car and the policemen guarding the Irish official, but they failed to lay an egg on their target.

POLITICS SOUTH OF THE BORDER

Politicians have had their share of the egg. President Allende of Chile was said to have "made an omelette without cracking eggs." That was early in 1972. By the tenth month of his office, Allende's government was described in egg terms again: it was said to be mobilizing have-nots by promising to "turn the omelette over," that is, give them a shot at consumer-oriented luxuries which it has been trying to strip away from the privileged strata.

PAINFUL AND EMBARRASSING EGGS

"Egg on one's face" is public embarrassment for a *faux pas.* Apparently it can also be painful in delivery.

Under a caption "He Got Egg All Over His Face," Abigail Van Buren aired a letter in her column from "L" in Illinois.

"I decided that the next time my husband struck me," wrote L, "I would pick up the nearest heavy object and let him have it. Unfortunately for him, the last time he hit me I was frying eggs in a cast iron skillet. I'll admit it was awfully drastic, but that was the last time he ever laid a hand on me."

CARTOON EGGS

Cartoonists and advertising artists find the egg irresistible.

Cartoonist Le Pelley did a cartoon he titled "Egg Race." It showed President Nixon with an egg balanced on his head – "U.S. Commitments;" another on his left shoulder – "US Conservatives;" and balancing eggs on spoons held before him, one representing POW's and the other, South Vietnam Chances. Behind him, broken on the ground, was a fifth egg representing Press Popularity. Roped off on the sidelines are nervous citizens yelling, or holding their breath or shielding their eyes because of the precariousness of the scene.

And the North Vietnamese were contending that they had never put most of their eggs in the American political basket.

ILLUSTRATIVE EGGS

Robert Pryor drew two powerful panel illustrations for Victor Navasky's exhaustive review of David Halberstam's *The Best and the Brightest* in the *New York Times Book Review* section in November, 1972.

Both drew on the imagery evoked by egg heads. One was triumphant; the other, crushing. The first

was of a confidently smiling President Kennedy holding an open egg carton balanced in the palm of his hand, as for delivery by a waiter. The eggs – all intact – were likenesses of Bundy, McNamara, Rusk, et al, represented in the early stages of the war in Vietnam.

The second panel presented a rueful President Johnson offering the same carton with all the eggs smashed and spilling onto his hand.

Other illustrators have used the egg again and again to symbolize "just hatched" events for open house, new business. The most dramatic of these was a full-page egg, cracking open at the top and leading the reader's eye directly to a slender block of copy. It read:

> To begin with. . .we're not cracked, nor worn, nor torn, nor used. We are, quite simply, about to hatch a stunningly different full-service department store. Not one little bit like the every-city-has-to-have (yawn)-at least one-and-(ho, hum)-we're-it kind of department store. Come to Eastridge, San Jose for our gala opening. . .We'll show you not only every thing you, your family and your home need for The Good Life, California Style. . .but you'll also discover the most unabashed, barefaced patron-pampering in the West. . .Eggs-actly.
>
> LIBERTY HOUSE

THE RENT EGG

In the Middle Ages peasants paid part of their rent in eggs. Along with grapes, or mustard or wine, eggs were a recognized medium of exchange.

A man with a wife and two children and two small parcels of land might expect to hand over an ox for each holding and three pullets and 15 eggs. The rest of the rent he paid off in service.

THE COMPARISON EGG

Eggs are often the writer's refuge when he is trying to make it clear how big a thing is or what it looks like. Everybody knows what an egg looks like and how big it is.

A New York newspaper carried a story about a diamond worth $11.7 million and headlined the item "Diamond the Size of a Hen's Egg."

"The 2½ inch long and 1½ inch wide stone is the size of a hen's egg and weighs almost half a pound," read the article.

Found in the little West African Republic of Sierra Leone, the egg-size diamond was promptly christened, "The Star of Sierra Leone." The president promised to keep the "star" intact. This qualified the stone as the world's largest extant diamond.

Now you know how big the biggest diamond in the world is – the size of a hen's egg. Or was. The government broke its resolve, and the diamond as well, to fill its coffers.



THE JOB HUNTING EGG

Instead of building a better mousetrap, a former Bostonian tried a less trite approach. She built herself an heroic papier mâché eggshell which she could put on over her head.

Nineteen, blonde, a stranger in San Francisco, and out of work for three weeks, she had no luck until she put on her eggshell. She plastered it like a sandwich board with slogans and requests for work and staked out a corner on the Wall Street of the West.

There a TV reporter found her waiting for job offers to come.

"How many job offers have you had?" he asked.

"About 15 to 30," she said.

"Are any offers promising? What kind of jobs are they?"

"Modeling, acting, typing." She shrugged off that last offer as well as one for gardening.

"Have you had some offers that weren't for jobs?"

She had indeed, but she was going to egg on until the right offer came.

COMMON EGGS-RECORDS, FACTS



WHICH CAME FIRST?

St. Thomas Aquinas, the "Angelic Doctor" of the 13th Century, arbitrarily settled the question of which came first, the hen or the egg.

"Every imperfect thing must needs be preceded by some perfect thing," he pronounced, "for seed is from some animal or plant."

Contemporary biologists are now offering their answers to the chicken-egg question. Laboratory-created proteins and cells, they say, suggest an evolutionary route first life forms could have taken.

It appears that the sequence of events makes it rather meaningless to ask which came first, the chicken or the egg. Hatching females, they point out, already contain in their bodies the germs of more eggs than they will ever lay.

Whatever they discover about the inside of an egg, egg history has already accumulated more facts and happenings than you and I can assimilate in years. Our ancestors ate eggs heartily and left proof in recipes and provision lists. Eggs have been the subject of endless studies of their measurements, color range, food value, availability in the wild; their fads, fragility and production problems. They have brightened the pages of newspapers with antics.

& CURIOSITIES





EGG FEASTS

Burdens of hosting in early times fell to those who could afford, or at least command, the requisites for Gargantuan affairs. Lists of provisions included eggs by the thousands.

The installation of Ralph, Abbot of Canterbury, in 1309 brought 6,000 celebrants to a feast. They ate 9,600 eggs among other things.

In 1577 when Lord North entertained the queen for two days on his estate at Kirtling, his guest and her escort, according to the lord's household records, consumed 2,522 eggs as well as 10,000 loaves of bread, 12 steers, 67 sheep and much more.

It boggles the mind to think about how these thousands of eggs were gathered, stored and cooked in times when food products were processed individually and by hand. How large were the flocks? How many tended them and gathered eggs? How and where were eggs stored for use?

We do have some idea to what use they put eggs. Thanks to Hannah Glasse who claimed to make cooking "plain and easy" in the 18th Century, we have an old recipe for a "grand sallet" egg.

Without specifying how many eggs to use – just quantities of yolks and quantities of whites – she tells how to make an egg twenty times normal size.

Separate yolks from whites and strain through a sieve, she instructs. Tie yolks in a bladder in ball shape and hard boil them. Put this balled yolk into a second bladder with the whites around it and tie up in oval shape and put back to boiling. The result is a giant egg which becomes a centerpiece for a grand salad.

This delight in monstrous size was not peculiar to these times only. In 1969, a 13,000-egg omelette was displayed as a work of art in a Swiss department store.

In 1972, it was reported from Lugo, Spain, that the Suso Bar had made the biggest Spanish omelette in history. It required 20 men to turn it over. It weighed 823 pounds and contained 550 pounds of potatoes, 44 pounds of onions, 22 pounds of sausage, 60 quarts of olive oil and 40 dozen eggs. To eat it, 5,000 citizens assembled on a river bank outside of town.

RECORD EGGS

In recent times, egg activities have been recorded in the *Guinness Book of World Records*, Britain's compendium of superlatives. Specifically noted are egg throwing contests, egg sizes, egg eating records for boiled and raw eggs, and champion hens.

Egg Throwing Contests

At an American League game between the Texas Rangers and the Oakland A's, a crowd of 22,502 celebrated Farmers' Day with rustic competitions.

Catfish Hunter was named champion hog caller. Horacio Pina won the milking contest. The Texas team of Frank Howard and Tobie Harrah won the egg throwing contest. The winning pitcher, using a soft-ball technique, provided a nice clean catch for his receiver. The record for the day was 91 feet, for an intact egg, but not record-breaking.

Guinness reports that the greatest distance which a fresh hen's egg has been thrown and caught unbroken is 190 feet, 10 inches. Dale Tegg of Pakuranga College in Auckland, New Zealand, performed.

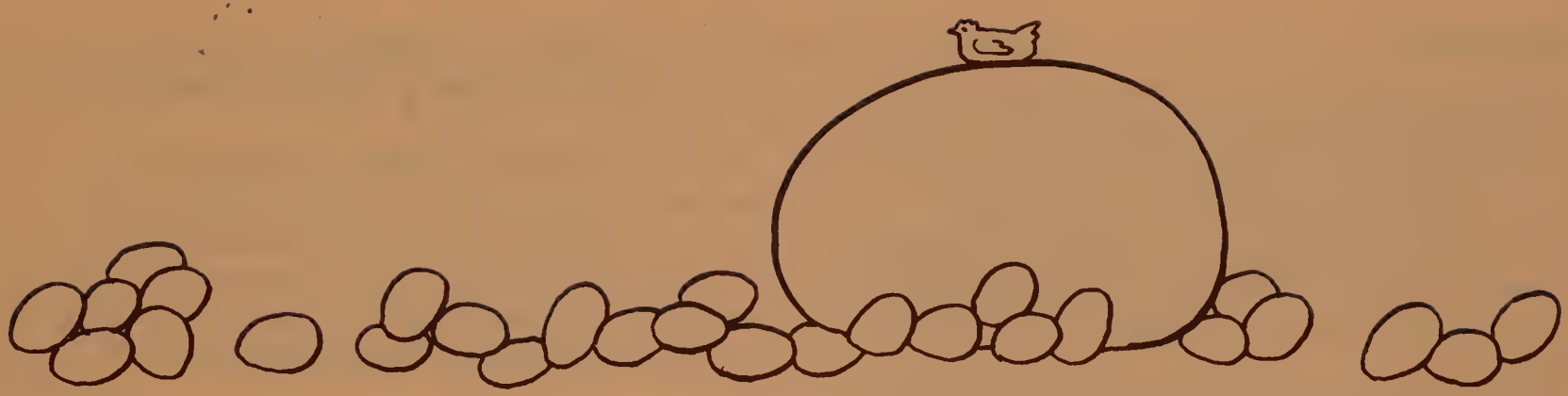
The Big Eggs

The largest egg ever found was more than twice the size of a man's head and said to be a million years old. In 1971, it brought $2400. Its proud owner mounted it like a jewel on black velvet and displayed it under a glass bell.

The largest eggs ever known were those of the extinct Aepyornis. They were 13 inches long, 9½ inches wide and held as much as two gallons of liquid. You could break six ostrich eggs or 150 hens' eggs into one of them.

The extinct moa of New Zealand laid an egg two times bigger than the ostrich egg. The moa was such a big bird, it could kill a horse with one blow of its foot.

The largest eggs of living birds are laid by the North African ostrich. Its average egg weighs 3.63



to 3.88 pounds and is 6 – 7 inches long. In girth it measures 4 – 6 inches. It holds three quarts and is edible. Boiling time is more than a half hour. Shells are 1/16 inch thick and can support a man's weight. A naturalist once amused himself by breaking hens' eggs into empty ostrich eggshells and found they accommodated up to 18.

The smallest eggs are those of hummingbirds and they look like pearls.

The Winner and Champion!

Hens' eggs have a considerable range in size. The average hen's egg weighs 2½ ounces. The record small hen's egg weighed only 1/25 of an ounce. A white Leghorn, after producing normal-size eggs, laid one weighing 11 ounces – five times bigger than normal.

Competitive hens around the world have laid claim to heavyweight egg championships. According to Guinness the championship is safe in the possession of a Vineland, New Jersey, Leghorn that laid a 16-ounce egg with a double yolk and double shell.

The Best Biddies

The highest authenticated rate of egg laying is 361 eggs in 364 days. The winner was a Black Orpington. The test was official. The place was New Zealand in 1930. Naturally she was a princess, Te Kawau Princess.

Possibly you know that hens earn R.O.P. degrees – Record of Performance. To earn this distinction, a hen must lay at least 200 eggs her first year. Her eggs must average at least 24 ounces to a dozen.

The average United States hen lays only 115 a year. At Egg City near Los Angeles where hens are taken very seriously, 2 million Leghorns ply their trade. As soon as they are discovered via computer to be underachievers, they are consigned to soup and potpies. Every hen in this day and age must fill a quota or fill a pot.

Statistical Eggs

Egg production figures in the United States, according to the Economic Research Service, USDA, show California leading with 8,728 million eggs in 1971. Georgia is next with 5,532 million; then Pennsylvania, North Carolina, Arkansas and Indiana in order. The grand total in 1971 was 71,644 million eggs. Gross income from farm eggs was close to $2 billion.

The average consumption of eggs per person in 1971 was 322.

SPECIFICATIONS FOR PERFECTION

"I think if required on pain of death to name instantly the most perfect thing in the universe, I should risk my fate on a bird's egg," said 19th Century author T.W. Higginson. He was speaking of a package which he deemed had a purpose in every element of its design – whether you considered its shape, size, color or the number of eggs in a clutch.

The shape gives it strength. Eggs can support comparatively great weight on their convex surfaces before breaking. It takes 9 lbs. piled on a fowl's egg to break it; 13 lbs. on a turkey egg; 26 lbs. on a swan's egg; 120 lbs. on an ostrich egg. Shape also assures stability, that the eggs will not roll around in nests and other places birds lay them.

Size of clutch is an insurance factor. Where eggs are safe, one egg is enough. Insecure ground nesters lay as many as 12 or more.

The barnyard hen, the result of 3,000 years of breeding by man, is the most prolific. She lays an egg almost daily. A good hen will produce 300 in a year and 3,000 in a lifetime. Her ancestor, the Asian jungle fowl, laid only 30 or 40 a year and she was only half the size of our domesticated hen.

SERVICEABLE COLOR

Coloration of eggs bears no relation to coloration of the bird which lays it. It does have a more or less direct relationship to the environment. Eggs deposited in exposed places usually have protective colors. Shell hue more or less harmonizes with the ground on which the egg is laid.

Eggs of the tern sometimes look like the stones or spotted pebbles lying near them on the beach. The ringed plover's egg has the same general coloring as the sand on which it lies. It is spotted with black dots. This gives the effect of tiny shadows and makes it difficult to see.

Color is not only camouflage. It enhances visibility. Eggs in dark nests or holes are conspicuously white so the bird can see them. Pigeons always lay white eggs.

Naturalists think eggs may be glossy white or

light colored in order to reflect the sun and guard the embryo against overheating.

IF YOU ARE EVER LOST IN THE WOODS. . .

Most of the approximately 9,000 bird species have distinctively marked or colored eggs. If you are ever lost in the woods, it might be well to remember the following facts about coloring in birds' eggs.

Bold-colored eggs are often foul tasting. Naturalists tested eggs of 134 species of birds. They listed 70 distinct flavors, including sweet, salty, sour, nutty, mealy, bitter, aromatic, acrid, earthy, fishy and mildewy. They drew two general rules. The bigger the egg, the better it tasted. Eggs with drab colorings or markings were the most appetizing. The large four-inch crane eggs were tasty, as were gulls' eggs.

Unforgettably foul egg flavors were invariably connected with color you couldn't easily forget. Nasty eggs were usually immaculately white or white spotted with red or brown.

Puffins, linnets and wrens have unpleasant tasting eggs, the worst being the wren's which is also one of the most beautiful. Walt Whitman probably never ate a wren's egg or he could not have rhapsodized, "The leaf of grass is no less than the journey work of the stars, and the ant is equally perfect, and the grain of sand, and the egg of the wren."

THE EGGS WE EAT

Naturally we think of hens' eggs when we speak about eating eggs. But there are other egg birds who feed man. Acceptable egg providers are ducks, lapwings, geese, partridges, turkeys, guinea fowl, pigeons, pheasants, peacocks, gulls, plovers, ringdoves, flamingos and ostriches.

Ordinarily ostrich eggs are considered too valuable for hatching to use as table food. In France, lapwing and plover eggs are prized for their rarity, not their taste. Bigger than pigeons' eggs, they appear on the French market in early spring and fetch a high price. It is usual to serve them hard-boiled as hors d'oeuvres. Larousse's *Encyclopedia of Food, Wine and Cookery* offers a half dozen recipes for both lapwing and plover eggs and suggests they also apply to other birds' eggs including pigeon and ringdove. For an omelette made with flamingo eggs, you might check the works of Alexander Dumas who was said to have one.

To the Chinese, quail and pigeon eggs, canned and fresh, are delicacies. And at the 2500th anniversary banquet in Iran, the menu featured quail eggs stuffed with caviar.

In the West Indies, people eat eggs of the sooty tern.

In the Falkland Islands of the South Atlantic, you can have fried albatross eggs or a mutton stew and a penguin egg omelette.

Egg Collecting in the Falklands

From an early date, whalers and sealers depended on eggs from the huge colonies of penguins in the Falklands. Edmund Fanning, one of the first sealers to work the islands in the late 18th Century, described how to preserve the eggs by immersing them in seal oil and storing them in wooden casks. These eggs were valuable items for sailors' diets, and crews of whaling vessels struck up a business collecting, storing and selling great quantities of both penguin and albatross eggs to visiting ships.

Collection of penguin, albatross and other wild bird eggs became a traditional activity. Early settlers also recognized them as important to their diet and took steps to protect the birds. When a merchant who dealt in penguin oil threatened to exterminate the rookeries, Falklanders enacted laws in 1862 to protect the birds that "provided eggs so necessary to the health and comfort of the inhabitants."

Traditionally Falklanders opened activities with an "egging picnic." One collection brought 13,000 eggs from a little more than a mile of cliffs.

The activity was institutionalized as "Egging Week" for children and led to the disappearance of one rookery after another. Still observed each year, though now under license, collections between 1965 and 1970 netted about 40,000 eggs a year, discounting possible illegal collections. The custom is now less popular than it was, and egg eating is no longer considered so important to Falkland's diet.

FOOD FOR THE GODS

The Australians say that when you have tasted a cake made with one emu egg, you really know the meaning of the word "rich." One emu egg is equal to 12 hens' eggs. These eggs are said to be delicious scrambled, and if you like eggs boiled, you have to wait for them a half hour and keep turning them in the water.

A medium size egg weighs about one and a half pounds. Australian horsemen who find nests and have no way to carry eggs home, doff their shirts, tie up the ends of their sleeves and fill them with eggs. Then they put a sleeve on each side of the saddle and ride home.

There are many ways to tell whether emu eggs are fresh. In any case, they keep for nine months or more. Smear fat or wax on them and you can keep them for years. To test their freshness, bushmen spin them. This art must require the talents of an expert juggler with big hands, or splat!

Take three eggs, place them end to end atop each other and hold top and bottom eggs in your hands. The pressure holds the center egg fast. If it



does not move, it has had its day. It it starts to spin around, it is fresh. Prepare to enjoy it.

DEATH DEFYING CLIFF HANGERS

The Faroese in the North Atlantic eat auk eggs. Amid falling rocks, whistling winds, and with crashing surf hundreds of feet below them, men risk their lives to raid auk nests. First comes a dizzying ride in a rope swing down sheer cliffs to slippery ledges. Friends, manning tarred ropes, watch as raiders gather eggs in sheepskin bags, then haul them back.

Preserved, the eggs appear again as special treats on winter tables. A nine-day egging season in early June allows the birds to produce another egg and keep the auk colony going. For centuries the isolated Faroese have included these eggs in their diet.

BROWN IS BEAUTIFUL

The preference humans have for brown or white eggs reflects a cluster of contradictions, superstitions, and differing values.

Many health food fanciers will buy only brown eggs, believing them to be more wholesome than white eggs.

Bostonians and Nova Scotians prefer brown eggs. But New Yorkers prefer white ones. So do the people of Saskatoon who associate brownness with staleness and pay 5¢ a dozen less for their brown eggs.

"Brown eggs are beautiful!" rhapsodized J.B. Priestley. The English prefer them. In America, Priestley says, they are despised and sold off cheaply, perhaps even thrown away.

To him, brown eggs have the look of reliable rusticity. They are close to nature and promise a rich, sustaining interior. They symbolize the hope of moving to the country from the wretched towns.

Americans, alas, want white eggs, those paragons of hygiene and purity which have all the charm of escapees from a factory. As soon as Americans can package and market guaranteed egg substitutes, charges Priestley, especially substitutes labeled "Old Mother Giles," they will despise real white eggs more heartily than they now despise brown eggs.

Rhetoric aside, Montagu Ashley and Edward Darling point to the facts that poultrymen prefer hens that produce white-shelled eggs and egg graders persist in eliminating brown-shelled eggs. It is a matter of economics. Buyers for markets want only white eggs because, they say, housewives want only white eggs.



The "In" Egg

Just as white bread overcame black and brown breads and became a status symbol, the white egg is "in." Many consumers equate whiteness with cleanliness and freshness. They even think white eggs are more nutritious.

The truth of the matter is that zoologists find no unvarying relationship between the color of the shell and the content of the hen's egg. An egg, no matter what its outward appearance, is an egg and its eggness is not affected by the shell color. A white one is as good as a brown one, in taste and nutritional value.

The Hen Decides

Shell color is determined by the breed of the hen and does not affect the grade or cooking performance of an egg. Leghorns and Minorcas lay white-shelled eggs. Most other hens lay brown-shelled eggs.

Ah, but there is a flamboyant South American Arachuna which attends to egg laying as if guided by a color wheel.

About 20 years ago, the Toronto Royal Winter Fair reported an 80-year-old gentleman who had bred a flock of 100 which laid only blue eggs. He had started 16 years earlier with a pair of Arachunas from Chile. When the hen died, he crossed the cock with a variety of breeds. As a result his hens laid eggs fit for an Easter basket – red, khaki, olive green, grey, chocolate and light green. He finally arrived at the blues in 1954. These he sold for $2 each or $20 a dozen.

Your Choice of 15 Colors!

Other Canadians have been enchanted with these colorful South Americans. In Fawn, British Columbia, Mrs. Gollnick brought a clutch of green and blue-green eggs to the Kamloops *Daily Sentinel* on St. Patrick's Day one year, not so much to honor the saint as to show what her hens were doing.

The hens were a motley crew, predominantly red, grey and black, and black with white breasts and hackled. They laid eggs in 15 different colors. A hardy breed, they provided food richer than other eggs.

"It is like having milk from a Guernsey instead of a Holstein," the owner claimed.

The Greening of the Henhouse

In Wyantskill, New York, an errant hen in a flock of Leghorns, Plymouth Rocks and Rhode Island Reds was reported to be laying green eggs. The owner of the flock spent hours trying to scrub the color off. When this failed, she called the county farm bureau agent who was equally at a loss to explain the phenomenon.

"They are real eggs," the lady insisted, "but I am not taking any chances on opening or eating them!"

In Massachusetts a Polish couple purchased two black hens from a man whose name slipped their minds. Their hens were industriously laying pale green eggs, which the couple piled up in the refrigerator pending identification.

"I don't know what to think," the good wife said and added hopefully, "Maybe my geese will lay some golden eggs!"

Even Mr. Priestley's England suffered from the mystery of green eggs. They were laid by the thousands and had green and khaki yolks that turned black when boiled.

Farmers were losing 10¢ a dozen on these off beat eggs and were obliged to sell them to caterers for baking purposes.

Scientists, instructed by the Ministry of Agriculture to put their heads together on the matter, pondered whether there was any basis to talk that the hens were eating too much green grass or shepherd's purse or pennycress.

The affair of the green eggs may still be unsolved. We only know for certain that excessive diets of onion bulbs and tops spoil egg flavor; lack of green food results in pale yolks; and deficiency of lime produces soft or thin shells. Otherwise, what makes hens lay green shelled eggs is a well guarded secret.

FOR GOODNESS' SAKE!

When I was growing up, our family survived the local gas company's annual demonstration cooking school. For one solid week, Mother dressed in her Sunday best and disappeared to attend sessions downtown at the Palace Theatre. She was phenomenally lucky and often returned bearing a door prize of a concoction straight out of a magazine illustration – still whole despite a trip home on the streetcar.

She returned also with ideas which she delivered like fiats. One of these was: Everybody must have at least one egg a day. And when I left home for my first job, this fiat was a parting reminder, along with a brief encomium on the equal virtues of hot oatmeal.

You can get the same advice today from the "first lady of nutrition." If you want to keep the doctor away, she advises, eat an egg a day instead of an apple. An old-fashioned egg – cholesterol and all.

At Harvard, a professor of nutrition is telling us that babies, small children, females between the ages of 10 and 55, and the elderly consume iron substantially below recommended dietary allowances. "Eat eggs," he says. "They are rich in this mineral."

A doctor at the University of Nebraska seconds this observation. There is no reason for healthy people to drop eggs from their meals simply because eggs contain some cholesterol. "Their protein has the highest biological value of any natural protein," he says. "Two eggs a day will satisfy 25 percent of an individual's daily protein requirement."

If you are an avid reader of puffs on cereal boxes and egg cartons you may already have the following information. This one comes from a dozen "ranch fresh eggs, Large Grade AA:"

> Egg protein is the most nutritious protein known. Eggs are also rich in vitamins A,D, E,K,B6,B12 and Thiamine (B1), Riboflavin (B2) and Niacin. Many minerals are found in eggs, such as calcium, iron, iodine, and phosphorus. Even with all these nutrients a large egg contains only 80-85 calories. Eggs are thus useful for people who must watch their weight. Eggs give you a satisfied feeling and sticks (sic) with you. Eggs do not load you down with calories.
>
> FOR GOODNESS SAKE EAT MORE EGGS!

OOLOGICAL NUTRIPHILES AND GASTROPHILES

A food with such distinguished credentials was bound to attract faddists. As a result, the egg has starred in fad-type reducing diets.

Many favored the egg diet since it was less expensive than one that required lamb chops, pineapple and lettuce leaves. Dieters ate eggs thrice daily to the exclusion of all else. The number of eggs varied. One diet specified nine eggs a day and probably had a slimming result simply because it was so boring it discouraged eating.

A "food fitting" has recently been the rage among nutriphiles who can afford it. A diet consultant devises a personal fitting for them at a cost of $50. One client described as a socialite explained why she felt a lot healthier, trimmer and more energetic. "For breakfast, I have a shake created especially for me," she said. "I put non-pasteurized milk, banana, orange juice, and a whole raw egg, shell and all, in my blender. The eggshell makes the shake a little sandy on the bottom, but it's a good way to get calcium."

Another food buff, identified as a decorator, recommended the same breakfast, except that she put in half-and-half instead of raw milk. "Of course I use the eggshell: it's the most nourishing part of the egg."

The Whole Organic Egg!

A dedicated nutriphile goes much farther. He says eggshell calcium, as found in fertile eggs, is a bonus. According to him, organic eggs are never washed with detergents and the shells are therefore safe to eat for calcium supplements. Simply drop the whole egg, washed only in cold water, into a blender and pulverize the shell.

Another whole egg method is to soak a bowlful of eggs in lemon juice or vinegar until the shells dissolve into the acid medium, leaving the eggs encased only in the intact membrane. Use these eggs as usual. Use the acid medium containing the dissolved shells as needed, by the spoonful in water before or during meals to aid digestion, or in salad dressings.

All this assumes that the fresh eggs are free of contamination of any sort.

PROBLEM EGGS

A couple of years ago, 29 sixth graders in a San Francisco Bay Area school put their minds to a problem: how to package raw eggs so that you can drop them from a height of 50 feet without breaking them.

Ground rules forbade boiling the eggs or discussing the project with fellow students. The local fire department agreed to supply a snorkel ladder.

While the rest of the school screamed encouragement from the sidelines, the teacher rose in the snorkel ladder to drop the eggs five stories down.

Sixteen eggs returned to earth intact.

Neither money spent nor time expended were success factors. A girl who soaked eggs in vinegar for 100 hours found them scrambled by the fall, as did a boy who spent $3.23 on padding.

Successful solutions resulted from insulating eggs with styrofoam, pillows and jello. One student packed eggs in foam rubber and attached a parachute. Another insulated eggs in paraffin with success.

Meanwhile in England, scientists were pondering how to prevent eggs breaking. They were working on a quite different approach. They were planning to breed hens with shorter legs on the assumption that eggs laid by short-legged hens wouldn't have so far to fall and would be less likely to crack.

Some Hens Have It

Another research goal is to produce harder eggshells and devise better transportation equipment for eggs. It has been established that some hens produce better shells than others. Scientists hope to build this information into breeding programs that will produce better birds that lay better shells.

Researchers have also measured stresses and strains on eggs from the minute they are dropped in the laying cage until they are picked up by the housewife in the market. Special equipment, produced as test precision instruments, has tested relative strength of eggshells. Breaking points range from 2,500 to 4,500 grams.

These are not frivolous concerns. Breakage losses from automated packing devices run to 336 million eggs a year. This represents a loss of $5 million. As a result, mathematicians, chemists, agriculturists and electronic engineers have been applying their knowledge to the task of producing more durable packages for eggs.

Rough Rider Egg

USDA scientists have developed an electronic egg which rides along the packing assembly line just like a regular egg. Equipped with a radio transmitter, the rough rider monitors packing devices, tells plant officials the minute the ride is too rough and pinpoints where breakage may occur. They are counting on this rough rider to help them reduce losses.

Neither Rain, Nor Hail. . .

Results are not in on an informal test of one egg's durability. Under the headline "Wrap It Grade A, Whomp it Fragile" we learned about a postal egg.

Complete with postage stamp and address but bare as the day it was laid and without a return address, an egg turned up in a collection box. Since the mail must go through, postal clerks wrapped the egg and sent it to its destination!

LIGHTING THE WAY TO MORE EGGS

The proper sort of chicken is having a bad time trying to live out her days without being probed, poked and manipulated.

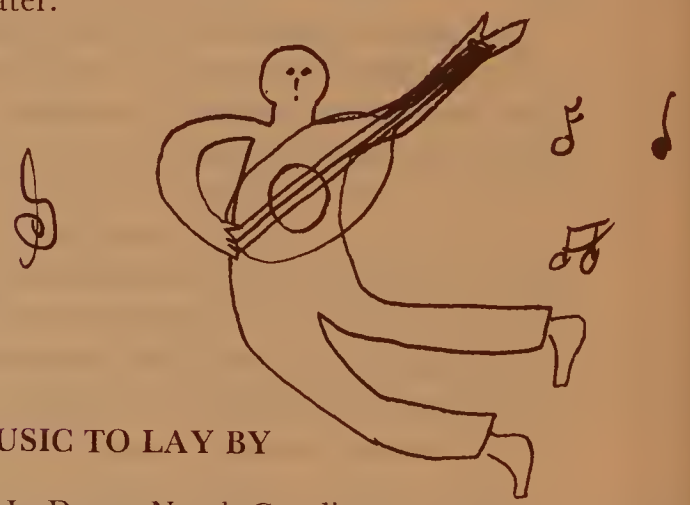
A nefarious scheme was long ago afoot in the USDA to fool daylighting hens by artificially stretching their work day.

You can fool them three ways:

Morning lighting. Start your hens' working day by turning on the lights 2 to 5 hours before daybreak, depending on the time of sunrise and the hours of daylight in your area.

Evening lighting. Prolong your hens' working day by turning on the lights at sundown. Dim them for a few minutes before you turn them off at the end of a 12 – 14 hour period of light. Give your hens a chance to find their way to their perches before you turn the lights off.

All night lighting. Your hens will stay up later and start their day earlier, if you turn low-wattage lamps on at dusk and turn them off at dawn. This gives hens just enough light to see their feed and water.



MUSIC TO LAY BY

In Dunn, North Carolina, a country music radio station discovered farmers in the area were piping their music into henhouses. The music, they insisted, made the hens lay more eggs.

THE SCIENCE AND MENTAL HEALTH HENS

Scientists at a Minnesota research station have looked into the social significance of the barnyard fowl. They discovered that hens have their own social scale, complete with dowagers, climbers and johnny-come-latelys.

Ranking members of the Hen Four Hundred, they pointed out, are jealous of the position they have gained and held by sheer pecking power.

Among laying hens, the clucking society leaders have first choice in feeding, watering and nesting.

All this is so important to a hen that she will stop laying eggs while a newcomer's status is being settled. Taking the hint, scientific poultrymen begin early to house their future layers in permanent flocks. This makes it clear what the social scale is, well before the hens begin producing. The result is fewer neurotic hens, more eggs.

THE AGRI-BUSINESS EGG

After all its high adventures as symbol and magic, as work of art and handcraft; after its inspired role in literature, language and religion; and after its lively participation in science, folklore and the daily life of the common man on the farm and in the towns, the egg has graduated to the big time.

It carries a portfolio of amazing economic data. Computers compute it. Professionals of all kinds swarm around it. Scientists hover over it. And the ultimate competition — the no-egg egg — threatens in the future.

This revolution began long, long ago with the first simple attempts to bypass the setting hen. According to Diodorus, a historian of the 1st Century, B.C., the Egyptians were hatching eggs artificially in heat produced by manure. About 1850 years later the exhuberant Americans invented the Eccaleobion, an automatic egg-hatching machine. Forced mass production of eggs as an industry, however, did not develop until relatively late.

"It is a striking phenomenon of history that although the egg is one of the oldest human foods," E. Parmalee Prentice pointed out, "the business of producing eggs on a large scale is hardly older than the manufacture of motor cars and radios."

The Industrial Egg

Raising eggs today is highly concentrated and industrialized. Economic factors have forced centralization of the poultry business into fewer, bigger hands.

Ever since World War II, egg production has been moving away from the farm into giant egg factories. The Middle West which once dominated the market has been overtaken by the South and the Pacific Coast. The average size of a Pacific Coast flock is 18,000; in the Middle West, 550.

About ten years ago, there were 102 flocks of 50,000 or more in the South Atlantic region and 112 flocks of that size in the South Central area. In operations that size, losses that can be measured in pennies per dozen are disastrous.

Supply and Demand Problem

A typical egg ranch loss can be as much as $100,000 in a year, this despite increased efficiency and as great as a 40 percent cut in the cost of producing a dozen eggs in the last 30 years.

PRESCRIPTION EGGS



From time immemorial, the egg has been a component of remedies for man's major illnesses and minor disabilities. The medical list for which the egg added its curative uses stretched from burns, cuts, sprains and inflamed eyes, to fevers, poisonings, constipation, consumption and jaundice, to name a few. And how many millions, by now, have convalesced on bland diets made nourishing with fresh eggs!

IS THERE AN EGG IN THE HOUSE?

When I was just old enough to walk but still too young to cope with fire, I reached into an open stove grate. The beautiful glowing coals in the baby hand destroyed forever any wish to play with fire and brought my young mother flying. What with my screams and her wails, the small neighborhood woke to the accident.

There were no telephones in every home then, and few doctors, if any, to call. Every mother had to meet emergencies with her wits and what she could find in the kitchen. Neighbors pooled experience. Luckily one of these was Tommy Turner's mother.

Seeing what had happened, she went immediately into action. She found her remedy in the kitchen. It was the white of an egg.

So, thanks to an egg, I grew up with hands unscarred.

WHAT DOES THE DOCTOR BOOK SAY?

Many households in early days had at least two volumes – the Holy Bible and a "doctor book."

Our doctor book, as near as I can remember, was off limits and formidably large any way. It had a green buckram cover and must have weighed five pounds. It finally gave in and took on the air of a broken down friend who had seen better days. It was well used.

I am certain it was not Dr. Chase's monumental receipt book – *Third, Last and Complete Receipt Book and Household Physician or Practical Knowledge for the People. . .In Fact, The Book for the Millions,* published in 1910. Gospel in its day, the book supplied remedies and recipes for saloon keepers, bakers, cooks, painters and others. And it had advice galore about home medicine.

If Mrs. Turner had consulted Dr. Chase, she would have found that his salve for burns was like her own – white of an egg, a tablespoon of lard all beaten together until a little water separated from the mix.

Among his other egg receipts were antidotes for poison, a salve for fever sores and cuts, eye washes, stimulants in low fevers, drinks for jaundice, a cure for consumption. He offered all his remedies with the chatty details one expects of a doctor with unexcelled bedside manner.

The Egg Chaser

An antidote for poison, rattles on like a personal experience, because that is what it was.

First he advised the quickest emetic known – a horrendous mixture of salt and ground mustard in water. It was to be drunk immediately it became known that a poison had been swallowed. "It should vomit in one minute," he said. "Then give the whites of two or three eggs in a cup or two of the strongest coffee. If no coffee, swallow the egg in sweet cream; and if no cream, sweet milk; if neither, down with the egg!"

Salves and Soothing Preparations

A salve for fever sores and cuts Dr. Chase concocted from spirits of turpentine and honey simmered over a slow fire. Then it was set to cool until a yolk of an egg could be added without being cooked by the heat. The mix was returned to the fire, camphor gum added and the whole simmered until well mixed and ready to use.

His eye wash contained among other ingredients the whites of two eggs and 32 ounces of soft water. A Mrs. Johnson of Wayne County, Michigan, who bought his 865-page tome made successful commercial use of the preparation for several years. "Had I not already had it in my book," said Dr. Chase, "I could not have purchased it from her for less than $5." She was upset that he was taking a source of profit away from her by selling his books with the recipe in her neighborhood.

Another eye preparation was called "Sailor's Eye Preparation." It was a mixture of burned alum and egg whites. It was laid between two cloths and placed on the eyes for relief. Dr. Chase acknowledged his indebtedness to an old Scotch sailor for the remedy. He had enjoyed talking over the sufferings of the sea with the tar who had used the remedy many times in places where nothing else could be obtained.

Stimulating Stimulants

Early day stimulants were indeed invigorating. One was made of the best brandy, cinnamon water and the yolks of two eggs well beaten with loaf sugar and oil of cinnamon. "This makes both eat and drink," remarked Dr. Chase with obvious satisfaction.

It is lamentable that his recipe "Cure for Consumption" should sound so hopeful a note in a day when so many families – my forbears included – could point to at least one member hopelessly ill with the wasting disease. The advice was good, however, as far as it went.

Having seen a piece going the rounds of the news papers, Dr. Chase lauded its good sense. He decided to give everyone a chance to judge for himself whether to give the remedy a trial. He guessed from its style that the original idea had appeared in Hall's *Journal of Health.*

> Eat all that the appetite requires of the most nourishing food, such as fresh beef, lamb, oysters, raw eggs, fruit, vegetables, and three times a day, take a glass of eggnog made as rich as the patient can bear.

The Eternal Problem

Dr. Chase regarded eggs as a sort of last resort in costiveness. In this matter, he could not resist giving fatherly advice about the wisdom of regularity in personal habits.

> When nature calls, at either door,
> Do not attempt to bluff her;
> But haste away, night or day,
> Or health is sure to suffer!

Having delivered this homely lecture and allowing human nature to be perverse, he further prescribed: "Attend to your diet, using milk, roasted apples, and if not dyspeptic, uncooked apples, pears, peaches, etc., at meal time, Yankee Brown Bread or bread made of unbolted (not sifted) wheat, if preferred, and avoiding meat."

Should yours be an obstinate case, the next step was this: Beat a fresh laid egg in a cup of water and drink on rising in the morning, and at each meal for a week to 10 days. Increase the number of eggs to two or three at a time if the stomach will bear them.

Then There Was Soot Coffee

References to "soot coffee" crop up in other early receipt books besides that of Dr. Chase. His was offered as a restorative in cases of typhoid fever and dyspepsia, etc. His soot coffee, he claimed, had cured many cases of the ague after all else had failed! This is how you make it: Scrape soot from a chimney – *not* from stove pipes. Steep 1 tablespoon in 2 cups of water and settle with an egg beaten in a little water as for other coffee. Serve with sugar and cream and take thrice daily with meals.

ANCIENT REFERENCES TO EGGS

Ancient Egyptian pharmacists, we are told, weighed their mint-of-the-mountain-dissolved-in-hippopotamus-oil and crushed-egg-of-the-gabzu-bird with as great care as do their modern counterparts weigh prescription ingredients in today's drugstores.

Avenzoar, the great clinical writer of ancient Arabia, devised a way to wash out the lower bowel, using a goat bladder and tube to introduce a mixture of milk, eggs and gruel. It was the forerunner of the nutrient enema.

> And the ancient Jews devised the first test meals.
>
> The work you have to do to prepare it is worth a thousand denares, ancient instructions read.
>
> Dip an egg a thousand times into cold and a thousand times into warm water until it has shrunk to a size that can be swallowed with one gulp. If the patient is sick, the sickness will stick to the diminutive egg. When the patient excretes the egg, the doctor can see and judge what medicines to give him.

From this, the expression "dip an egg a thousand times into cold and a thousand times into warm water" came to mean "an ounce of prevention is worth a pound of cure."



18TH CENTURY EGG CURES

In 1725 a Tom Jones fussed in a letter, "It seems before ye Doctor proceeds any further, he wants ye operation of Nature, who I am afraid will treat me very roughly, and who I suppose is taking her rounds this sickly time. . .I may suppose I am to wade through Rivers of water gruel, and Chicken Broth strengthened with mollasses with no other support than ye yolks of four poached eggs once a day without bread or salt."

A more famous gruel eater who was doubtless also more grateful was John Randolph, Virginia's Great Irreconcilable. He was so excited by the Missouri debates that he could not eat anything but crackers and gruel for days.

A Killing Cure

A celebrated English widow attributed healing powers to an exotic mess that included eggshells. With it, she hoodwinked all England into believing she had a cure for stone in the bladder.

Anticipating the golden age of advertising, she placed a notice in *Gentlemen's Magazine.* Her ad promised to make her medicine public for a "contribution" of £5,000.

Both the church and the peerage rose to the bait but failed to raise the required amount. A great public clamor followed. Finally an Act of Parliament led to the appointment of an investigating committee of leading English physicians and surgeons. These professionals examined the medicine and unanimously issued a statement that it was indeed useful. It had dissolving powers.

The British Government paid the lady £5,000. She kept her bargain and gave the world her discovery in the London *Gazette,* June 19, 1738.

It was a veritable witch's decoction: Boiled herbs and soap; swine's cresses burned to blackness to disguise them; pills made of wild carrot and burdock seeds; hips and haws reduced to ashes with alicant soap and honey; powder made of roasted eggshells crushed with garden snails in the month of May.

So distinguished a man as Prime Minister, Sir Robert Walpole, took the cure by the pound. Following his death, an autopsy discovered stones in his bladder anyway. It was estimated that this otherwise intelligent man had eaten in the last years of his life 180 pounds of soap, to say nothing of 1,200 gallons of lime water and unknown quantities of roasted eggshells.

FOLK EGG MEDICINE

A more tenuous egg lore has passed down to us by word of mouth. In recent times, both egg cures and egg tabus have made contributions to folk medicine.

Egg curing has been common in Europe and widespread among American Indians. It consisted

of rubbing the nude body of the patient with an uncooked egg.

If the healer was attempting a diagnosis, he broke the egg and examined it afterwards. He observed its shape, any unusual color, and the form of the fertilized spot. From these he determined the nature of the trouble and proceeded to treat the illness.

If the purpose was merely therapeutic – as to relieve a fever – the healer buried the egg in a stream to dissipate the heat drawn earlier from the patient's body. This same cure was often prescribed for those under the spell of the evil eye.

A Chinese home cure for headache is similarly easy to accomplish. Shell a hard-boiled egg, insert a silver coin and apply to the temple. This is said to draw out the poison, proof of which is that the coin becomes black and the egg yolk striated.

Healing in Mexico's Sierra Madre may take the form of diets or regimens prescribed according to the ailment. Illnesses are often classified according to cause – hot or cold – and foods used as treatment are classified in the same way. One of the most far reaching and devastating diets is prescribed for new mothers: no baths for 15 days and no eggs for 20.

In the Sierra Madre, they also believe that eggs eaten after dark cause congestión.

In Madagascar a pregnant woman may not eat white of eggs for fear her child will be born an albino.

Nature's Band-Aid

Closer to home in the Lower Snake River Valley of the Pacific Northwest, the late Mrs. Maggie Keithly Lydston Wheeler Mackey advised: "Peel the soft inside white layer from an eggshell and use it to pull cuts together. It will stick and the cut will heal without a scar."

Mrs. Mayo, a Kansas pioneer, concurred: "There is no better plaster for wounds or cuts than the inside lining of a freshly broken eggshell, if applied immediately."

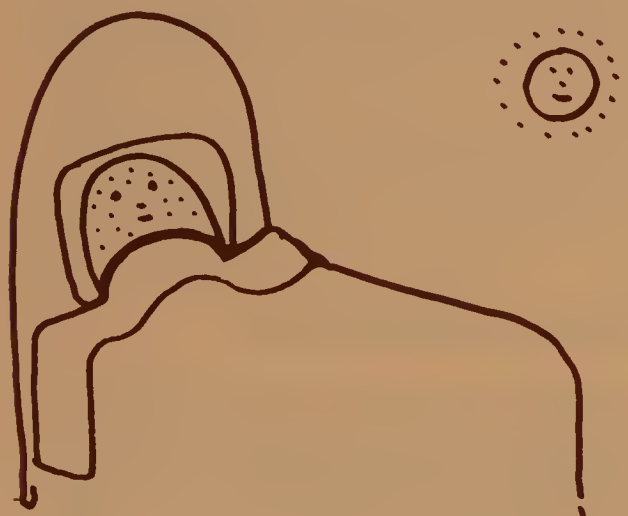
From these examples, one could conclude that an egg in the house was as useful for cuts as for burns.

OTHER MEDICAL RESOURCES

In the opening years of this century, homemakers often found remedies in what we now regard as somewhat unsophisticated ways. Calling doctors and hospitals was the last resort – a step to be taken only after every known home remedy had failed. Housewives made do with advice dispensed by home products manufacturers, trusted writers for newspapers and magazines, and domestic science teachers.

The very professional Rumford Company *Cook Book,* first issued in 1908, included a chapter, "Recipes for the Sick." More than one-third of these recipes required eggs. The Rumford Company produced baking powder.

Such early recipe books were really the woman's home companion and friend in need. They helped her with remedial diets for stomach upset; recipes for caudles and possets to pamper the bedridden; eggnogs and milk punches to strengthen the weak; panadas to restore the will to eat; and potions for just about everything from weak backs to coughs.



For That Upset Stomach

Corn Coffee – recommended as nourishing and stimulating enough to allay a queasy stomach.

First brown nice, sweet dry corn, being careful not to spoil its flavor by burning it; then grind. To 1 cup ground corn add 1 beaten egg. Put in coffeepot and pour boiling water – at least 2 cups or more – over it. Steep. Serve with cream and sugar.

Tonics and Bracers

Eggnog – recommended as palatable for weak and feeble patients as well as invigorating and strengthening because of the tonic virtues of Madeira wine.

Separate 1 egg and beat with 1 tablespoon pulverized sugar until creamy. Grate in a little nutmeg. Add 1 large tablespoon brandy and 2 of Madeira wine. Beat white of egg to stiff froth and mix in with 1 cup sweet milk.

The original recipe for eggnog called for yolks and whites of 16 eggs, 16 tablespoons of loaf sugar pulverized, 1 grated nutmeg, ½ pint good brandy or rum, 2 glasses of Madeira, and 12 cups cold milk. This quantity was apparently made for general or hospital use, or the patient must have expected to live on it for a week!

Or he might have been planning to have many visitors.



Raw Egg and Milk – to be taken by convalescents if they suffer fatigue after exercise. Keep on ice.

Beat yolk of freshly laid egg thoroughly. Add 1 cup milk and continue beating until foamy. Add a little port or other wine and some sugar. Drink as needed.

Milk Punch – recommended for strengthening the very weak, not for encouraging general stimulation.

Dissolve 2 tablespoons sugar in 2 cups of sweet milk. Thoroughly beat a fresh egg and stir into milk. Add 2 tablespoons brandy and stir well. Serve ice cold.

An egg punch, Dr. Chase swore, rescued him from a dire case of typhoid pneumonia. A great argument rose between two attending physicians – a young man and an old fogy, when who should arrive but a Methodist clergyman who saved his life! The remedy: white of an egg beaten with a tablespoon of sugar and wet with a tablespoon of the best brandy.





Raw Egg Teas – to strengthen and restore invalids.

Break fresh egg in a bowl and beat well with 1 or 2 tablespoons sugar. Add a little ice-cold water and tea and 1 tablespoon of spirits. Suitable herbal teas include sage, mint, catnip, pennyroyal, gentian root, chamomile flower, strawberry leaf, blackberry and raspberry leaves.

Egg Lemonade – very grateful in cases of inflammation of lungs, stomach or bowels.

Put white of 1 egg, 1 tablespoon powdered sugar and juice of half a fresh lemon in 1 goblet of water. Beat thoroughly together and serve.

Rice Cream – excellent for the bowels.

Thicken 2 cups of sweet milk with rice flour to the consistency of cream and sweeten and flavor to taste. Add 2 tablespoons plain gelatine to 1 cup cold water. Place over fire until gelatine dissolves. Cool and beat to a froth. Beat whites of 2 eggs to a stiff froth and combine with gelatine, sweeten and flavor with rosewater. Stir into milk and rice flour. Serve.

FUN WITH EGGS

THE UNIVERSAL TOY

Three cheers for the hen's egg. It is plentiful, easily available, and inexpensive. It fits into hands young and old, small, large and medium. It has no sharp corners. Its shell is dyeable, etchable, engravable, blowable, and paintable.

The egg is collectable, too. And, joy of joys, it is rollable! And finally, it is eatable.

Anything with so many attractive assets can naturally provide absorbing and endless activities, not only for the family circle but for the entertainment of party guests from 8 to 80.

Let us consider how many ways there are to have fun with eggs.

The Collectable Egg

For pure motivation, it would be difficult to match the egg hunts of an extinct race of egg worshippers. Theirs was a contest that richly rewarded a winner for his energy and sheer possession. Archeologists tell us they lived in egg shaped huts on Easter Island and the winner of their egg-gathering contest became king!

Nothing so grand results from our simple Easter Egg Hunts, which every participant wins, if he finds any eggs at all. Eggs are hidden in advance in the house or outside. The hunter who finds the largest number wins the grand prize and the rest simply keep what they have found.

The Easter Egg Hunt becomes more interesting and challenging when something more than mere size of collection is the objective. This is how it works.

Dye eggs in various colors and trim baskets to match. Hide eggs indoors and outdoors and instruct each player to gather only eggs that match the trim on his basket. If his basket has yellow ribbons, he collects only yellow eggs; blue ribbons, only blue eggs. Let the children take home the eggs they find.

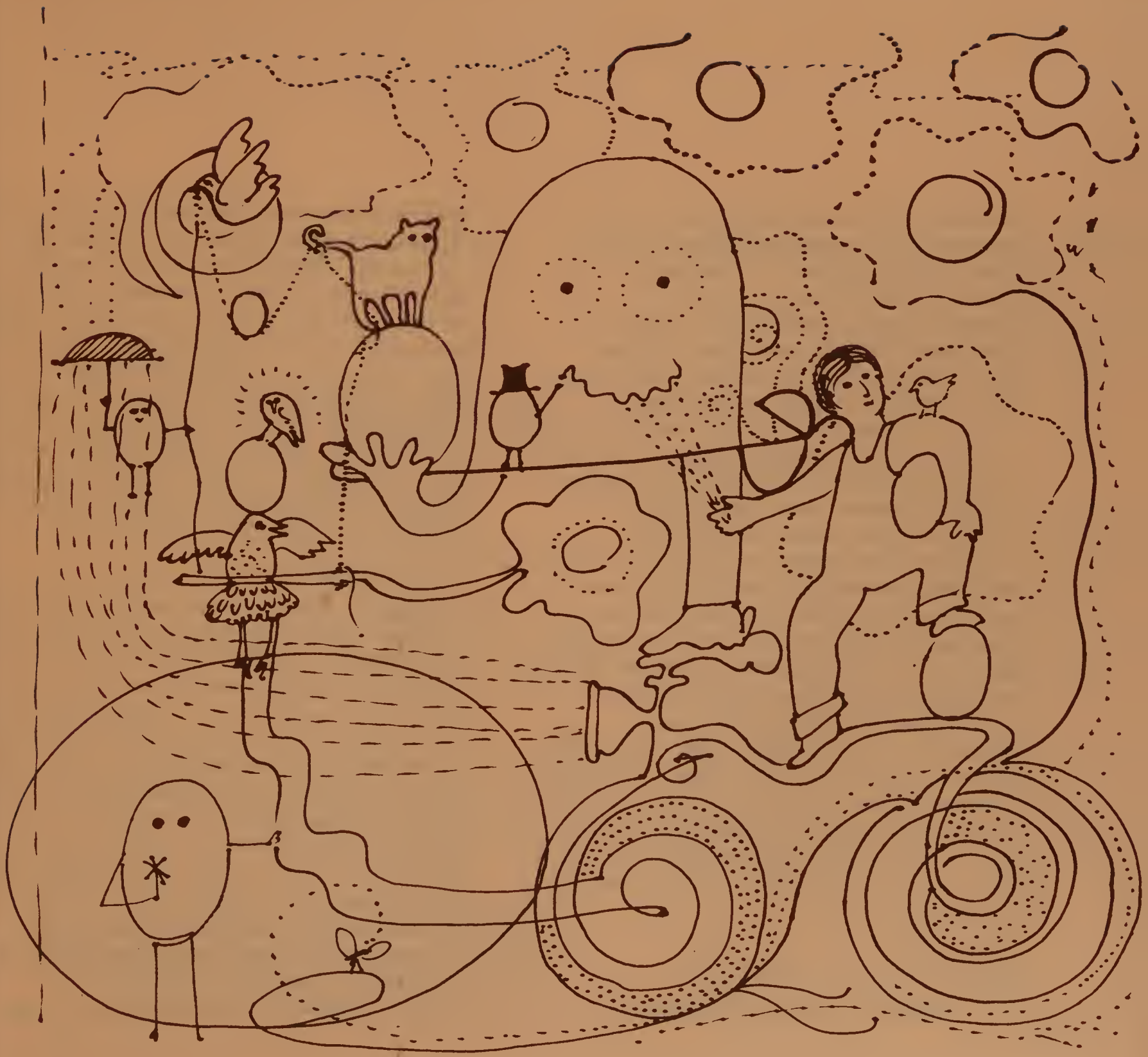
The Team Egg Hunt

A much noisier and rollicking kind of egg hunt is the "Hens and Roosters" game. Players divide into two groups. Each team selects a Hen who receives a basket. Eggs, candy eggs or jelly beans are concealed throughout the house. At a signal, the Hens look for the eggs while the boys crow like roosters and the girls cackle and cluck like hens.

Every player participates in the hunt. When a player finds an egg, he doesn't touch it but crows or clucks until his Hen Leader comes to collect it. If a rival player finds the same egg, both crow and cluck until the Hen who gets there first wins the egg. The team collecting the most eggs wins.

Rollable (and Other) Eggs

The *Egg Roll* is an Easter game best played on a sloping lawn, though there is nothing to prevent its being played indoors. Each player gets a basket of hard-boiled eggs.



One version is to roll each egg with the idea of striking that of another player. The player who strikes another's egg wins it. The object is to strike as many eggs as possible.

Another version of egg rolling is to roll for distance. Players stand at a starting line and apply muscle rolling the eggs with a single ground sweeping cast. The egg that goes the farthest wins.

A more boisterous game is *Egg Football.* Players choose sides and mark a table to resemble a football field. The football is a blown egg. Players may propel it with their breath or by fanning it with a fan, but they may not touch the football.

The game starts with the egg in the center of the field. Only two football players from each team blow at one time. Members of each team may put their heads together and blow simultaneously provided they do not touch the egg. The game starts at the sound of a whistle and is ended the same way at a prearranged time – 5 or 10 minutes.

If, in the contest, the players blow the egg offside, a referee replaces it in the center of the table across from the point where it went out of bounds and the game continues. The object is to blow the egg across the goal line or off the table. Each touchdown scores six points and the team with the highest score wins.

Steady Nerves and a Good Bite Help

The *Egg Relay* is another team game. Players divide into two teams, each with a captain, to start things. Each captain receives a hardboiled egg – only a sadist would use fresh eggs in this game – and each player receives a spoon big enough to hold an egg. Teams line up facing each other, each player with a spoon in his mouth. At a signal, the captain places the egg in his spoon first and transfers it to the next spoon in line without using his hands. And so on down the lines. If an egg falls during a transfer, the player responsible must pick it up with the spoon still held in his mouth, though he may steady the spoon with his hands in this awful operation. The team to complete the relay first wins.

"Questionable" Eggs

Simple guessing games are fun for children. One of these requires only filling an Easter basket with hard-boiled colored hens' eggs, or if you want to make it really difficult, with small, wrapped candy eggs. Ask party guests how many they think the basket holds. At the end of the party, the basket goes to the child whose guess is most nearly accurate.

For grownups, you can pose the question, "Who first made an egg stand on end?" Most will quickly say, "Columbus." Not so. It was Brunelleschi, the great Italian architect. When his critics asked him how he was going to support the great dome for the cathedral at Florence, he stood an egg on end.

Fun for all are egg charades. Four suggestions for these pantomimes come to mind.

The first honeymoon breakfast and no eggs!

Don't put all your eggs in one basket.
He that steals an egg will steal an ox.

Dozens more will occur to you.

Blowable Eggs

In order to play egg football, you have to start with blown eggs. This is fun in itself, especially if you have never blown an egg and think, perhaps, it is even too difficult to try.

It is really very simple.

Wash and dry fresh eggs thoroughly.

Place an egg small end up in an egg cup, or shot glass or return it to the egg carton.

Using a thick, clean darning needle, place it in the center of the top of the egg. Tap gently with a knife handle and force the needle through the shell. Make the hole as big as the thickest part of the needle.

Reverse the egg and repeat the operation on the big end of the shell. Make sure you insert the needle far enough into this end of the egg to puncture the membrane of the air cell. Place your mouth over this hole. blow hard and catch the egg contents in a bowl.

The egg should come out in a small stream. You may have to enlarge the hole at the bottom of the egg if the contents do not pour out easily. The hole doesn't have to be larger than twice the diameter of the needle.

You will hardly notice the holes, once you have decorated the shells. As for the contents of the eggs you have blown out, refrigerate them in a covered bowl and use in a couple of days in soups, cookies, scrambled eggs, breads, sauces, puddings. It would be a good idea to plan ahead as you blow and store the right amount of egg for each recipe in a separate, covered container or bowl.

DYEABLE, EDIBLE EGGS

My Father always abhorred waste. He saved nuts and bolts and usable nails against the day he would find them useful. He often reminded us that when he was a lad, he was lucky to have an orange at Christmastime. Against such a background, I could never feel quite comfortable dyeing Easter Eggs in such a way as not to be able to eat them. And I could not happily give a small child a dyed Easter egg that he could not put in his mouth.

There is no reason, of course, why you should wait for Easter to dye eggs. A beautifully dyed egg brings pleasure at any time and a dyed shell is as good as scented, tinted stationery for conveying a message.



With this in mind, I have had a good deal of fun hard-boiling and dyeing eggs with materials I could find in my kitchen and herb garden. None of my experiments were the least bit scientific, understand, but I was able to eat them afterwards!

Each experiment I made was with two eggs – one I could take from the "dye" immediately the egg was boiled – about 20 minutes – and one I could leave in the liquid over night. And it is well I did, because the differences in end results were measurable. An egg boiled in strong coffee, for example, after 20 minutes has a warm brown shell; left over night, the shell takes on a rich coffee shade. Of all the kitchen dyes, coffee produced the best of the browns.

In each case, I brought the dye bath to a boil, turned the heat back so that the eggs would bubble along gently. I added a teaspoon of vinegar, which is supposed to make the shells less limey and help the color fix. The eggs boiled at least 20 minutes in water to cover. It is important they be totally submerged. Otherwise, an eggshell comes out with an eye-shaped circle on it. These eye shapes are fun, of course, if you are planning to use them as part of your egg decoration.

A number of the shell colors are very beautiful – enough to defy description – except to say that the end products are worthy of the most sophisticated of color connoisseurs.

Don't trust evening or artificial lights to reveal what you have achieved with these dyes. Only in full daylight will you see the real appearance. We have kept eggs several days to see how the dyes hold and they hold very well.

Dye Materials	*Colors Produced*
Walnut shells	Subtle buff or adobe
Red cabbage leaves	Beautiful robin's egg blue
Orange peels	A very tender yellow
Anjou pear peelings	Elegant pale yellow/green
Carrot tops	Smoky yellow/green
Yellow Delicious Apple peelings	Delicate lavendar flecked with soft rust
Onion skins	Handsome orange much loved by the Russians
Spinach	Pinkish and grey/gold buffs
Fresh oregano & mint	Beige
Thyme	Pale greyed yellow/orange, beautiful with eggs dyed in pear peelings

The spinach deserves an added note as a dye material. The eggshell is pale pinkish buff if the egg is removed immediately after the 20-minute boiling. Left over night, the shell takes on a suede soft grey/gold buff color. This is especially handsome with the lavender eggs dyed with cranberries.

Dye Materials You Can Experiment With

Many other materials in the kitchen and garden are open for experiments – Concord grape skins; lemon peel; seeds of dill, celery and cummin; saffron and turmeric; chili powder; violet petals; chrysanthemum leaves and leaves of fennel, sage and yarrow; tansy and dandelions; beets and berries of all kinds.

Cranberries – I used a whole bagful – are very rewarding dyers. An egg pulled out right after boiling had a shell of pale pink lavender, endlessly etched with a dark pink and green net. Left over night in the "stew", the shell came out grey/lavender, etched in blue and with a stippled lace net of pink gold. It was so precious, I hated to crack the shell and eat the egg. This egg was stunning placed with eggs boiled in red cabbage leaves or orange peelings.



Decorating Dyed Eggs

Many of these eggs you dye will be so beautiful you won't want to do anything more than place them in a basket. The ones I boiled in peelings of Yellow Delicious Apples fractured in boiling and this added a special dimension. The delicate cracks looked like river lines on a map and the coloring had the luminescence of marble. For me, the egg was already sufficiently decorated without further effort on my part.

Should you want to use eggs to decorate an Easter gift or serve as a place card or a centerpiece, you can easily etch names and messages on the dyed eggshells with a sharp tool or penknife. The original white comes through like reverse writing.

The very shape of the egg suggests there is a mystery, too, because the message or etching moves out of sight, around the shell. These eggs look stunning on eggstands or in white Chinese porcelain soup spoons.

It is also possible to decorate dyed eggs with pressed on letters. We received an egg on our Silver Anniversary with "Happy 25th Anniversary" in pressed-on letters surrounded with different colored stars applied with a set of felt tipped pens. Possibilities for decoration are endless.

Natural Painting Materials

If you want to draw in color on your dyed eggs, you can try these old coloring recipes found tucked away in a pioneer cookbook.

For orange and yellow. Put freshly grated lemon or orange peel or carrots in muslin bag with very little water and squeeze hard. By adding water, you can obtain various hues down to a light cream color.

For green. Pick fresh spinach, dandelion or sourdock and wash. Put a peck of the wet greens in a mortar, pound to pulp, and squeeze through a cloth into a sauce pan. (You can reduce this to pulp just as well in an electric blender.) Heat and stir until liquid begins to curdle. Strain. Mix in equal quantities of greens and sugar– pint for pint. Add a pinch of powdered alum and a jigger of alcohol. Bottle, cork tightly and store in a cool place. Dilute with water to arrive at shade you desire.

For reds. Use pure raspberry, strawberry or cranberry juice. Dilute for lighter shades.

Egg Edibility

Now it's time to have fun eating the eggs – those that you hard boiled for show and for games and those you blew: For good measure, let's add a few heirlooms that will give you a reputation for simple excellence of cuisine and also for elegance and cleverness without taxing you too much.

Salad 1– Stuffed Eggs. This dish expects you to have a shelf with specialties on it, and a garden.

Shell hard-boiled eggs and cut in half. Remove yolks and mash smooth. Add an equal amount of canned deviled chicken or turkey and moisten with mayonnaise. Shape into balls and refill center of eggs. Press halves together and put on ice until you are ready to serve. Then lay whole eggs in a circle on a nest of crisp lettuce leaves with mayonnaise dressing heaped in the center. Garnish with capers and nasturtium leaves and flowers.



Salad 2 – Pink Daisies. This is a cosmetic dish prepared on individual plates.

Shell enough hard-boiled eggs to accommodate 1 for each guest. Put eggs in warm beet juice and let stand until eggs are a delicate pink. On individual plates arrange small leaves of romaine or red lettuce with stem ends to the center of the plates. Carefully cut eggs in half lengthwise so that the yolks can be removed whole and placed over the ends of the lettuce leaves. Now cut the pink white of the egg in narrow, lengthwise strips and arrange on the plates to resemble petals of a flower. Put on ice. Just before serving, add a rich French dressing. Accompany the salad with Welsh sandwiches - thin slices of bread spread with 1 part of butter rubbed together with 2 parts mild soft cheese, flavored with tarragon vinegar.

Salad 3 – Eggs and Ham. This is somewhat heartier since it comes to the midnight table with meat, too.

Shell and cut in half lengthwise enough hard-boiled eggs to accommodate the number of guests expected. Remove yolks and mash smooth with a large spoonful of butter. Add a few cracker crumbs and 1 cold boiled carrot chopped fine. Season to taste with lemon juice, salt and paprika. Return this mixture to the whites and lay all in a nest of crisp lettuce leaves. Serve with thin slices of cold boiled ham.

A Dish to Make After Blowing Eggs

The easiest way of all to use a spate of eggs is to make scrambles, omelettes and custards. Among these is a family favorite my Grandmother used to prepare. It is called *Eggster,* or possibly *Egg Stir.* No one in the family is quite sure of the spelling though all agree that the eating is fine!

Eggster for two or three
Beat 3 eggs thoroughly. Add 1½ cups milk and cream mixed. Stir in 1½ tablespoons flour slowly as you sprinkle it in the eggs and milk. When the mix is smooth, pour it into a buttered warm heavy skillet. Cook over moderate heat and keep on stirring until the mix thickens and is satin smooth. Season with salt and pepper. Serve with toast.

And if you are sure the eggs are impeccable, think how many egg nogs you can make – with orange juice, raw sugar, honey, carob powder and a hundred other flavors.

A Trio of Antique Spectaculars

For *Eggs-in-Nests* and *Snow Eggs* you will have to dip into your whole egg supplies in the refrigerator. *Air Pies* you will make on a day you may be baking Nesselrode Pudding or Krendel or making Paskha, and need only the yolks.

The Krendel is a Russian birthday cake and Paskha a traditional Easter dessert in Russia. When either is made there is an abundance of egg white left over much to the children's delight. For then they have *Air Pies* which they can help make.

Air Pies are sheer confection.
Beat six egg whites until they peak, adding ½ teaspoon baking powder. Fold in 1 cup of berry preserves. Our friend Nicholas Suntzeff says raspberry is best – and he ought to know. Next best is blackberry and after that, strawberry. Some add sugar –"for the American taste." The mix comes up like rocky road. Now spoon it into a deep, buttered ovenproof glass dish and pile it to the center like a mountain. Bake at 350°until the top is delicately browned. Serve at once while it is hot and before it falls. Serve the exciting stuff in dessert bowls and eat with a spoon.

Eggs-in-Nests are show pieces you offer to appreciative brunch companions. In its way, this dish is an air pie with the yolk restored and the sweets removed and it is as pretty as a picture. My own name for the dish would be "Eggs with Ruffles" for it goes to table with what look like starched ruffles. At the turn of the century, it was thought to be a nice dish for breakfast or tea. It serves three or six, depending on appetite. If there are to be two eggs to a dish, make certain the dish is large enough to keep the egg white from bursting over the edges in the oven.

Separate six eggs, being careful not to break the yolks. Beat whites to a froth, add salt and pepper and spoon into well-buttered baking dishes. With the spoon, make a depression in the egg white, one for each yolk, and pour in 1 tablespoon of cream in each depression. Upon each spoonful of cream place an egg yolk being careful not to break it. Bake in a moderately hot oven and when yolks are done to your taste, serve hot and at once. I use ovenproof stoneware bowls for Eggs-in-Nests so that I can bring them to table without the need to transfer to other serving dishes. This keeps the dish beautiful and intact. Two eggs to a bowl are satisfyingly enough.













Snow Eggs are worth saving for special family galas like wedding breakfasts and anniversaries or for any spring day you have a bouquet of yellow daisies or jonquils or roses to put on the table. The list of ingredients is embarrassingly simple, but the technique required will give you status, never fear!

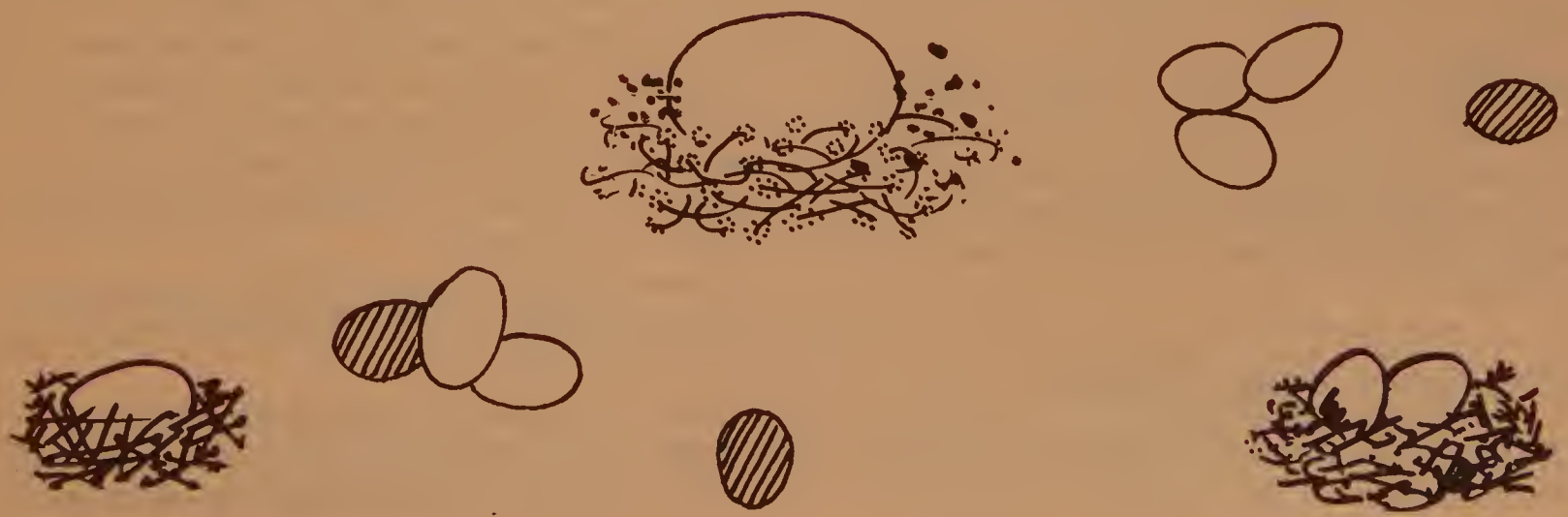
2 cups milk
Vanilla
Peel of ½ lemon
5 eggs separated



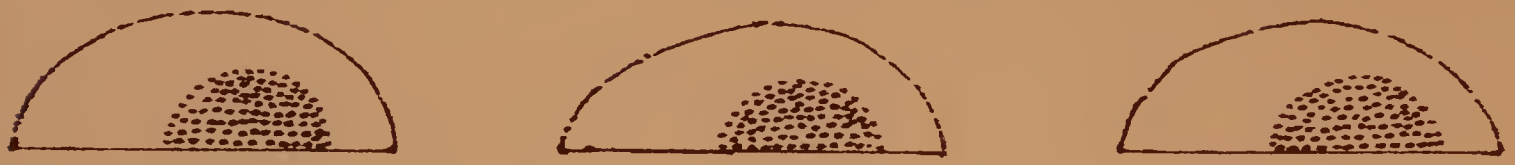
Heat milk with vanilla and lemon rind in a double boiler. Beat egg whites stiff and when milk comes to boiling point, remove lemon and put in egg white by the tablespoonful. These are the snow eggs. Turn them over in the milk and when the white sets, take eggs out and place in a deep dish. (A 2-quart, clear glass soufflé dish is nice to use because it displays what a handsome dish you are making—all yellow and white.) When all the egg white "eggs" are done, beat the egg yolks lightly and stir into the milk. Do not allow to come to a boil, but keep stirring until the mix reaches the consistency of cream. Pour over the snow eggs.

This dish may be served hot for breakfast with crisp toast. In this case, place the deep dish in a pan of hot water while you make the snow eggs. As a hot dish, snow eggs are very like the Chinese "fried milk"– very delicate and beautiful to behold.

As a cold dish, snow eggs can be a dessert. Just sprinkle on powdered sugar and serve in dessert bowls. A delight with sweet biscuits.



EGGS HAVE A THOUSAND WAYS



EGGS HAVE A THOUSAND WAYS

Eggs have been on menus for thousands of years. They have been in cook books for only a few hundred years.

In Grandmother's day, a cook book was still a luxury. Young ladies hired out as maid servants in homes that could afford them and learned to cook at the instruction of their mistresses. When their service was done and they married, they took along with them the recipes and methods they had copied down or carried in their heads.

As time passed, social chit-chat over tea and little cakes, and talks over the back fence stimulated trading of recipes.

The trade-offs were merely for the ingredients. These found their way onto handwritten scraps of paper and into notebooks. Methods were either taken for granted or discussed at length.

For charity's sake, church guilds and Ladies Aids invited members to share their choicest recipes for the enjoyment of all. They gathered their findings into some of the most interesting cook books to be found anywhere. This was one way everyone in town could get recipes she wouldn't dare ask for personally.

OTHER EARLY RECIPE SOURCES

Word-of-mouth and hand-me-down recipes were forerunners of a flowering of little cook books designed to sell manufactured food products and kitchen appliances or to cap an established reputation.

In 1908, the Department of Home Economics of the Rumford Chemical Works of Rumford, Rhode Island, issued an authoritative little cook book. It had 18 kitchen tested recipes for eggs – one with the exotic title, "Eggs in Prison."

Cornucopia of Eggs

By 1919, you could buy a book titled *Eggs in a Thousand Ways.* It was written by Chef Adolphe Meyer who specialized in eggs in "the high class hotels, restaurants and clubs of New York."

Chef Meyer started his book with boiled eggs, then followed with 79 ways to do cold eggs; 22 egg drinks; 210 omelets; 227 poached eggs; 123 scrambled eggs and 9 surprise omelets. All this was in a vest pocket volume of 150 pages.

Somewhat later, the McNess Company distributed a paperback cook book of 65 pages. It featured advice from a cake baker who had won nearly 1,000 prizes for her cakes. She used a carload of eggs in the process and creamed butter and sugar with her bare hands.

When she made an angel food cake, she always used eggs that were at least 4 or 5 days old and thoroughly chilled.

When she separated whites from yolks, she allowed them to stand 20 minutes, then added salt and whipped to a firm froth without letting



whites dry out. She added the sugar to whipped eggs gradually, folding it in, never beating at any time.

When the batter was ready and poured into the pan, she cut around a few times with a knife to break any big air bubbles and just before the pan went into the oven, she held it six inches above the mixing table and dropped it a couple of times. That took care of any last bubbles, she said.

WHAT DOES AN EGG EXPECT OF YOU?

Frankly, an egg wants to be respected.

As a food high in protein, it doesn't ever want to be subjected to high temperatures. When it is, it becomes a tough in a leathery jacket, through no fault of its own.

How to treat an egg has been told very well and in great detail in government pamphlets published by the USDA and the British Columbia Egg Marketing Board, to name two. Both have been primary sources for many home economists who teach and who write for magazines and newspapers and advise consumers.

DON'T LET THE PROFESSIONALS HAVE ALL THE FUN!

While I do not believe that any fool who can read can become a great cook, it is certain that an egg cook can use facts. She should also operate with the sure knowledge that she doesn't have to do everything perfectly the first time.

If you are a beginner, get a basic cook book like *America's Cook Book,* compiled by the Home Institute of the *New York Herald Tribune.* It will tell you everything you need to know about many things, including eggs. Then follow exactly all recipe directions relating to eggs, no matter whether you are cooking, frying or baking.

Beginners and veterans alike will find it useful to have Gourmet International's picture cook book, *Eggs: The Fine Art of Egg, Omelet and Soufflé Cooking.* It shows the *look* of egg cookery and that is often very reassuring.

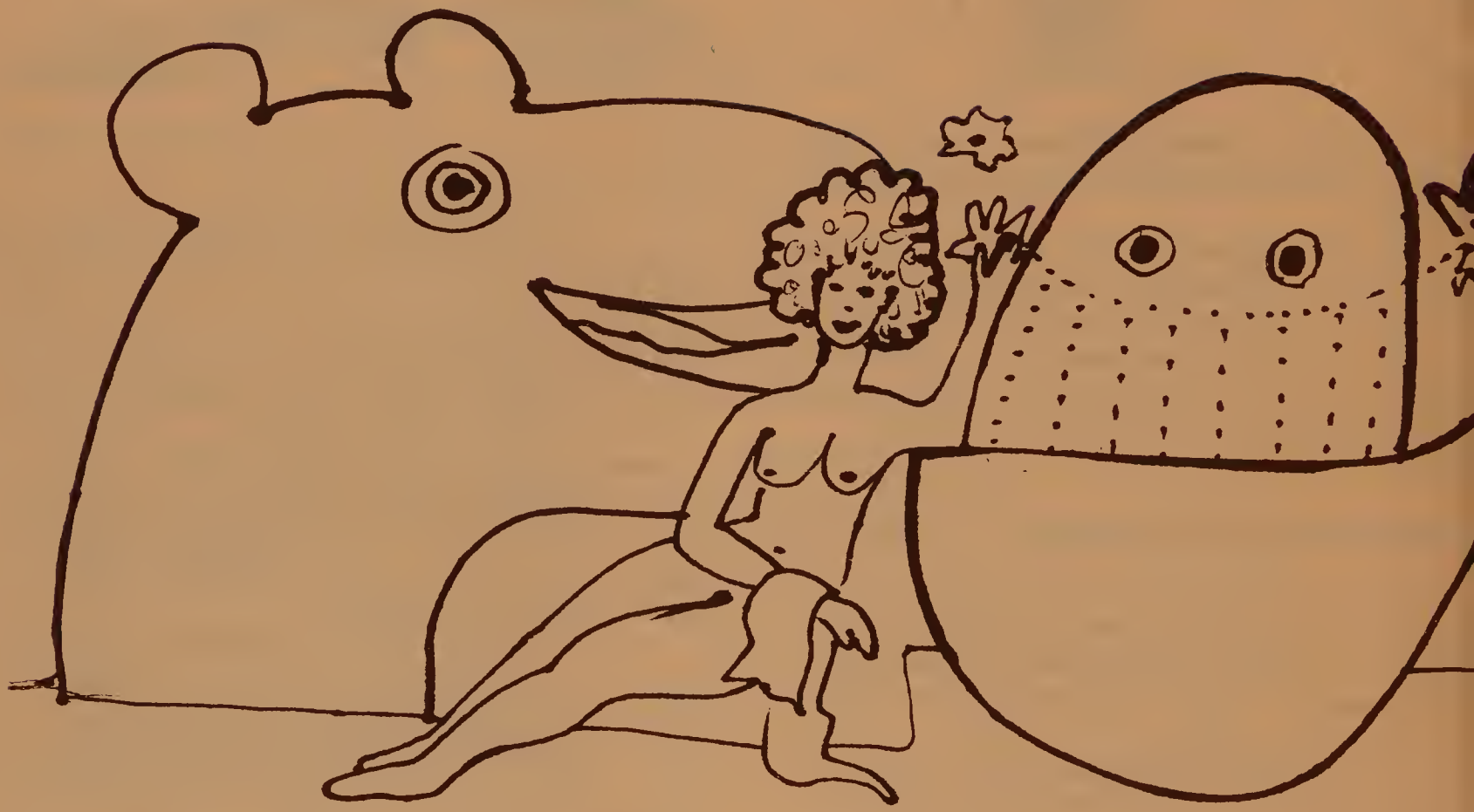
Above all, take pride in your inherited recipes. Write to your grandmothers and aunts for them. Look into the family archives and restore recipes that have made so many good things to eat. The way things are going, such a revival could do much to restore America's tastebuds!

THE INESCAPABLE EGG

The marvelous egg infiltrates your diet all day long. You eat it unaware. Its broken shell is prelude to countless dishes that have gone into frying pans on the stove, into baking utensils in the oven and into soup kettles.

The egg has a thousand ways. The whole egg you eat is but one gratifying manifestation. When the egg surrenders its identity by joining a list of ingredients, it becomes an indispensable secret agent in everything from soup to dessert.

THE SOUP EGG



A WHOLESOME DISH

Frontier cooks regarded soups as restoratives. Long before I ever heard of vitamins, I heard my Mother preaching that soup was good for us.

This wasn't hard to believe when we sat down to a big bowl of soup that had started with a soup bone, gathered strength in the kettle with fresh vegetables, and finally sported a magnificence of fluffy egg dumplings for a topper.

SOUPS YOU CAN'T BUY IN A CAN

With the advent of instant fuels and the growth of commercial canning, soups, alas, left home. But *you* can have fun making soups and exerting creativity in the process. Even really spectacular soups are easy to make. Bones and trimmings, parings and tough vegetable leavings, scraps of salad greens–accumulations normally wasted–can all go into your soup pot. I even save pickle



juice for soups and liquids from boiling and steaming vegetables and from canned vegetables.

A Rule of Thumb

You can make good stock by starting with a quart of water for each pound of meat. Simply make what the pots you already own, can accommodate.

A rule of thumb is this: Use 2/3 lean meat to 1/3 bone and fat and 1 quart of water to each pound of meat and bone.

How to Make Soup Stock

1. Cut meat into small pieces and crack bones to increase surface in boiling. Brown a little of the meat in a frying pan if you want to deepen color and improve flavor.
2. Soak meat in cold water one half hour to extract juices and put into large pot with 1 quart of water to each pound of meat.
3. Cover pot tightly and heat to simmering. Allow to simmer several hours. *Do not boil.* Boiling toughens meat and inhibits flow of juices.

4. Add cut-up vegetables (carrots, onions, celery, cabbage, salad greens, etc.) and herbs (parsley, bay, thyme, summer savory, marjoram) the last hour of simmering. Continue cooking until vegetables are tender.
5. Strain soup through fine sieve. (Hold vegetables and meat for sauces or other soups and purees.) Cool liquid quickly and allow to become thoroughly chilled before using. The fat will cake on top and you can remove it easily. In any case, keep the fat "seal" until you are ready to use the stock. It protects stock against spoiling.

If you store stock in pint jars, you can use the liquid as needed. Stock will keep several days after which you can reheat it and continue to store it.

Now Comes the Egg

If you wish to use the stock as a clear soup, heat it and add a slightly beaten egg white and the eggshell. Bring to a boil for 2 or 3 minutes and then simmer for 10 to 15 minutes. Remove scum, strain through a fine strainer and serve clear.

Thickening Soups

The Romans used eggs to bind sauces. In medieval times, manor tables had menus according to the rank of those seated. The lord's pottage was thickened with egg yolks. Lesser mortals had their stews thickened with bread crumbs.

So cooks have known for a very long time that the easiest way to thicken and enrich cream soups is to mix an egg yolk with 2 tablespoons of cream and a half cup of the hot soup. Stir this into the soup just before serving.

Control Your Temperature!

Temperature control is very important when you thicken soups with egg. To prevent curdling, stir a little of the hot liquid into the egg mix first. Then pour it into the soup and continue stirring. Do not allow to boil.

To prevent overheating during surface cooking, use a double boiler and keep water just below boiling. I also use a two-handled Chinese wok which sits in a ring holder over an electric unit. I highly recommend it for heating milk for the cream base of soups described in this book. I particularly like the facts that the shape of the wok makes it very easy to stir flour and butter pastes smoothly into the milk and that there is no long handle to get in my way. My 14-inch wok easily accommodates all the liquids required for making soup for 10 to 12 guests.

I also use a heavy Dutch oven in making cream soups.

Serve with Flourish!

The old recipes that follow are for special occasion soups, but there is no reason why any day in the week shouldn't be a special occasion on which

to enjoy them. They deserve to appear in heirloom tureens and to be dished out with ornate silver ladles into handsomely simple bowls. They all demonstrate something beautiful an egg can do for a soup.

Farina Cream Soup. This fluffy, ivory soup is a delightful find. The secret is in the cereal. You may not find farina under its old name, but be assured farina is alive and well at your grocer's as "Regular Cream of Wheat."

Eggs add magic to this recipe, too. Because of them a myriad of ivory pearls shimmer in the tasty broth. If you are in a hurry, you can use bouillon cubes as a basis for the stock.

2 level tablespoons farina
2 whole eggs
½ cup milk
4 cups chicken stock
A few peas
Sprigs of parsley

Beat farina, eggs and milk together. Stir slowly into boiling stock. Lower heat and continue cooking for 12 minutes, stirring constantly. Serve garnished with the peas and parsley.

Serves 6

Exploded Dumpling Soup. Here's our nominee for a potion to serve instead of "one more for the road" and in place of strong coffee to pick up the worn and weary. It's a simple, festive cup to offer friends on any occasion. It is fluff on the tongue, wholesome and tasty.

6 cups boiling consommé
2 tablespoons sifted flour
½ cup milk
2 whole eggs
Salt to taste

Mix flour, milk, eggs and salt in a bowl. Pour through a colander into boiling consommé and continue boiling for 5 minutes. Keeps very well.

Serves 6

Watercress Cream Soup. The Chinese say that every new food you try, adds 75 days to your life. Because every pound of watercress contains more than 21,000 units of vitamin A, 350 mgs vitamin C and is rich in minerals, it certainly qualifies as a life extender. Besides, the taste of this soup is divine and if you can believe the ancient Greeks, it will sharpen your wits, too.

1½ tablespoons butter
1½ tablespoons flour
2 cups chicken stock
1 cup milk
½ cup cream
2 bunches well washed watercress
2 egg yolks lightly beaten
Salt and pepper to taste

Heat butter in heavy skillet or Dutch oven, add flour and blend. Add chicken stock and milk and bring to boil. Add watercress and seasonings and boil 15 minutes. Cool, put in blender, then return to stove. Bring to boil and add eggs that have been stirred into cream. Do not allow to boil again. Serves 6

Cheese Cream Soup. If a soup may be said to be amiable, this is it. Similar to the Italian *stracciatella,* it is smooth and rich without seeming to be cloying.

1 onion
2 cups beef stock
1 tablespoon butter
2 tablespoons flour seasoned with white pepper and celery salt
2 cups milk
2 egg yolks lightly beaten
¼ cup grated parmesan cheese

Boil onion for 15 minutes in stock. Strain stock and return to stove. Heat milk to scalding in double boiler and thicken with seasoned flour rubbed into butter. Add beef stock. Stir egg yolks slowly into soup, then the cheese, stirring constantly. Serve with very crisp crackers.

Serves 6

Carrot Soup. In horse-and-buggy days, carrots were considered a valuable food not only for man but also unsurpassed for horses and milk cows! In this soup, carrots provide a golden essence, and the noodles furnish a heartiness far transcending anything you will ever find in a can! Enjoy!

3 grated carrots
1 medium onion chopped
2 tablespoons butter
2 cups chicken or veal stock
1 bayleaf
Pinch of thyme and basil
1 tablespoon minced parsley
2 cups milk
1 tablespoon flour
2 egg yolks, lightly beaten
1 cup boiled noodles

Combine grated carrots and chopped onions and put in Dutch oven or heavy skillet with butter. Simmer covered 20 minutes. Add stock and herbs and continue cooking 20 minutes more. Cool, purée in a blender and return to stove. Add 1 cup of the milk and sprinkle flour into soup, stirring constantly. Bring to boil and add second cup of milk in which you have stirred beaten yolks. Just before serving, add noodles. Season with salt and a little cayenne.

Serves 6 generously

Egg and Napa Cabbage Soup. In times past, cooks of regular cabbage tossed in pieces of charcoal or a pinch of baking soda or vinegar to dissipate the odor. No need to throw the windows open while you cook Napa cabbage for fear of filling the house with a strong odor and offending approaching guests!

4 cups shrimp stock
2 cups shredded Napa cabbage
3 eggs beaten with ½ teaspoon salt
1 teaspoon soy sauce

We make the shrimp stock with dried shrimp, using ¼ cup shrimp soaked for 1 hour in 4 cups of water and 2 tablespoons sherry. We quickly boil the shrimp in the soaking water for 3 minutes and drain. Return drained stock to stove, add cabbage and bring to boil. Pour beaten eggs into soup through a ladle that has holes in it. As soon as the soup comes to a boil, remove from stove and serve at once. The yellow of the eggs clusters in tiny curls around the cabbage to make a beautiful, light soup.

Serves 6

Fiesta Peppers in Cream. Only at the turn of the century did the pepper come into favor as a fresh vegetable. At that, cooks warned housewives to seed them with the utmost care for fear of touching seeds against the green sides and so ruining the whole vegetable.

When you have made this soup, you have also cooked a chicken for lunch or dinner and started two courses in a single pot.

This creamy celadon soup with its subtle tang and bits of green and red floating on top is so colorful you can practically hear the castanets.

1 small chicken, about 2½ pounds
10 cups cold water
2 minced green onions
3 green peppers, seeds removed
1 cup raw rice
1 teaspoon salt
1 bay leaf
5 sprigs of fresh parsley, 2 of thyme
2 lightly beaten egg yolks
1 cup cream
Enough red and green cherry peppers for garnish

Put chicken in kettle with water. Season with salt and bring to boil. Add herbs, onions, peppers and rice. Simmer gently until chicken is tender, about 40 minutes. Remove chicken and cool stock. Purée stock in a blender and return to kettle. Bring to boil and add yolks stirred into the cream. Season with salt and cayenne. Garnish with cherry peppers cut in small squares.

Serves 10 nicely

Two-in-One Potato Soup. The meat-and-potatoes syndrome of pioneer days caused the potato to be maligned as "The Tyrant Potato." In defiance of chemistry and dietetics, husbands insisted on it as daily fare.

A rebellious housewife complained, "If I burn my fingers preparing half a dozen vegetables and omit potatoes, my skill as a housekeeper and cook are as sounding brass and tinkling cymbals—to my husband at least! I am tired to death with potatoes!"

But this complicated combination of potato purée and julienne is definitely serendipitous. There is nothing ordinary or plebeian about this soup. Make the whole recipe even if you have only two or six to serve, and rejoice in the leftovers. The wonderful stuff is just as good the second and third day after you make it.

4 cups potato purée
4 cups julienne
3 egg yolks
1 cup cream
Chopped parsley, chervil and peas

You can take a shortcut by using two No. 2 cans of potato soup. Then make the julienne as follows: Cut into slender strips 1 carrot, 1 turnip, 1 leek, 1 rib of celery, 4 cabbage leaves and ½ onion. Season with salt and ½ teaspoon sugar. Mix and put in well-buttered heavy skillet, cover and simmer. Add no liquid unless vegetables begin to dry out. When vegetables are tender, add enough chicken stock to make 4 cups julienne. Add julienne to potato purée and bring to boil. Add yolks lightly beaten into cream. Serve garnished with parsley, chervil and a few peas.

Serves 10–12

Cream of Asparagus. A sententious Victorian opened a chapter on dinner vegetables with "The Aristocratic Asparagus."

"Asparagus," she observed, "has nothing plebeian about it, as has the onion, the potato, the cabbage, turnip or parsnip. It is essentially a gentleman's vegetable and is an aristocrat from tip to stalk."

1 pound fresh asparagus
2 cups water, salted
1 tablespoon butter
1 tablespoon flour
4 cups milk
2 egg yolks lightly beaten
Salt and pepper to taste

Chop stalks of asparagus into inch-length chunks, using only the tender parts. (Save tough lower stems for your soup stock hoard.) Bring to boil in salted water. Cook vegetable until tender, cool quickly, drain and set aside a cupful of

asparagus tips. Purée remainder in blender and return to kettle and keep hot. Blend butter and flour in heavy pan and add milk, stirring until smooth. Add asparagus slowly with tips. Add a little of the hot soup to the beaten yolks and pour into soup. Continue cooking for a half minute, stirring constantly. Season to taste and serve. This thin cream of exquisitely delicate sunny green serves 8 –10 and will keep well in the refrigerator for a couple of days.

Lettuce Soup. This delicate, old-time soup deserves to make a comeback. It is a little like the Chinese lettuce soup that follows Peking Duck. It is richer because eggs and cream go into its making. Easy to make, it is a delight to eat.

1 head of lettuce
2 tablespoons butter
6 cups clear stock (chicken, veal or beef)
Salt and pepper to taste
3 egg yolks
1 cup cream

Slice lettuce very fine and put in heavy skillet with butter. Cover and simmer 10 minutes. Add stock and seasoning and simmer another 15 minutes. Pour in egg yolks that have been lightly beaten into cream. Serve with Melba toast. This is easily made. Slice bread very thin, remove crusts, and place in warm oven until bread is crisp and brown.

Soup serves 6

Panada. Every old cook book in my possession recommends the panada. The word originates with the Latin for bread and bread is the mainstay ingredient. This recipe transforms the wholesome taste of milk and toast so appealing to the convalescent to a banquet offering. Every spoonful has a savory body that reaches every part of your mouth and goes down so smoothly you want to repeat the pleasure immediately. Plain and excellent for the digestion!

½ loaf stale white bread or French rolls
6 cups water
Salt and pepper to taste
1 cube butter
2 egg yolks
1 cup cream
½ cup milk

Break bread into chunks and put in a Dutch oven with water, seasoning and butter. Cover and simmer for an hour. It will have the consistency of gruel. Now mix lightly beaten yolks in cream and milk and stir slowly into bubbling soup.

Serves 6–8

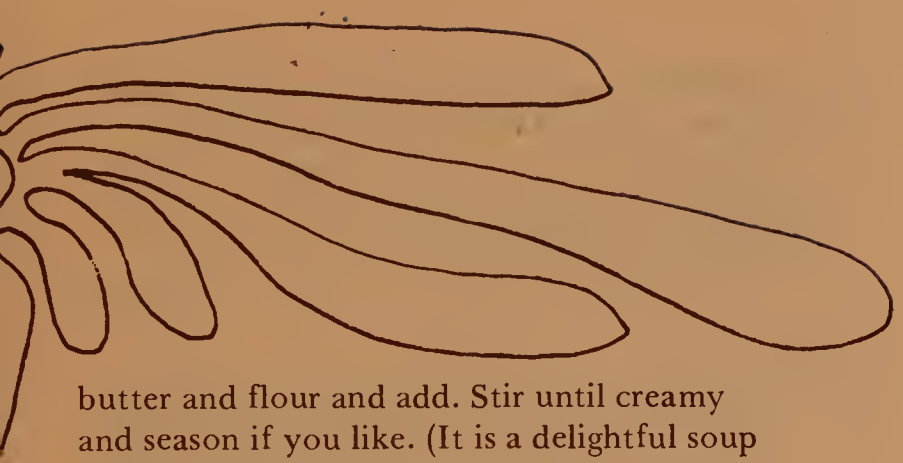


Onion Cream Soup. Once upon a time, onion seasoning was tasted but never seen. Long despised, onions finally became respectable edibles in Grandmother's day. Delicate spinsters quit fainting at fumes of boiled onions and the rusty joke about cooking onions in the middle of a ten-acre lot fell into disuse.

Dumas tells us that Stanislas I, father-in-law of Louis XV, was so impressed by an onion soup served to him at an inn that he made a trip to the kitchen later in his dressing gown to make an unusual request. He asked the cook to prepare the soup before his very eyes so that he could make the soup himself. It could have been a soup like this.

4 good size yellow onions
1 tablespoon butter
2 cups onion stock
1 cup milk
1 tablespoon butter rubbed into
1 tablespoon flour
1 egg yolk
1 cup cream

Peel and slice onions and put into kettle with boiling water. Simmer 5 minutes. Remove from fire and drain, holding water to add to soup. Melt butter in heavy skillet, add onions and allow to cook slowly 10 minutes. Add 2 cups onion stock, cover and simmer 45 minutes. Cool and purée in blender. Return to stove in double boiler and add milk. Make a paste with



butter and flour and add. Stir until creamy and season if you like. (It is a delightful soup without seasonings and we prefer it without salt and pepper.) Finally add yolk which has been lightly whipped in the cream. Continue stirring but do not allow to boil. Serve small portions as this is rich stuff and accompany with crisp, salty crackers.

Serves 6–8

Iced Lemon Soup. If ever a soup deserved a poet laureate, this soup does for its taste and visual quality. It will surprise your tongue with its blend of smooth cream and tangy lemon and hot pepper. It will send your mind in search of a way to identify comparable food flavors.

Color contrasts and design qualities provide a happy visual surprise, too. The soft yellow soup accentuates the bright yellow of the lemon slice and the golden rim of the lemon rind, and the cayenne sparks the lemon segments with its flecks of fire.

We never eat this soup without recalling the sumptuous dinner at which we first enjoyed it at friends' home in Mexico City. Their sophisticated apartment was a symphony of white on white – white rugs, white walls, white furniture. The glass-topped dining table was set with white china and white linens. On a cool day, we had expected a hot soup. The icy lemon dish was exhilarating.

4 cups chicken stock
2 cups light cream
2½ tablespoons cornstarch
6 egg yolks lightly beaten
2 teaspoons sugar
¼ teaspoon white pepper
½ cup fresh lemon juice
Salt to taste
Thin slices fresh lemon for garnish
Sprinkles of cayenne



Heat stock and cream in which you have blended cornstarch. Allow to thicken but do not boil. Whisk a little hot soup into the egg yolks and add to soup mixture with dash of salt, sugar and white pepper. Cook in double boiler for about 10 minutes but do not allow to boil. Remove from heat and whisk in lemon juice. Keep tasting to make sure you have the right balance as you add lemon juice. Chill at least 6 hours and serve garnished with lemon and dusted with cayenne. Now your only problem is what to serve next and not be anticlimactic. Keeps well.

Serves 12

Cream of Cucumber Soup. In frontier days the only good cucumbers were cooked ones. Cooking dissipated whatever disturbing qualities they were charged with. As a result, cucumbers were baked, fried, stuffed and made into soup, of course. They do make a pale soup that is pleasant to taste.

3 large cucumbers
1 tablespoon butter
Salt and pepper to taste
1 teaspoon sugar
2 tablespoons butter
2 tablespoons flour
4 cups stock (chicken)
2 cups milk
2 egg yolks
1 cup cream

Peel, quarter and remove seeds of cucumbers. Cut in chunks and put in boiling salted water and simmer for 5 minutes. Drain and hold liquid to add to stock. Put cucumbers in heavy pan with 1 tablespoon of butter, cover and simmer ½ hour seasoned with pepper and salt and sugar. When done, cool cucumbers and put in blender.

Heat 2 tablespoons of butter in another heavy sauce pan–Dutch oven will do–add flour and stir to a paste but do not brown. Add chicken stock and left over cucumber liquid to make 4 cups, stirring constantly. Add puréed cucumbers and bring up to boil, but do not boil. Add heated milk. Stir in cream in which you have lightly beaten egg yolks. Stir until well blended. Serve with herbed croutons.

Serves 10

Tapioca Cream Soup. When "minute" tapioca came into use, it was advertised as a precision ingredient that guaranteed success with difficult dishes. It made runny fruit pies behave; gave body to stews; made omelets and soufflés stand up; and, of course, made soups better.

This soup can be made only with old-fashioned pearl tapioca. You will never achieve the correct texture by using "instant" tapioca.

Here is a cream soup with amusing little lucite pearls. Serving it will give your dinner the aura of "old family" and heirloom recipes.

Soak 2 tablespoons pearl tapioca in 1 cup cold water over night. Heat 2 cups well seasoned stock to boiling. Stir in drained tapioca and continue boiling until tapioca clears. Then slowly add 2 cups of scalding milk in which you have dissolved a pinch of soda. Season to taste and pour soup very slowly upon beaten yolks

of 3 eggs. Turn into heated tureen and serve.

Serves 6–8

Cream of Corn Soup. Pioneers had a hundred ways to use corn and still they were far from original. It has been said that anything we may think of in relationship to corn, was long ago anticipated by the Incas. Hardly any vegetable is more universally loved.

2 cups cream style corn
2 cups water
4 cups rich milk
2 tablespoons butter
2 tablespoons flour
Salt and pepper to taste
1 egg yolk

Blend corn in an electric blender or press through a colander. Add water and bring to boil. Scald milk in double boiler and add to corn. Blend butter and flour to a paste and stir into soup, stirring continually until soup is smooth. Season. Add a little of the soup to the beaten egg yolk and then pour into soup just before serving. Immensely satisfying.

Serves 8

Cider Soup. This refreshing dessert soup is a pleasant surprise after a hearty dinner. After all, how many places have you dined where a meal closed with a soup? We taste before adding sugar. You may prefer it, as we do, with little or no sugar at all.

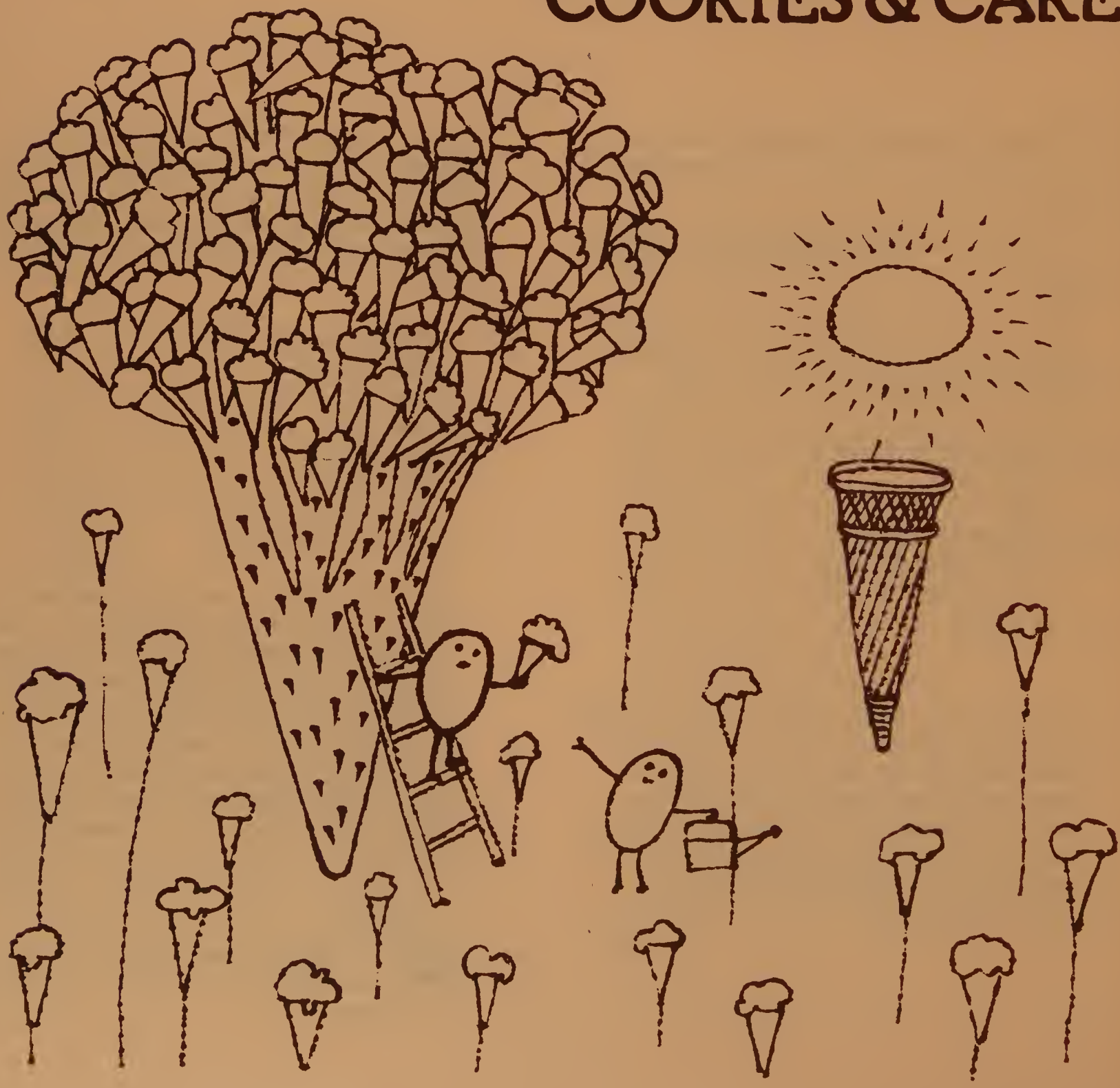
2 tablespoons sifted flour
6 eggs separated
4 cups sweet cider
4 cups water
Sugar to taste
A few slices of lemon
Pinch of salt
Pinch of powdered mace

Stir flour and beaten yolks into cider and water. Sweeten, add lemon and salt and put on fire in a kettle. Stir constantly with whisk or egg beater over hot fire. When soup comes to a boil, pour at once into a tureen with the mace. Form beaten egg whites into small dumplings, dust with sugar and arrange on top of soup. Cover tureen and dumplings will be ready when they reach the table. Serve hot with sugared croutons or sweet biscuits. Soup is also delicious chilled.

Serves 10



EGGS IN DESSERTS-PUDDINGS, COOKIES & CAKES



PUDDINGS

When Queen Elizabeth planned a state visit to France in 1972, Buckingham Palace passed the word that 13-course banquets were out. Meals would consist of "a beginning, a middle and a pudding."

The frontier cooks' approach to a sensible menu like this was ingenious. Their puddings were creations – Trilbys with lemon sauce; fruit affairs piled high with baked meringue; and puddings with fetching titles like Widow's Peach, Mountain Dew and Queen of Puddings.

Here is a baker's dozen of them.

Queen of Puddings

Combine: 2 cups fine bread crumbs
4 cups milk
1 cup sugar
4 egg yolks beaten
Grated rind of a lemon
2 tablespoons melted butter

Bake at 350° for 1 hour in buttered oven dish placed in pan of hot water. When done, spread top with favorite jam. Beat egg whites stiff and add 6 tablespoons sugar, one at a time, and strained lemon juice. Pile beaten whites on top of pudding and return to oven to brown lightly Serve cold with cream.

Serves 6-8

Farina Pudding

Bring 3 cups of milk to a boil. Add 4 tablespoons melted butter mixed with 3 tablespoons farina to make a thick mush. Cool. Separate 5 eggs. Beat yolks well and add to mush with 5 tablespoons sugar and grated rind of a lemon. Beat whites stiff and fold into mixture. Pour into buttered baking dish dusted with flour. Place dish in pan of hot water and bake at 350° for 1 hour. Serve warm with following sauce.

Sauce: Cream 4 tablespoons brown sugar with ½ cup butter. Add beaten yolks of 2 eggs and simmer a few minutes in double boiler.

Serves 6-8

Delicate Pudding

Prepare custard by combining 1 cup milk, 1 tablespoon flour, 4 tablespoons melted butter, ¼ cup sugar, ¼ teaspoon vanilla and beaten yolks of 5 eggs. Thicken in double boiler but do not boil.

Line a deep dish with prepared pastry, spread with your favorite jam, pour over it the custard and bake in 350° oven about 25 minutes. Frost with a meringue made with the 5 egg whites and sugar to taste. Return to oven to brown. Serve cold.

or

Line deep dish with pastry, pour in custard and spread with a layer of chocolate (Melt ½ cup chocolate chips, thinned with 2 tablespoons strong coffee). Bake as above and serve cold with a frosting of whipped cream.

Serves 6-8

Transparent Pudding

Combine thoroughly 1 cup butter, 2 cups sugar, beaten yolks of 8 eggs and grated rind and juice of 1 lemon.

Prepare a rich pastry and line an oven dish. Spread pastry with raspberry preserves and sprinkle with 6 teaspoons flour. Pour pudding mix in and bake at 350° about 50 minutes. If top browns too quickly, make a hat for it with aluminum foil and continue baking. Serve cold.

Serves 6

Lemon Pudding

Prepare custard with grated rind of 2 lemons, 2 cups sugar, 1 cup cream, 2 tablespoons melted butter, 5 eggs well beaten and 3 tablespoons arrowroot. Bake about 30 minutes in deep dish lined with pastry. Serve cold.

Serves 6

Hedgehogs

Make a cake with:

1 cup sugar
1 cup flour
3 eggs
1 teaspoon baking powder
2 tablespoons hot water

Thoroughly mix sugar and eggs, add flour sifted with baking powder. Add hot water. Bake in oval tins. Cool and poke toasted slivered almonds vertically into tops of cakes. Pour thick boiled custard over them and serve cold. (See Lemon Cream Sauce below.)

Serves 6-8

Delmonico's Pudding

Heat 4 cups milk to nearly boiling. Beat yolks of 6 eggs with 6 tablespoons sugar and stir into 3 tablespoons cornstarch dissolved in a little cold milk. Add to hot milk and simmer 3 minutes. Add 1 teaspoon vanilla. Pour into buttered baking dish and bake 10 minutes at 350°.

Beat 3 egg whites to a froth, add 3 tablespoons sugar and ½ teaspoon vanilla. Spread on pudding when it is done and return to oven to brown. Serve cold with whipped cream.

Serves 12

Delicious Pudding

Prepare an angel food sponge.

2 cups powdered sugar
12 eggs separated
¼ teaspoon salt
Grated rind of a lemon
2½ cups flour

Beat yolks separately, add sugar and mix thoroughly. Add salt and lemon rind, then sifted flour a little at a time. Beat egg whites to a froth and fold into batter. Bake in square

flat pans for 30-40 minutes in 325° oven. Cake should be about 1 inch high when done. Cool and cut into 3-inch squares. Slice and butter and return pieces to pan as they were. In a double boiler prepare a custard with 4 eggs, 4 cups of milk, ½ cup sugar and ½ teaspoon almond flavoring. When slightly thickened, pour over cake and return to oven and bake ½ hour at 325°. Serve cold.

Serves 10

Poor Man's Pudding

Beat 1 egg, 1 cup sugar and 1 tablespoon melted butter together. Add ½ cup milk, 2 cups flour sifted with 1 teaspoon baking powder. Bake in oven dish ½ hour and serve cold with custard sauce.

Serves 6

Bridgeport Pudding

Combine 1 cup boiled rice, 2 cups milk, beaten yolks of 5 eggs, grated rind of a lemon, ½ cup sugar and ¼ teaspoon salt. Pour mixture into oven dish placed in a pan of hot water and bake at 350° for about 50 minutes. Cool and cover with a frosting made of 3 egg whites, 6 tablespoons sugar and 2 teaspoons lemon juice. Return to oven to brown, then cool at room temperature. Serve cold.

Serves 6-8

Snow Pudding

Dissolve 1 package plain gelatin in ½ cup cold water. Add 1½ cups boiling water, ½ cup sugar, juice and grated rind of a lemon. When gelatin thickens, break in whites of 3 eggs and beat vigorously with egg beater. Pour "snow" gelatin into mold and allow to set until firm in refrigerator.

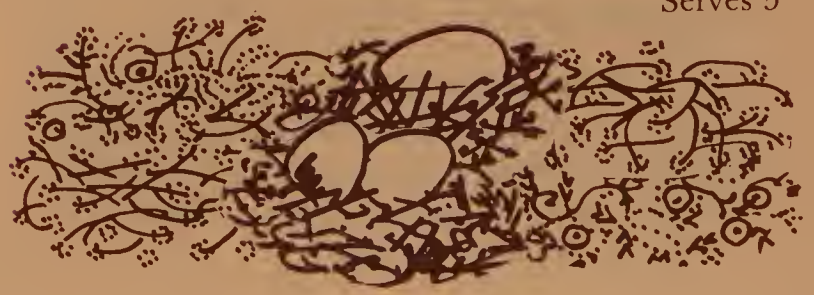
Prepare a boiled custard sauce in double boiler with egg yolks, 2 cups milk, ¼ cup sugar and pinch of salt. Minced blanched almonds make a nice flavoring. Serve cold poured over gelatin.

Serves 6

Hen's Nest Pudding

Blow 5 eggs and fill with blanc mange. When it is stiff, remove shells. Pare rind from 6 lemons and boil till tender, cool and cut in thin strips to resemble straw. Sprinkle with sugar. Fill small deep dish half full of gelatin. When it sets, arrange lemon like a nest and place "eggs" on top.

Serves 5



Egg Pudding

Bring 4 cups milk to boil in doubler boiler. Stir in 9 tablespoons flour mixed into 2 cups cold milk. Cook well and remove from stove.

Beat together yolks of 12 eggs, 6 tablespoons sugar and 3 tablespoons melted butter. Add slowly to milk mixture, stirring constantly. Cool. Beat whites of eggs to a froth and fold in. Pour into buttered oven dish, set dish in pan of hot water and bake 1 hour at 350°. Serve cold with sauce.

Serves 10

Easy Pudding Sauces

Cream Sauce – Cold

Combine 1 cup powdered sugar, 2 egg yolks, salt to taste and your favorite flavoring. Beat thoroughly. Fold in 1 cup whipped cream. Spoon over puddings. Sauce is also good on cakes, ice cream and fruit.

Lemon Cream Sauce – Hot

In a double boiler, bring 2 cups milk to boil. Stir in 1 teaspoon flour, ½ cup sugar, 3 egg yolks well beaten. Remove from fire and add grated rind and juice of a lemon. Stir until smooth. Serve hot or cold.

You may omit lemon rind and juice and substitute other flavorings.

COOKIES

Among my souvenirs is a looseleaf cookbook, the recipes of which I typed from scraps of papers, all handwritten. They were the treasures of an older friend who was a superb cook and wanted to preserve the gleanings of many years. Before she was gathered to her fathers, she gave her only copy to me. Two-thirds of the book is given over to cookie recipes. Many of them carry the names of her friends who shared them with her. All here require eggs.

Let me share this bonus from the past.

Bone, Muscle and Brain Builders

Oatmeal had its cheering section late in the last century. A Prof. Forbes of Edinburgh was the authority who gave credence to its virtues. Over a period of 20 years, he measured the breadth and height and the strength of arms and loins of Edinburgh University students. The Scotch and the Scotch Irish from Ulster who grew up eating at least one meal a day of good milk and good oatmeal porridge led all the rest in height, breadth of chest and shoulders, and strength of arms and loins.

So please eat these oatmeal cookies with a glass of milk!

Date Filled Oatmeal Sticks. The way the dates are added is beautifully efficient and simple, by far the best method I have ever found.

1½ cups shortening (half butter, half lard)
1½ cups brown sugar
2 eggs
½ cup sour cream
1 teaspoon soda
½ teaspoon salt
1 teaspoon vanilla
3 cups oatmeal ground fine in meat grinder
Enough flour to roll

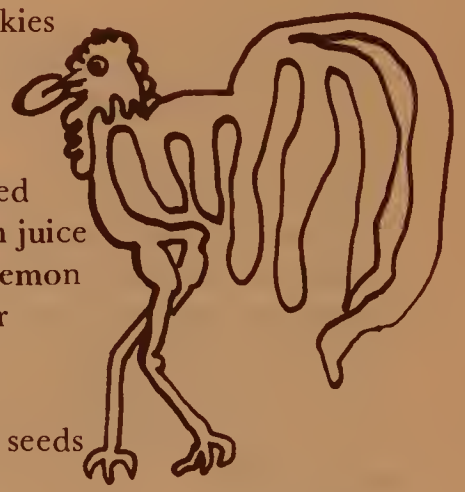
Cream shortening and sugar thoroughly. Add eggs and beat well. Add sour cream, soda and salt and blend well. Add oatmeal, vanilla and enough flour to make a soft dough. Have dates ready pitted and spread open. Roll out dough on lightly floured board. Lay dates over half the dough and fold the other half over the date-filled section. Press firmly together with rolling pin. Cut dough in small squares or rectangles and bake in 375° oven on buttered cookie sheets for 12 – 15 minutes.

Yields 50 2x1-inch sticks

The Wonderful Taste of Lemons!

As a child growing up, I recall lemon as the most persistent of flavors, the most freighted with the exotic. Who ever saw a lemon except in a store or imprisoned in a bottle of extract? Its pungent acid, married with eggs and sugar and butter, announced that something special was going forth in the kitchen.

Lemon Ice Box Cookies



1 egg
1 cup sugar
½ cup butter softened
2 tablespoons lemon juice
Grated rind of one lemon
2½ cups pastry flour
½ teaspoon soda
½ teaspoon salt
1 teaspoon caraway seeds

Beat egg and gradually beat in sugar. Add lemon juice, butter, caraway seeds, grated lemon and flour which has been sifted with soda and salt. Form rolls about 2 inches in diameter, wrap in waxed paper and chill until firm enough to cut in 1/8-inch slices. Bake in hot oven.

Yields 5 dozen

Cookies Grandmothers Make

The cookies my Grandmother made were always rolled cookies and there were none quite like hers. She cut them out of the dough on the kitchen table with a favorite cup that was big and generous. When the cookies came out of the oven, they were my first experience with a single food that was a meal-in-one. One of these big beautiful sugar cookies and a glass of milk and I was unable to heed the call to supper!

Grandmother's famous white cookie recipe, retrieved from the family archives by Aunt Clara is similar to one someone else's grandmother had for "Everlasting Cookies".

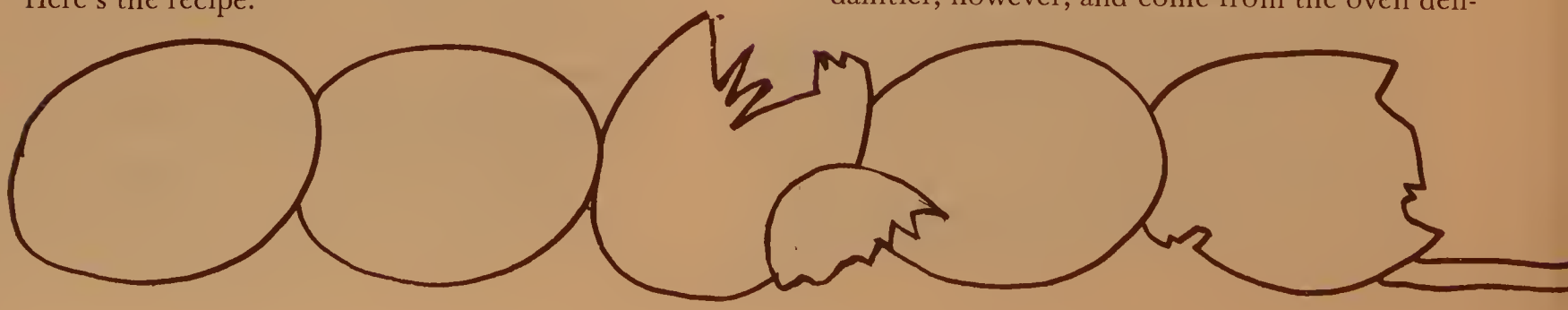
The "Everlasting Cookies" derived their name from the fact that they made a record of sorts. A pioneer woman made nearly a barrelful of them for her brothers to take across the plains with them to California in 1849. The men were six months on the road. They swore the cookies were as good when they arrived at their destination as when they set out! Now, you know about one thing that went along in the Conestoga wagons. Here's the recipe.

2 cups sugar
1 cup butter
2 eggs well beaten
1 cup milk
1 teaspoon salt
½ teaspoon each cinnamon and nutmeg
3 teaspoons baking powder mixed with some flour
Enough flour to roll out soft

Cream butter and sugar thoroughly. Add eggs, milk, salt and spices. Add baking powder to batter mixed with a little flour. Add remaining flour to make soft dough. Roll out on floured board, cut with round cookie cutter, sprinkle with sugar, and bake on buttered sheets in moderately hot oven.

Yields 4 dozen

Charlie's Mother's Cakes. I haven't the faintest idea who Charlie and his Mother were. These little cookies remind me of the store bought cookies we called scrub boards when I was a child. They are daintier, however, and come from the oven deli-



cately browned, not muddy-looking like the commercial variety. This recipe makes enough cookies to give away. But they keep very well in the freezer if you aren't feeling loving and giving!

1 cup butter
2 cups sugar
½ cup milk
1½ cups grated coconut
3 eggs, yolks and whites beaten separately
1 teaspoon baking powder
Flour enough to roll

Cream butter and sugar thoroughly. Add milk, grated coconut, beaten egg yolks. Sift baking powder with 1 cup flour and add to dough. Fold in beaten egg whites and add enough flour to make soft dough – about 4½ cups. Roll out dough and cut small rectangles 1x2 inches and press fork along tops to make ridges like a scrub board. Bake on buttered cookie sheets at 375° and keep an eye on them after 8 minutes.

Yields 150 small cookies

Swedish Cookies. It is a mystery why these good little peanut cookies are called Swedish. Possibly the source of this old recipe was a Swedish lady who brought the recipe with her to the Midwest in the early days. There were many Swedes in our town.

1 cup butter
1 cup sugar
2 eggs
1 teaspoon vanilla
2 cups flour
Loose sugar and finely chopped peanuts

Cream butter and sugar. Add eggs, vanilla and flour. If you find the dough too precious to handle easily, add a little flour. On a floured board, roll thin, sprinkle with sugar and chopped peanuts and roll again lightly to press in sugar and nuts. Cut in various shapes and bake on buttered sheet in moderate oven.

Yields 5 dozen



The Hearty Goodness of Molasses and Ginger

If lemon was the taste of elegance, molasses and ginger were the homely companions of everyday fare. And I must say, I have seldom met a cookie made with either that I didn't like.

Molasses Roll Cookies. These improve with age and are best after they are a week old.

2 cups molasses
1 cup lard
1 egg
1 cup sugar
2 cups sour cream
2 teaspoons soda
1 teaspoon baking powder
1 tablespoon ginger
1 teaspoon cinnamon
¼ teaspoon cloves
1 teaspoon salt
Enough flour to make soft dough

Mix molasses and lard. Add well beaten egg and sugar, then cream. Sift all dry ingredients together with a little flour and add. Add more flour, enough to roll out soft. Roll on floured board, cut with a round scalloped cookie cutter and bake on buttered sheets in a moderate oven. Yields enough cookies to invite the neighbors in!

Ginger Snaps You Can't Resist. The world's best ginger snaps were invented by someone named Augusta. You make the dough a day ahead and then invite your favorite children to help you roll the dough into balls.

Augusta's snaps crack on top, have a very crisp texture and should be stored in a tight can.

¾ cup shortening, half butter, half margarine
1 cup sugar
1 beaten egg
4 tablespoons molasses
1 teaspoon each ginger and cinnamon
A little salt
3 teaspoons soda sifted with
2 cups flour

Cream shortening and sugar thoroughly. Add egg and molasses. Sift dry ingredients together and add to batter. This will make a quite soft dough. Let it stand over night in a covered bowl in the refrigerator. Roll into balls the size of a walnut, then roll in sugar and bake on buttered sheet at 325°.

Yields 4 dozen

Aunt Eda's Brown Sugar Cookies. These are very crisp cookies, too, the kind you remember coming home for after school. You follow the

same procedure as for Augusta's snaps and thoroughly chill the soft dough before rolling balls and baking in a medium oven at 350°.

1½ cups brown sugar
½ cup white sugar
1 cup lard
3 eggs
2 teaspoons soda
2 teaspoons cream of tartar
1 teaspoon salt
3¾ cups flour
2 teaspoons vanilla

Yields 6 dozen

White Rocks. These cookies are traveling under an assumed name. They are really very light, tender and crusty. If they must be called "rocks", let's give them the right name – Floating White Rocks. They are like the tricky basalt rocks that float down the Columbia River past St. Helens.

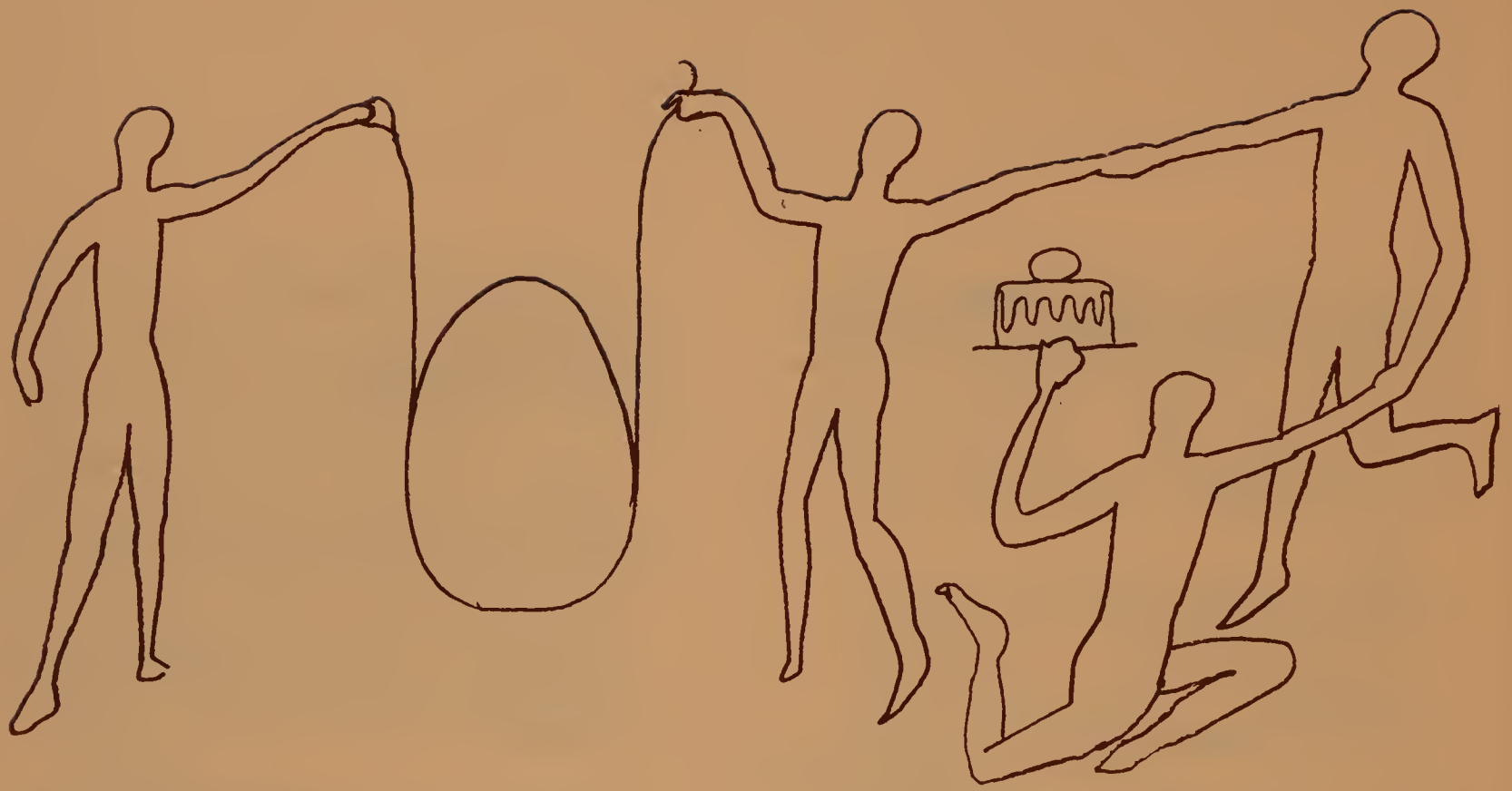
1½ cups white sugar
½ cup butter
2 eggs
1 teaspoon vanilla
1 cup sour cream
3 cups flour
1 teaspoon soda
1 teaspoon baking powder
A bit of salt
1 cup chopped dates
1 cup chopped nuts



Cream butter and sugar thoroughly. Add eggs and beat until fluffy. Add vanilla. Sift flour together with soda, baking powder and salt. Add sour cream and flour alternately to batter. Add dates and nuts. Drop on buttered baking sheet by teaspoon and bake in moderate oven. If you can keep from eating the dough, recipe yields 8 dozen.

Hermits. If this is what hermits eat, lead us to the hermitage! This cookie enjoys a distinction few other cookies can boast – a listing as a cookery term in *Webster's New International Dictionary*. "A hermit," it states, "is a kind of spiced molasses cookie, often containing chopped raisins and nuts."

Cooks down the years have taken this definition under advisement and created not a few changes. Some hermits have strong coffee in them. Some are made with oatmeal, some with coconut. Just about all have spices and raisins. Our recipe has nuts (we like cashews) and grated orange rind but no molasses.



3 cups sifted cake flour
1 teaspoon soda
½ teaspoon each nutmeg and cinnamon
½ cup broken nuts
1 cup each raisins and currants
Grated rind of one orange
½ cup butter
1½ cups brown sugar
2 tablespoons sour cream
2 eggs well beaten

Sift flour once, measure, add soda, nutmeg and cinnamon and sift again together 3 times. Sift half this mixture over fruits and nuts. Mix well. Cream shortening well, adding sugar gradually and continuing until light and fluffy. Add cream and beaten eggs and orange rind. Beat well. Now add sifted dry ingredients, fruits and nuts a little at a time. Beat after each addition until smooth. Drop from teaspoon on buttered sheet and bake at 350° for 8 – 10 minutes.

Yields 8 dozen

Henry's Cookies. These cookies are dear to me because they were the first inkling I had that I was about to marry a gourmet who wasn't afraid of the kitchen. He decided at the very last minute to add Henry's cookies to his repertoire for a big dinner he was making all alone to compliment me and a pair of his future in-laws.

This is his story about the origin of Henry's Cookies.

"Henry was my aunt's butler many years ago. I remember him for his Belgian accent and for the

flourish with which he handled big silver trays at dinner. An ambitious man, he tried to market his secret for salad dressing only to discover that without preservatives, it had too short a shelf life to survive.

"For me this was no loss. We enjoyed his salads and especially his cookies. They were a crowning achievement. As thin and crisp as potato chips and often just as curled because they were very hard to get off the cookie sheet, they were so good there were never any left to store."

1 cup finely chopped nuts
(or ¾ cup shredded coconut)
½ cup butter
¾ cup powdered sugar
2 eggs separated
¼ teaspoon cinnamon

Chop nuts. Good nuts to use are pecans, walnuts, peanuts and blanched almonds. Use only one kind of nut at a time. Do not mix them. Cream butter and sugar thoroughly, add egg yolks and beat well. Add spice and nuts. Beat egg whites to a froth and fold in. Drop by spoonfuls on a buttered sheet – only 6 to a baking sheet because the batter spreads a good deal in the oven. Bake in moderate oven and remove from sheet while they are hot or they will stick forever!

Yields 2 dozen

CAKES

Early cakes were eggless, made of flour and water and sometimes honey. Such austere fare was a feature of weddings in early England and, like so many other things, arrived there with the Romans. Ritual dictated breaking the cakes over the bride's head and then gathering the fragments for her to offer to her friends, probably as good luck symbols.

Cakes with eggs did not come into existence until the 17th Century.

At our house, a child could request on one day only what cake we would all eat. That was a birthday cake. The cakes were always layer cakes and the frosting was high. There were lemon cakes and orange cakes and rich white cakes with chocolate frosting and the birthday child got the biggest piece.

Here are some recipes you can use to wish someone you love a very Happy Birthday.

Moonlight Cake. This was Uncle Adolph's favorite birthday cake. He was a Norwegian sailor who left the sea to farm near Pretty Rock, North Dakota. He was the one who taught me how to read the skies. And he built a swing in his barn for me and my brother. The recipe for this exquisite cake was contributed by my Aunt Edie.

10 egg whites
7 egg yolks

¼ teaspoon salt
7/8 teaspoon cream of tartar
1½ cups sugar
1 teaspoon almond extract
1 cup flour

Add salt to egg whites and beat until light. Sift in cream of tartar and continue beating whites until they are stiff. In separate bowl, beat yolks until they are thick and lemon colored. Add to them 2 heaping tablespoons of the beaten whites. To remaining whites, gradually add sugar which has been measured after sifting. Add almond extract. Now fold yolk mixture into egg whites and gradually fold in flour which has been measured after one sifting but which has been sifted four times before adding to egg and sugar mix. Bake in angel food pan which has first been dipped in cold water. Bake in medium oven – 350° – for an hour.

When the cake is baked, set pan upside down for 1½ hours before removing. We like this cake frosted with a lemon glaze which you make as follows.

Lemon Glaze

3 tablespoons softened butter
1 egg yolk
Grated rind of a lemon
2 tablespoons lemon juice
2 cups sifted powdered sugar

Blend butter, yolk, lemon rind and juice until smooth. Add sifted sugar and stir until smooth. This makes a thin cover for top and sides of a Moonlight Cake.

Grandmother's White Cake. This is a very rich cake. For those with admirable constitutions and no won't power, it is something you have twice in an evening – one piece at dinner and a second piece for the road.



1 cup butter
2 cups sugar
1 cup sweet milk
3 cups flour
2 teaspoons baking powder
Whites of 5 eggs
1 teaspoon vanilla

Cream butter and sugar thoroughly. Add milk and beat until smooth. Sift flour 3 times and measure. Add baking powder and sift again and add to mix. Whip eggs to a froth and fold into batter. Add vanilla last. Bake in layer pans at 350° until golden and a toothpick comes out clean. Frost with chocolate icing.

Below is my own invention for chocolate icing.

1 pkg. chocolate chips melted in double boiler
1 cup powdered sugar
1 large lump of butter
Enough light cream to mix
1 tablespoon orange curaçao
½ cup broken cashews



Other Interesting Cakes

Cornstarch Cake

1½ cups powdered sugar
½ cup butter
½ cup cornstarch
½ cup sweet milk
½ teaspoon cream of tartar
¼ teaspoon soda
Whites of 4 eggs, beaten
1 cup flour

Marble Cake. This is a four-layer extravaganza with alternating white and brown layers and an unusual two-part icing

White Batter

4 egg whites beaten stiff
½ cup butter
1 cup sugar
1 cup sweet milk
2 cups flour
2 teaspoons baking powder

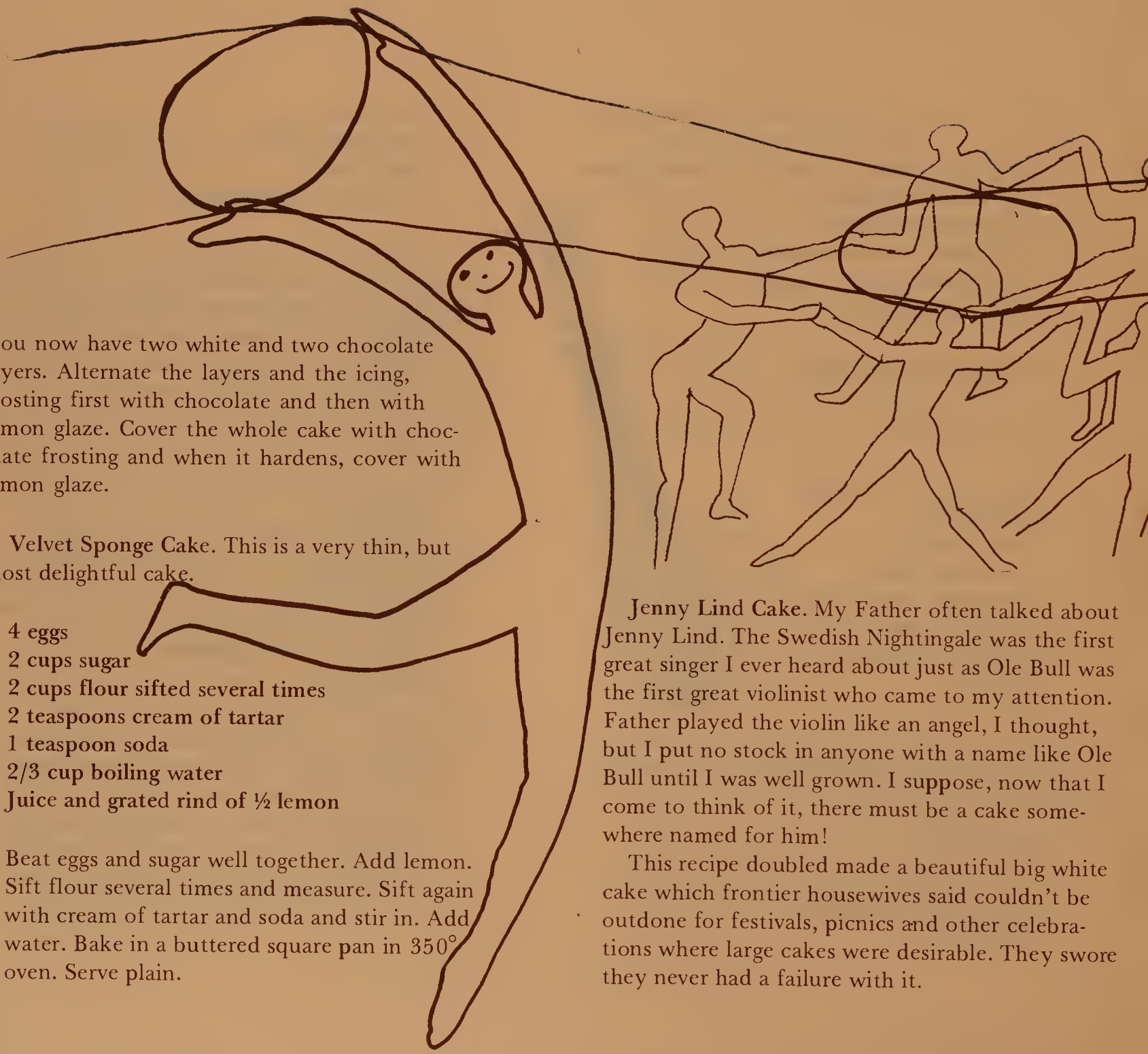
Sift flour several times, the last time measured and with baking powder added. Cream butter and sugar until fluffy. Add milk and flour alternately, beating until smooth each time. Fold in stiffly beaten egg whites. Bake in buttered layer pans in 350° oven about 25 minutes.

Chocolate Batter



4 egg yolks
¾ cup brown sugar
¾ cup milk
½ cup butter
3 squares melted chocolate
2 teaspoons baking powder
2 cups flour

Sift flour and baking powder together. Cream butter, gradually adding sugar and beating until fluffy. Beat in one egg yolk at a time, then melted chocolate. Add flour alternately with milk, beating smooth each time. Bake in buttered layer pans in 350° oven about 25 minutes.



You now have two white and two chocolate layers. Alternate the layers and the icing, frosting first with chocolate and then with lemon glaze. Cover the whole cake with chocolate frosting and when it hardens, cover with lemon glaze.

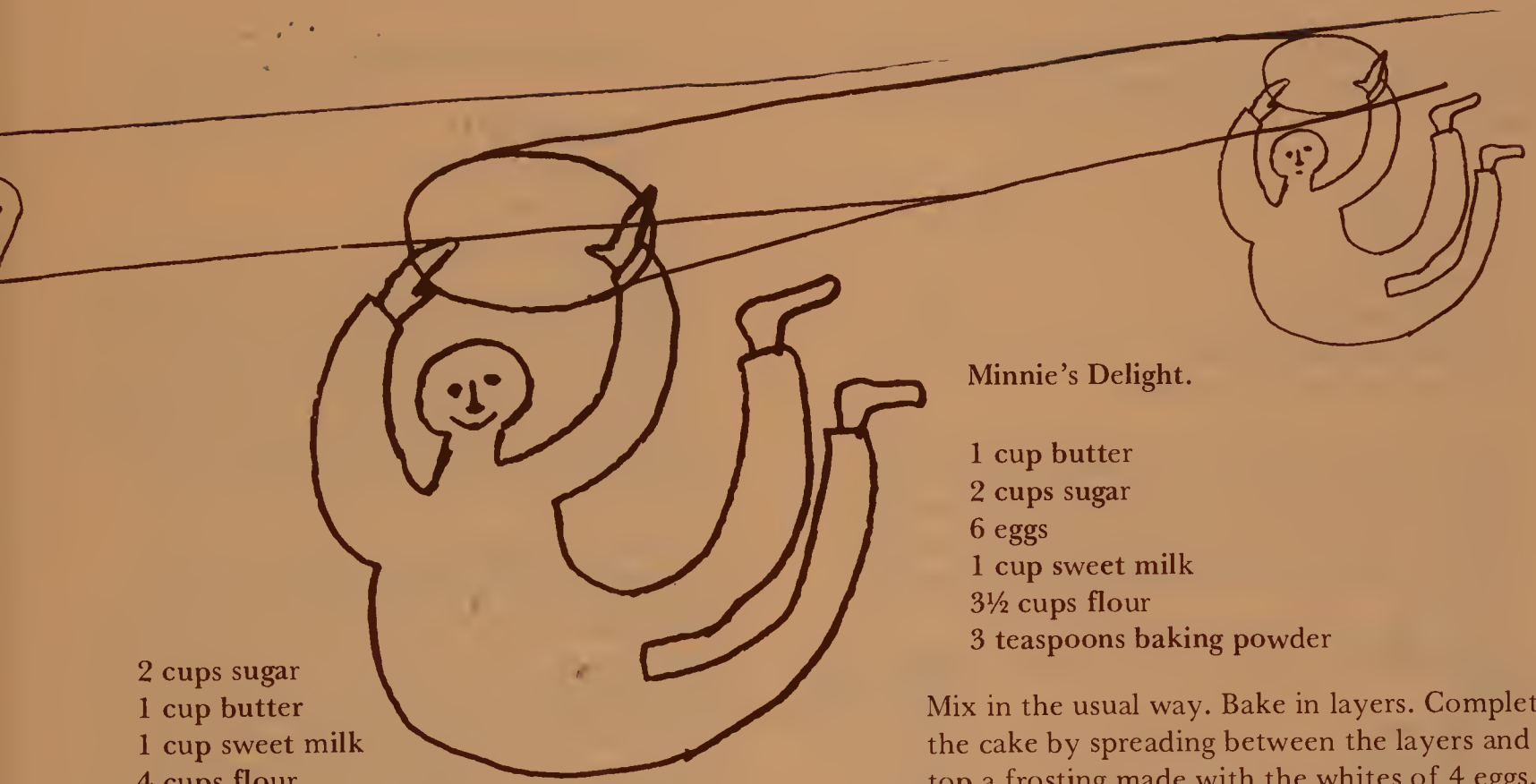
Velvet Sponge Cake. This is a very thin, but most delightful cake.

4 eggs
2 cups sugar
2 cups flour sifted several times
2 teaspoons cream of tartar
1 teaspoon soda
2/3 cup boiling water
Juice and grated rind of ½ lemon

Beat eggs and sugar well together. Add lemon. Sift flour several times and measure. Sift again with cream of tartar and soda and stir in. Add water. Bake in a buttered square pan in 350° oven. Serve plain.

Jenny Lind Cake. My Father often talked about Jenny Lind. The Swedish Nightingale was the first great singer I ever heard about just as Ole Bull was the first great violinist who came to my attention. Father played the violin like an angel, I thought, but I put no stock in anyone with a name like Ole Bull until I was well grown. I suppose, now that I come to think of it, there must be a cake somewhere named for him!

This recipe doubled made a beautiful big white cake which frontier housewives said couldn't be outdone for festivals, picnics and other celebrations where large cakes were desirable. They swore they never had a failure with it.



2 cups sugar
1 cup butter
1 cup sweet milk
4 cups flour
3 teaspoons baking powder
12 egg whites

Cream butter and sugar thoroughly, add milk, then flour which has been sifted several times, then measured and the baking powder added and sifted a final time. Beat egg whites stiff and fold into batter. Bake in angel food pan and handle the same way you handle the Moonlight Cake. Ice with burnt sugar, maple or chocolate glaze.

Minnie's Delight.

1 cup butter
2 cups sugar
6 eggs
1 cup sweet milk
3½ cups flour
3 teaspoons baking powder

Mix in the usual way. Bake in layers. Complete the cake by spreading between the layers and on top a frosting made with the whites of 4 eggs, thickened with sifted powdered sugar, flavored with lemon or chocolate.

Lemon Filled Cake. It was a cake like this and a horseback ride – my very first – that made a country Fourth of July celebration memorable when I was a teenager. Everyone around the countryside convened at a large farm house and brought things to eat. Had I not been from a city, I would have believed that the whole United States stopped

the world to eat, not to mark independence. Nothing like this feast ever happened in the city on the Fourth.

2 cups sugar
¾ cup butter
3 eggs beaten
¾ cup sweet milk
3 cups flour sifted with
2 teaspoons baking powder

Cream butter and sugar thoroughly. Add beaten eggs, then milk. Sift flour several times, measure, add baking powder and sift again before adding to batter. Bake in buttered layer pans in moderate oven.
Prepare filling to put between layers as follows;

1 cup sugar
¾ cup water
Juice and rind of one lemon
2 tablespoons cornstarch in a little cold water

Dissolve sugar in water, add lemon juice and rind and let come to boil. Add cornstarch in cold water. Let return to boil and cook until it reaches consistency of jelly. Cool and spread between cake layers. This would be quite enough for most of us, but the Fourth of July version was topped with a mountain of Seven Minute Frosting.

Seven Minute Frosting

2 egg whites
1½ cups corn syrup
Dash of salt
1 teaspoon vanilla

Combine eggs, syrup and salt in top of double boiler. Place over boiling water making sure water doesn't touch upper kettle. Beat constantly with a rotary eggbeater for 7 minutes until frosting stands in peaks. Take from water, add vanilla and beat to spreading consistency.

Strawberry Shortcake. In June in Wisconsin when the little wild strawberries were ripe, we picked them in the daisy meadows around home. On a warm day, it wasn't possible to move around the patches of berries without stepping on a few. What a sweetness every misstep loosed on the air around us! What a harvest of every size red berry, bursting with ruby elixir and painting our hands with its wine! What a welcome the berry picker got when she arrived home with a panful of strawberries and a daisy or two!

This called for two treats – strawberries in thick clots of cream and strawberry shortcake. The cake was really a sweet biscuit.

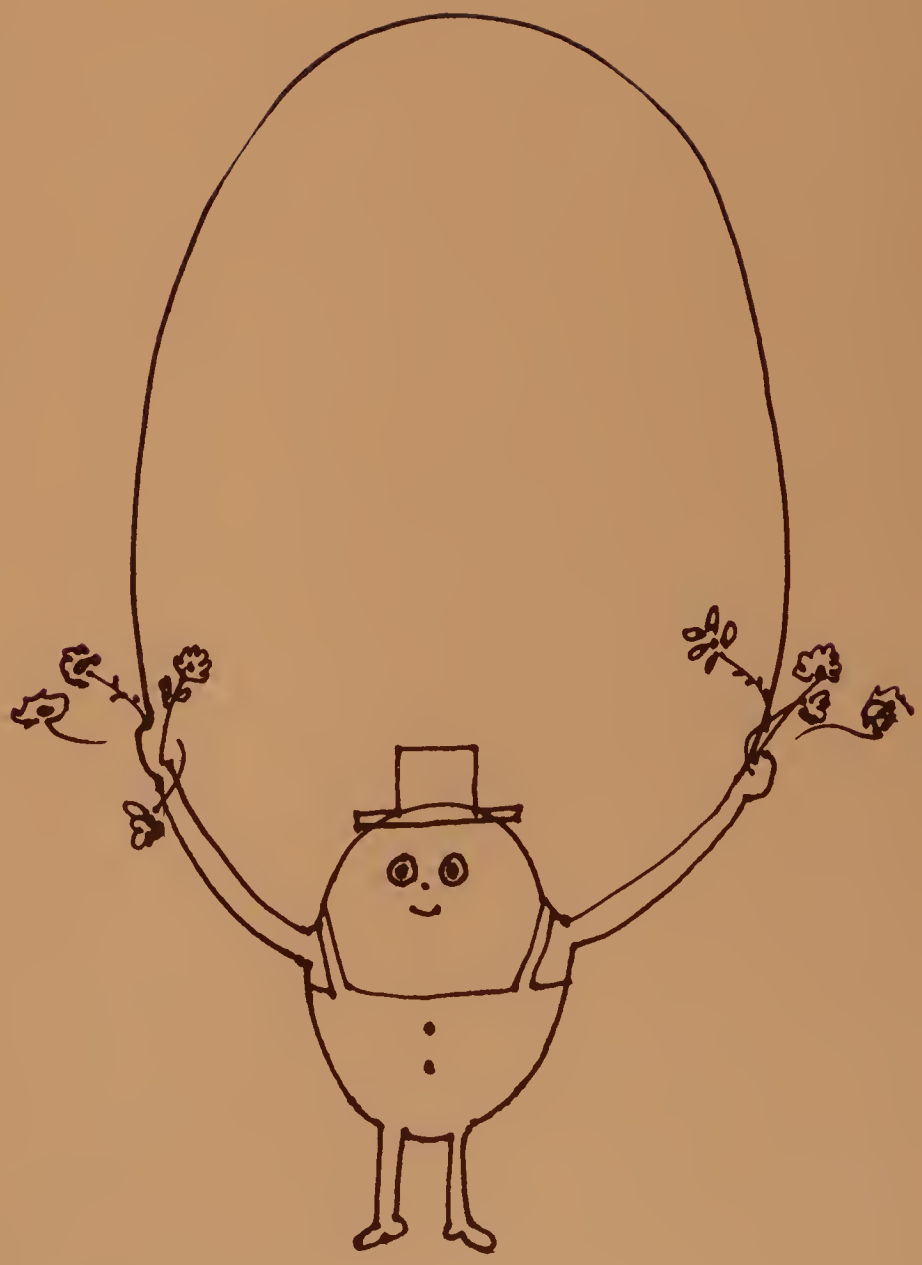
2 cups flour
3 teaspoons baking powder
1 teaspoon salt

2 tablespoons sugar
3 tablespoons butter
1 cup sour cream
1 egg

Sift flour, baking powder, salt and sugar together and cut in butter as for pastry. Add cream and egg, well beaten. Put all together and handle as little as possible. You can prepare the dough several ways for the oven.

1. Roll dough out in two sheets and lay one on the other and bake. While it is still warm from the oven, you can separate the layers, spread the bottom layer thickly with strawberries, sprinkle with powdered sugar, and replace upper crust. Cut in squares and serve.
2. Roll out dough and cut in rounds, bake like biscuits. Top them with strawberries and whipped cream and serve.
3. We liked to spoon the dough onto cookie sheets. They came out of the oven shaggy, full of little peaks and valleys, wonderfully crusty. When they cooled, we broke them open, filled them with the little wild strawberries, put the tops back on, piled on the whipping cream and retired into a sybaritic heaven.

In any case, bake the shortcake in a hot oven about 12 minutes on ungreased baking sheet and lightly brush tops with butter.



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